Source extracts for the research question

This packet collects the source pages behind each claim on the one-page research question, Seasonal herding in the Himachal hills, 1881 to 1961. Each entry gives the source, its file, the original PDF pages, and where those pages sit in this packet. Each group includes the pages before and after the page cited. The extracts are transcribed from the page images, and the packet page numbers refer to the page counter of this file.

Ibbetson 1881

Denzil Ibbetson, Report on the Census of the Panjab, 1881, Results

File: 2. Census of the Punjab, 1881, Denzil Ibbetson, Results, pp 1-421.pdf, inside sources/Punjab 1881, Denzil Ibbetson-20260926T175319Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 274 to 276 (cited page 275). Packet pages 6 to 8.

The Gaddis take their flocks to Kangra for the winter, 1881 (Background)

"The greater portion of their wealth consists of flocks of sheep and goats, which they feed half the year (the winter months) in the valleys of Kangra, and for the other half drive across the range into the territories of Chamba."

Not cited on the page. Altitude, relevant to the Annales reading

"they are found from an elevation of 3,500 or 4,000 feet up to 7,000 feet. Above this altitude there is little or no cultivation"

British rule in Kangra, Gaddi land in both British Kangra and Chamba State (research question, Marxist reading, first arrangement)

"They hold lands on this side and also in Chamba, and in former days were considered subject to both States. At present our rule has materially weakened the tenure of the Chamba Chief, and many continue all the year round on this side of the range acknowledging no allegiance whatever to Chamba. It was a rule with these simple people, whenever fined by the Kangra authorities, to pay a similar penalty into the Chamba treasury. I am afraid our institutions have taught them greater independence"

Ibbetson 1881, Gujars

Denzil Ibbetson, Report on the Census of the Panjab, 1881, Results (Barnes on the Gujars of Kangra)

File: 2. Census of the Punjab, 1881, Denzil Ibbetson, Results, pp 1-421.pdf, inside sources/Punjab 1881, Denzil Ibbetson-20260926T175319Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 266 to 268 (cited page 267). Packet pages 9 to 11.

The Gujjars move buffaloes (Background)

"In the hills the Gujars are exclusively a pastoral tribe, they cultivate scarcely at all. The Gadis keep flocks of sheep and goats, and the Gujar's wealth consists of buffaloes. … During the hot weather the Gujars usually drive their herds to the upper range, where the buffaloes rejoice in the rich grass which the rains bring forth"

Rose

H. A. Rose, A Glossary of the Tribes and Castes of the Punjab and North-West Frontier Province, Vol. 2 (1911)

File: sources/2015.69652.Glossary-Of-The-Tribes-And-Castes-Of-The-Punjab-And-North-west-Frontier-Province-Vol2.pdf

Original PDF pages 296 to 298 (cited page 297). Packet pages 12 to 14.

Rose gives October and November, and April and May (Background)

"The yearly exodus to Kangra takes place in October and November, and the return journey in April and May."

Brahmaur 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Brahmaur, Chamba
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Bhrhmaur - Chamba).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 44 to 46 (cited page 45). Packet pages 15 to 17.

Roads reached the valleys, road and building work (research question, Marxist reading, fourth arrangement)

"On account of construction of approach road to Brahmaur and extraction of timber from forests, and construction of government buildings at Brahmaur and nearabout, new avenues of income have also been thrown open to them and 8 able-bodied persons are working there as unskilled labour at a daily wage of about Rs. 2/-"

Original PDF pages 53 to 56 (cited page 54, 55). Packet pages 18 to 21.

Brahmans and Rajputs owned most of the sheep and goats (Background). Printed table, p. 54

"Brahman 34 households, 20 possessing sheep or goats, 2,027 animals. Rajput 49, 20, 2,364. Sipi 15, 8, 93. Rehara 1, none. Total 99, 48, 4,484."

The Gaddis take their flocks to Kangra for the winter, 1961 (Background). p. 55

"In the beginning of the winter (October and November), the flocks are driven to the low hills of Kangra, Nurpur, Pathankot and Jammu. … In the spring season (April), the flocks are driven back to the village"

Not cited on the page. Hired shepherds are rare, relevant to the Marxist reading. p. 55

"Pohals are hired in summer season by a very few people in rare cases when they cannot spare some one from amongst the family to look after the flock."

Forest Department permits and the grazing fee of Rs. 15 per hundred head (Background, research question, Marxist reading). p. 55

"The Forest Department is discouraging the multiplication of the number of such animals and to implement this they do not issue grazing permits for more than a fixed number of goats and sheep. This attitude of the Department has created great dissatisfaction among the shepherds … On the other hand the Forest Department are of the view that such checks are necessary to check overgrazing and resultant erosion."

Kanum 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Kanum, Kinnaur
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Kanum Kinnaur).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 15 to 17 (cited page 16). Packet pages 22 to 24.

The upper Sutlej traded with Tibet, and the trade ended (research question, Annales comparison)

"During winter people migrate to lower hills alongwith their flocks laden with chilgozas, wool, woollen patties, nuts, pasham, jira and other local herbs which are sold by them either in Lavi fair at Rampur or in the villages in Sirmur, Seoni, Arki, Suket, Bilaspur and Mehlog … The well-to-do people of the village used to go to Gartok in Tibet and buy wool, pasham, jira, sheep and goat. This trade has now practically come to an end."

Original PDF pages 50 to 52 (cited page 51). Packet pages 25 to 27.

The end of the trade with Tibet (research question, Annales comparison)

"Prior to the India-China dispute Shipki-La Pass was open to all traders without passport, customs and without let or hindrance … but no more do caravans of mules, flocks of sheep and goats and ladden human beings now wind through the cavernous openings of Shipki-La."

Road work open to villagers (Marxist reading, fourth arrangement)

"The well-to-do Zamindars were often observed showing concern about the changes and they found it difficult to engage labourers to attend to their sheep and goats. Men and women now prefer to work on the roads rather than work as 'fawals', agricultural labourers and 'rigries' for obvious reason that they get better wages."

Original PDF pages 84 to 86 (cited page 85). Packet pages 28 to 30.

Kanum's flocks spend October to April in the lower hills (Background)

"During winter from October they migrate to Lower Hills as far into Bilaspur, Arki, Mehlog some parts of Karsog, Seoni and Sirmur. They spend the chilly months in these places till the end of April."

Newell 1961

William H. Newell, study of the Gaddis, in Census of India 1961, Report on Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes of Himachal Pradesh

File: 1961 Census, Report on SC and ST of Himachal Pradesh.pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 17 to 19 (cited page 18). Packet pages 31 to 33.

The Raja owned the grazing rights and auctioned fee collection, with the 1950 fee rates (Background, Approach, Marxist reading)

"In Chamba all grazing rights belonged to the rajah of Chamba. … the right to collect the fees in such areas was auctioned by the rajah of Chamba to the highest bidder, who was usually a Gaddi. … The rate in 1950 was 2 annas 6 pies per goat per grazing district and one anna 6 pies per sheep."

Not cited on the page. The mountain pass, relevant to the Annales reading

"the high pass between Kugti village at the top of the Budl Nadi and Lahul … This is a bare mountain top at a height of over 16,000′ without any wood or trees of any sort. It is exceptional for anyone with animals to take less than three days actually on the tops of the mountain"

Original PDF pages 36 to 38 (cited page 37). Packet pages 34 to 36.

Permits fix how many animals each shepherd may graze (Background)

"At the present time, one can only pay tax to the extent that one has a permit issued by the forest officer and the total number of animals allowed to graze in any dhar is determined by the forest officer. This is in order to prevent overgazing [sic]."

Not cited on the page. Relevant to the Marxist reading, third arrangement

"From personal knowledge I know that these permits are freely bought and sold amongst shepherds so that shepherds have now become closed corporations."

Flock numbers: not used on the page, but read before citing any fall in flocks

"About three or four years ago a severe disease struck certain of the flocks with a big decrease in numbers. In 1962 the flocks were coming back to the same strength as in 1958. … the number of sheep and goats was reduced by about a quarter due to the Forest Department permit system. (p. 38 has the fee-paying flock table, 1952-53 to 1961-62.)"

Kothi 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Kothi, Kinnaur

File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Kothi Kinnaur).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 15 to 17 (cited page 16). Packet pages 37 to 39.

The merger of the hill states into Himachal Pradesh, and new roads (research question)

"A motorable road which would pass just below the village is also under construction. … Before the formation of Himachal Pradesh on the 15th April 1948, Kinnaur formed a part of the erstwhile State of Rampur Bushahr."

Maingal 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Maingal, Chamba

File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Maingal - Chamba).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 51 to 53 (cited page 52). Packet pages 40 to 42.

The Gujjars of Maingal take their buffaloes to higher pastures in May and return in September (Background)

"The pastoral economy of the Gujjars demands extensive utilization of pastures and their migration to the higher hills begins in May. They go with their buffaloes to the Chandi, Chal Sakri and Nadin. It takes two days to reach the jot. … The Gujjars are back from the jot in Maingal by September."

Not cited on the page. Not every Gaddi herds

"The Gaddis of Maingal are different from the Gaddis of Brahmaur. They do not lead a pastoral life but have settled on agriculture as their principal occupation."

Devi-Kothi 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Devi-Kothi, Chamba
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Devi-Kothi, Chamba).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 47 to 49 (cited page 48). Packet pages 43 to 45.

Settled farmers who hire graziers (Annales comparison)

"The farmers may also send their sheep and goats with professional graziers to high hills. The charges of the graziers range from twenty to twenty-five naya Paise for the period from May/ June to October for a sheep or goat."

Bir 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Bir, Mandi
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Bir - Mandi).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 42 to 44 (cited page 43). Packet pages 46 to 48.

A low village (Annales comparison of high and low villages)

"There are 139 goats and 69 sheep possessed by 24 households. These are purchased from Gaddis who wander near about in winter, for 10 to 12 rupees."

Shakrori 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Shakrori, Seoni, Mahasu
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Shakrori - Seoni Mahasu).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 74 to 77 (cited page 75, 76). Packet pages 49 to 52.

A low village (Annales comparison of high and low villages). p. 75

"many of which have been bought from the Kinnauras that go by, for ten to twelve rupees … Thousands and thousands have been trecking along and passing these villages since by-gone ages."

A low village, livestock table (Annales comparison). p. 76

"Table XXV, total row: sheep 23, goats 53."

Chitrari 1961

Census of India 1961, Village Survey: Chitrari, Chamba
File: 1961 Census, Village Survey (Chitrari).pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 23 to 25 (cited page 24). Packet pages 53 to 55.

Roads reached the valleys (research question)

"In all these years wherever I have taken my sheep, no matter what route I chose Government has improved and made a better road or is intending that. And behold, this old beaten track below these rocks was our beaten track for centuries, a jeep has started plying."

Punjab Census Atlas 1961

Census of India 1961, Punjab Census Atlas (G. S. Gosal and B. S. Ojha, 1966). It covers Punjab as it stood in 1961, including Kangra, Kulu, Lahaul and Spiti, and Simla. It does not map Chamba or Kinnaur, which were in Himachal Pradesh

File: 1961 Punjab Census Atlas.pdf, inside sources/1961 Village surveys + census reports-20260926T175323Z-1-001.zip

Original PDF pages 11 to 11 (cited page 11). Packet pages 56 to 56.

Maps from the period (Approach). Contents page

"Map titles include Location of Punjab State, Administrative Divisions, Changes in Administrative Divisions 1951-61, Physiography, Drainage System, and Vegetation Types."

Original PDF pages 21 to 25 (cited page 21, 22, 23, 24, 25). Packet pages 57 to 61.

Maps from the period (Approach). Maps 1 to 5

"Location of Punjab State, Administrative Divisions, Changes in Administrative Divisions 1951-61, Physiography, and Drainage System."

Original PDF pages 44 to 44 (cited page 44). Packet pages 62 to 62.

Maps from the period (Approach). Map 13

"Vegetation Types."

Part IV.—Minor Land-owning and Agricultural Castes.

almost all Hindus, and are said to trace their origin from Mathra. They are industrious, patient, and orderly; and though they are ill spoken of in the proverbs of the countryside, yet that is probably only because the Jat is jealous of them as being even better cultivators than himself. Thus they say in Rohtak: "Kosli (the head village of the Ahírs) has fifty brick houses and several thousand swaggerers." So in Dehli: "Rather be kicked by a Rájpút or stumble uphill, than hope anything from a jackal, spear grass, "or an Ahír;" and again: "All castes are God's creatures, but three castes are ruthless. When they get "a chance they have no shame; the whore, the Banya, and the Ahír." But these stigmas are now-a-days at least wholly undeserved.

The Ahírs of the North-West Provinces have three great sections, the Nandbans of the central *doáb*, the Jádúbans of the upper *doáb* and the Mathra country, and the Gwálbans of the lower *doáb* at Benares. The Ahírs of the Panjáb have returned themselves as shown in the margin. Of the Gwálbans more than 16,000 are found in Patiála. Within these tribes they have numerous clans, among which the Kosali of Rohtak and Gurgáon number 7,322.

Ahir tribes.	
Jádúbans	43,961
Nandbans	24,998
Gwálbans	25,187

494. The Mahtam (Caste No. 51).—There has been a confusion in the figures of Table VIIIA. owing to the fact that the Mahtams are also called Bahrúpias. The Mahtams of Gújrát and Siálkot returned themselves under that name, and were included under Bahrúpia in Table VIIIA. I have restored them to their proper place in Abstract No. 85, page 266. The Mahtams, or as they are called in the Jálandhar division Mahton (nasal *n*), are found chiefly in the Satluj valley, and along the foot of the hills between Jálandhar and Gújrát. They are of exceedingly low caste, being almost outcasts; by origin they are vagrants, and in some parts they apparently retain their wandering habits, while everywhere they are still great hunters, using nooses like those of the Báwarias described in section 575. But in many districts, and especially on the middle Satluj, they have devoted themselves to husbandry and are skilful and laborious cultivators. The great majority of them are classed as Hindus, but about one-fifth are Musalmán, and as many again Sikh. But the Musalmán section, even in the Multán division, eat wild pig and retain most of their Hindu customs, and are consequently not admitted to religious equality by the other Musalmáns. They appear, however, to bury their dead. They live, in Muzaffargarh, in grass huts on the river banks, whence the saying—"Only two Mahtam huts and calls itself Khairpur." Mr. Purser thus describes the Mahtams of Montgomery:—

"They are a low Hindu caste, and are looked down on by their neighbours. Their story is that they were Rajputs, and one of "their ancestors was a kanungo. Abkar was then on the throne. Kanungos were called *mahta*, and thus they got their name. "The first mahta was dismissed, and then settled at Mahtpur in Jalandhar. His descendants emigrated and settled along the banks "of the rivers as they found quantities of *sarr* in such situations, and working in *sarr* was their chief occupation. It was not till "the Nakkai chiefs held sway that they settled down permanently in this district. They adopted the custom of marriage with "widows according to the form of *chaddar dálna*, and so became Sudras. They are also called 'Bahrupias,' which name is a cor-"ruption of '*Bho-rúp-ias*,' and means people of many modes of life, because they turned their hands to any business they could "find (yet *cf.* Select Glossary, I, 17 & 54). Cunningham (History of the Sikhs, page 17) says, 'the hardworking Hindu Mahtams are "'still moving family by family and village by village eastward away from the Ravi and Chanab.' This would seem to give the "Mahtams a western instead of eastern origin as claimed by them. They own a good many villages (19), most of which are in good "condition. Where they are not proprietors of the whole village, they reside in a separate group of huts at some distance from the "main *ábádi*. They are great hands at catching wild pigs; but it is in cutting down the jungle on inundated lands that they excel. "Though industrious they do not care much for working wells, and prefer cultivating lands flooded by the rivers. They are quar-"relsome and addicted to petty thieving. They are of medium stature and stoutly made."

495. There is a Bahrúp tribe of Banjáras or, as they are called in the Panjáb, Labánas; and the Labánas and Mahtams of the Satluj appear closely to resemble each other. Elliott's description of the Bahrúp Banjáras at page 54, Vol. I of his *Races of the North-West Provinces*, tallies curiously in some respects with that of the Bahrúpia Mahtams of Gújrát given by Captain Mackenzie at section 71 of his settlement report of that district; and on the whole it seems probable that the Mahtams are Banjáras or Labánas, in which case it is possible that the Satluj group have come up from Rájpútána, while the sub-montane group are merely a western continuation of the Banjáras of the lower hills. This is the more probable as I find that the Jálandhar Mahtams trace their origin from Jammu, conquered Ráhon from the Gújars, and were in turn deprived of it by the Ghorewáha Rájpúts probably not less than five centuries ago. At the same time I should note that the Mahton of Hushyárpur and the neighbourhood appear to hold a much higher social position than the Mahtams of the Satluj; and it may be that the two are really distinct. Sardár Gurdiál Singh indeed goes so far as to say that the Mahton of Hushyárpur are of good Rájpút blood, though they have lost caste by taking to ploughing and practising widow-marriage, and that their social standing is not much below that of Rájpúts. He thinks that the name may be derived from *Mahta*, which he says is a title of honour current among the Rájpúts of the hills: and this agrees with the Montgomery tradition quoted above. Mr. Anderson also gives the Hushyárpur Mahtons high social standing. On the other hand, Mr. Wilson says that the Labánas of Sirsa would scout the idea of connection with the Mahtams of the Satluj, whom they consider utterly inferior to themselves. The point needs to be cleared up by further enquiry, especially in the districts where the classes come into contact. Our detailed tables of clans will doubtless throw light on the question.

496. The Sarrara (Caste No. 118).—It is perhaps probable that these men are the same as those discussed under the head "Sarera" in the section on Hill Menials. But I have separated them, as their identity is not at all certain. The Sarráras which are found in Hazára belong to a race inhabiting Chibhál, or the hill country of Kashmír on the Hazára border, and according to Major Wace belong to the same ethnic group as the Dhúnd, Satti, and Kharrál of the same tract. It might perhaps have been better to take them with the Kharráls. They are chiefly found in the Abbottábád *tahsíl*, where they are purely agricultural. They are all Musalmán.

497. The Ghosi (Caste No. 125).—The Ghosi is I believe an Ahír tribe; but in the Panjáb the name is only used for Musalmáns, and is often applied to any cowherd or milkman of that religion, whether Gújar, Ahír, or of any other caste, just as Gwála is used for a Hindu cowherd. The Ghosi proper is only found in the eastern districts, though a few have strayed into the large cantonments to the west. But

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Part IV.—Minor Land-owning and Agricultural Castes.

the 235 persons shown as Ghosi in the Ráwalpindi division are, according to my papers, entered as Ghasiára or "grass-cutter," while the 337 of the Multán division are shown as Her, probably for Ahír. How these came to be classed as Ghosi I cannot explain. It was not done by my orders. It is said that Hindus will buy pure milk from the Musalmán Ghosi, but will reject it if there is any suspicion of its having been watered by the latter, as they must not drink water at his hands! The Ghosis are a purely pastoral caste, at any rate in the Panjáb. They are however sometimes butchers.

498. The Gaddi (Caste No. 81).—These figures appear to include two entirely distinct classes of people. The Musalmán Gaddis of Dehli, Karnál, and Ambála are apparently a tribe found in the upper *doáb* of the Jamna and Ganges, closely resembling the Ghosi, and perhaps like them a sub-division of the Ahírs. They are called Gádi almost as often as Gaddi. They are by hereditary occupation milkmen; but in Karnál, where they are most numerous, they have settled down as cultivators and own several villages. They are poor husbandmen. And a further confusion may possibly have taken place from the fact that a descendant of a Rájpút father by a widow of another caste married by *karewa* is called Garra with the hard *r*. Indeed it is not quite impossible that here we may have the connecting link between the two classes. At any rate the word Gaddi, as used in the Panjáb proper, is applied to the inhabitants of the mountain range between Kángra and Chamba and of its continuation in the latter State. The term is commonly applied to almost any inhabitant of that region; but the true Gaddis, whom General Cunningham is inclined to identify with the ancient Gandaridæ or Gangaridæ, are apparently of Khatri origin. Mr. Barnes thus describes them:—

"The Gadis are the most remarkable race in the hills. In features, manners, dress, and dialect they differ essentially from all "the rest of the population. The Gadis reside exclusively upon the snowy range which divides Chamba from Kangra. A few of "them have wandered down into the valleys which skirt the base of this mighty chain, but the great majority live on the heights "above; they are found from an elevation of 3,500 or 4,000 feet up to 7,000 feet. Above this altitude there is little or no "cultivation, the increasing acclivity of the range opposing insurmountable obstacles. They preserve a tradition among themselves "that their ancestors originally came from the Panjab, and that during the horrors of the Mahomedan invasions the population of "the cities fled from the open country before their invaders and took refuge in these ranges, at that period almost uninhabited. The "term 'Gadi' is a generic name, and under this appellation are included Brahmins, Khatris, and a few Rajputs and Rathis. The "majority, however, are Khatris, and the sub-divisions of the caste correspond exactly with the tribes among the Khatris existing in "the plains of the Panjab at the present day. Impure castes are not styled Gadis, but are known by the names of Badi, Sipi, "Háli, &c. They are a semi-pastoral, semi-agricultural race. The greater portion of their wealth consists of flocks of sheep and "goats, which they feed half the year (the winter months) in the valleys of Kangra, and for the other half drive across the range "into the territories of Chamba. They hold lands on this side and also in Chamba, and in former days were considered subject to "both States. At present our rule has materially weakened the tenure of the Chamba Chief, and many continue all the year round "on this side of the range acknowledging no allegiance whatever to Chamba. It was a rule with these simple people, whenever "fined by the Kangra authorities, to pay a similar penalty into the Chamba treasury. I am afraid our institutions have taught "them greater independence, and the infraction of this custom is now more frequent than the observance. Many Gadis cultivate the "winter crops or wheat in Kangra, and returning with their flocks grow the summer or rain crop at "Barmor," as the province "on the other side of the snow is designated. They all wear woollen clothes, which they make up at home out of the wool from "their own flocks. The men don a remarkable high-peaked cap, with flaps to pull down over the ears in case of severe weather. "The front is usually adorned with a garland of dried flowers, or with tufts of the Impeyan pheasant, or red beads, the seeds of "parasitical plants growing in the forests. The rest of their dress is a frock, made very capacious and loose, secured round the waist "with a black woollen cord. In the body of this frock the Gadi stores the most miscellaneous articles; his own meal, tied up in an "untanned leather pouch, with two or three young lambs just born, and perhaps a present of walnuts or potatoes for his master are "the usual contents. His legs are generally bare, but occasionally he wears woollen trowsers very loose at the knee, to allow free "motion in walking, and fitting tight at the ankle, over which it lies in folds so as not to restrict the action of the limbs. The "women wear the same frock, only reaching to their ankles, secured with the same woollen cord. Their garment fits rather tighter "about the body, and is both modest and becoming. The head-dress is a "chaddur," or sheet, thrown loosely over the upper portion "of the body, and sometimes fastened in the shape of a turban, with a loose streamer behind by way of ornament. The Gadis are "a very simple and virtuous race; they are remarkable, even among the hill population, for their eminent regard for truth; crime is "almost unknown among them; their women are chaste and modest, seldom deserting their husbands. Like all the inhabitants "of mountainous regions they are frank and merry in their manners,—they constantly meet together, singing and dancing in a style "quite peculiar to themselves. They are great tipplers, and at these festive meetings the natural hilarity is considerably enhanced "by deep potations. In person they are a comely race. The women frequently are very fair and beautiful,—their features are "regular, and the expression almost always mild and engaging. The Gadis wear the thread of caste, and are much stricter in Hindu "customs and observances than most of the inhabitants of the higher ranges of the Himalaya. They are not a very widely-diffused "race. They extend over the greater part of Chamba, inhabit the skirts of the Kangra snowy range, and are found also on the "southern face of the Badrawar hills across the Ravi. Their peculiar caste, "Khatri," and their position in the ranges immediately "above Lahore favour the tradition that originally they were fugitives from the cities of the plains before the Mahomedan inroads."

They are almost all shepherds, and do not in any way resemble the Khatris of the plains. They are all Hindus, but locally distinguished from the *jándre* or cotton-clad Hindus. The Khatri and Rájpút Gaddis intermarry; and in some places the Bráhman Gaddi will marry the Khatri Gaddi. The Khatri or true Gaddis are the best of the classes, and "number among them the best shepherds, and the richest and most influential men." It is not improbable that in Chamba, their true home, the Rájpút and Bráhman Gaddis are less numerous than in Kángra. The Gaddi are a simple and rustic people. The proverb says: "The Gaddi is a good-natured fool; ask for his cap and he gives you his coat." And again: "In no-man's-land one makes friends with Gújars and Gaddis."

FOREIGN RACES.

499. Foreign Races.—I have called the groups of which the figures are given on the next page in Abstract No. 87 Foreign Races, because they bear titles properly foreign to India and for the most part lay claim to foreign origin. It will presently be seen how little real right many of them have to the names they bear. The Saiyads might have been included in this group, but they have been classed with the priestly castes. The present group is divisible into three sections, the Arab and Shekh, the Túrk and Mughal, and the Ghulám and Qizilbásh. The last two and probably many of the Arabs and Túrks are true foreigners, and have a good claim to the names they bear; but the Shekhs and Mughals are for the most part mere pretenders. What Rájpút is to the Hindu, Shekh, Saiyad, and in the west of the Panjáb Mughal, are to the Musalmán; and every convert of low caste who wishes to glorify himself assumes one

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Part IV.—Minor Land-owning and Agricultural Castes.

of these titles, while tribes whose origin is lowly or has been forgotten, trace their descent from the people of the Prophet or of one of the Mahomedan conquerors of India. As Mr. Thomson puts it: "Pride of "race leads to the invention of some royal progenitor, and pride of religion is a perpetual inducement to "escape from the admission of an idolatrous ancestry."

Abstract No. 87, *showing* Foreign Races.

	Figures.						Proportion per 1,000 of Total Population.						
	140	17	126	37	130	181	14	17	126	37	130	181	
	Arab.	Shekh.	Turk.	Mughal.	Ghulám.	Qizilbásh.	Arab.	Shekh.	Turk.	Mughal.	Ghulám.	Qizilbásh.	Total.	
Dehli	...	50,195	5	5,806	...	...	...	78	...	9	...	...	87	Dehli
Gurgaon	...	10,157	...	1,317	...	...	...	16	...	2	...	...	18	Gurgaon
Karnál	...	13,789	...	597	...	...	...	22	...	1	...	...	23	Karnál
Hissar	...	3,983	...	492	...	...	...	8	...	1	...	...	9	Hissar
Rohtak	...	8,334	...	414	...	...	...	15	...	1	...	...	16	Roht a
Sirsa	...	2,733	...	694	...	...	...	11	...	3	...	...	14	Sirsa
Ambala	...	28,920	...	855	...	...	...	27	...	1	...	...	28	Ambala
Ludhiána	19	6,129	...	677	...	...	...	10	...	1	...	...	11	Ludhiána
Simla	...	3,676	...	160	...	...	...	86	...	4	...	...	90	Simla
Jullundur	...	9,720	...	1,662	...	...	...	12	...	2	...	...	14	Jullundur
Hoshiárpur	...	6,839	...	1,400	...	...	...	8	...	2	...	...	10	Hoshiárpur
Kángra	...	1,792	...	289	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	...	2	Kángra
Amritsar	...	8,280	...	2,546	...	...	...	9	...	3	...	...	12	Amritsar
Gurdáspur	...	10,468	157	2,450	...	...	...	13	...	3	...	...	16	Gurdáspur
Siálkot	...	11,636	2	4,537	...	...	...	12	...	4	...	...	16	Siálkot
Lahore	3	17,853	95	3,676	...	33	...	19	...	4	...	...	23	Lahore
Gujránwála	...	8,557	...	827	...	...	...	14	...	1	...	...	15	Gujránwála
Ferozepore	...	6,806	...	1,103	...	...	...	10	...	2	...	...	12	Ferozepore
Ráwalpindi	17	25,524	188	25,169	...	...	...	31	...	31	...	...	62	Ráwalpindi
Jhelum	...	8,412	...	11,222	...	...	...	14	...	19	...	...	33	Jhelum
Gujrát	...	7,906	...	5,290	...	...	...	11	...	8	...	...	19	Gujrát
Shahpur	...	7,499	...	2,335	...	...	...	18	...	6	...	...	24	Shahpur
Mooltan	475	12,649	1	4,601	99	...	1	23	...	8	...	...	32	Mooltan
Jhang	...	5,337	...	3,122	...	...	...	14	...	8	...	...	22	Jhang
Montgomery	35	4,740	1	1,620	...	...	...	11	...	4	...	...	15	Montgomery
Muzaffargarh	297	5,046	...	576	...	...	1	15	...	2	...	...	18	Muzaffargarh
D. I. Khan	23	5,713	1	676	...	10	...	13	...	2	...	...	15	D. I. Khan
D. G. Khan	32	4,680	5	495	...	...	...	13	...	1	...	...	14	D. G. Khan
Bannu	...	11,391	...	759	...	...	...	34	...	2	...	...	36	Bannu
Pesháwar	1,418	9,576	83	4,538	3,347	389	2	16	...	8	5	1	32	Pesháwar
Hazara	23	5,098	2,996	5,297	...	...	...	13	7	13	...	...	33	Hazara
Kohát	...	4,428	1	153	...	9	...	24	...	1	...	...	25	Kohát
British Territory	2,342	327,928	3,535	95,361	3,446	441	...	17	...	5	...		22	**British Territory**
Patiála	...	14,603	...	1,854	...	...	...	10	...	1	...	...	11	Patiála
Nábha	...	2,229	...	341	...	...	..	8	...	1	...	...	9	Nábha
Kapurthala	...	2,447		606	...	...	...	10	...	2	...	...	12	Kapurthala
Jínd	...	3,153	...	926	...	...	...	13	...	4	...	...	17	Jínd
Total East. Plains	...	26,214	...	4,517	...	...	...	10	...	2	...	...	12	Total East. Plains
Baháwalpur	...	14,248	...	2,523	...	...	...	25	...	4	...	...	29	Baháwalpur
Chamba	...	2,169	...	119	...	...	...	19	...	1	...	...	20	Chamba
Total Hill States	...	3,945	...	578	...	...	...	5	...	1	...	...	6	Total Hill States
British Territory	2,342	327,928	3,535	95,361	3,446	441	...	17	...	5	...	...	22	**British Territory**
Native States	...	44,407	...	7,618	...	...	...	12	...	2	...	...	14	**Native States**
Province	2,342	372,335	3,535	102,979	3,446	441	...	16	...	5	...	...	21	**Province**

500. The Arab (Caste No. 140).—Arabs are returned in the Panjáb chiefly from the Multán and Pesháwar divisions. They are probably Arab merchants from Bombay, where I believe men of true Arab extraction are somewhat numerous. That they have not come direct from Arabia is shown by the language table, in which Arabic is returned as the mother-tongue of only 63 persons. More than half the Arabs in the Panjáb are to be found in Pesháwar itself. This is hardly to be wondered at, for Pesháwar is a city in which may be found representatives of almost every Eastern nation, and is the half-way house between India and Asia. It is possible that some of our Shekhs, whether truly or falsely so called, may have returned themselves as

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Abstract No. 84, *showing* Gujar tribes *for* Districts.

	Gujar Tribes.																			
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	
	Tánwar.	Chokhar.	Rawál.	Kalsán.	Kathana.	Kasánah.	Kalas.	Gorsí.	Chechí.	Dhedár.	Powál.	Larí.	Bijár.	Khalúdar.	Melu.	Thakría.	Chauhán.	Mousa.	Bhumla.	
Dehli	2,555	744	100	1	336	676	7	8	51	1	6	4	...	...	...	...	87	...	...	Dehli
Gurgaon	324	1	...	8	1,629	797	...	...	274	10	782	17	...	...	...	...	155	...	2,692	Gurgaon
Karnál	...	2,325	4,417	1,588	21	92	...	422	307	43	208	...	33	...	118	...	172	...	...	Karnál
Hissar	116	34	8	20	389	508	189	10	308	33	79	42	70	...	602	...	86	...	...	Hissar
Rohtak	...	19	3	1	101	128	4	41	42	2	24	1	...	...	9	...	52	...	...	Rohtak
Ambala	...	240	10	...	1,491	2,289	1,208	1,594	2,810	1,218	4,467	554	3,504	...	6	...	1,280	...	...	Ambala
Ludhiána	...	...	...	...	749	695	1,175	3,462	3,285	1,139	1,690	613	1,584	...	409	29	518	30	...	Ludhiána
Jálandhar	...	...	...	...	546	388	565	1,457	1,152	86	1,139	173	683	...	1	...	682	278	...	*Jálandhar*
Hushyárpur	...	...	...	...	546	2,299	1,111	3,301	3,171	...	6,910	2,825	3,230	1,172	2,357	1,200	4,530	2,585	...	Hushyárpur
Kángra	...	...	...	...	60	135	118	209	418	52	211	851	190	...	...	13	645	142	...	Kángra
Amritsar	...	...	...	...	153	134	...	180	645	...	197	...	180	...	...	...	146	69	...	Amritsar
Gurdáspur	1,140	336	...	...	2,750	1,533	...	1,772	4,010	215	1,687	30	710	...	...	860	1,151	4,749	...	Gurdáspur
Siálkot	...	3	10	...	1,020	439	...	277	692	167	541	1	176	...	...	...	517	...	...	Siálkot
Lahore	...	1	13	...	445	82	...	200	1,020	54	198	40	178	...	47	4	194	91	...	Lahore
Gujránwala	...	...	17	...	125	25	60	38	205	...	27	...	126	...	...	43	221	...	...	Gujránwala
Firozpur	...	...	...	...	1,108	312	160	870	779	338	389	114	215	...	...	...	332	170	...	Firozpur
Ráwalpindi	...	280	...	...	5,646	612	1,318	1,232	3,207	340	2,417	4	1,041	...	25	975	2,361	344	...	Ráwalpindi
Jahlam	...	20	...	...	3,684	882	1,260	309	1,621	451	1,349	30	907	...	...	758	1,287	62	35	Jahlam
Gujrát	...	269	...	...	21,449	3,048	3,500	3,312	8,092	1,921	3,491	150	3,592	...	1,389	3,524	7,985	382	2,189	Gujrát
Pesháwar	...	13	3	...	..	2	13	119	167	2	31	2	230	...	...	...	...	...	..	Pesháwar
Hazara	...	195	...	...	8,526	11	1,314	319	7,136	899	2,684	...	2,304	...	...	2,362	5,132	221	21	Hazara
States of East. Plains	134	167	30	...	2,782	456	652	2,036	5,258	908	1,095	416	1,664	...	382	183	981	403	328	States of East. Plains
British Territory	4,143	4,524	4,600	1,627	51,065	15,126	12,104	19,279	30,562	7,055	28,539	5,461	19,159	1,172	4,968	9,770	27,554	9,123	4,937	British Territory
Native States	134	167	67	..	3,080	1,014	1,209	2,824	6,427	1,261	1,441	1,258	2,186	..	956	183	2,238	403	370	Native States
Province	4,277	4,691	4,667	1,627	54,145	16,140	13,403	22,103	45,989	8,316	29,980	6,719	21,345	1,172	5,924	9,953	29,792	9,526	5,307	Province

Part IV.—Minor and Land-owning Agricultural Castes.

not excessive praise in a district held by Gakkhars, Awáns, and Rájpúts), though the Maliár or Aráin is a better market gardener; and that they are quiet and industrious, more likeable than (Salt-range) Jats, but with few attractive qualities. Mr. Steedman gives a similar account of the Gújars of Ráwalpindi, calling them "excellent cultivators." So the Gújars of Hushyárpur are said to be "a quiet and well-behaved set." In Jálandhar Sir Richard Temple describes them as "here as elsewhere of pastoral habits, but more "industrious and less predatory than usual;" and Mr. Barkley writes: "At present, after thirty years of "British rule, they are probably as little given to crime as any other large class in the agricultural popu- "lation. It is still generally true that they occupy themselves more with grazing than with agriculture; "but this is by no means invariably the case." But in Fírozpur again Mr. Brandreth describes them as "unwilling cultivators, and greatly addicted to thieving," and gives instances of their criminal propensities. Thus it would appear that the further the Gújar moves from his native hills, the more he deteriorates and the more unpleasant he makes himself to his neighbours. The following description of the Gújars of Kángra by Mr. Barnes is both graphic and interesting:—

"The Gujars of the hills are quite unlike the caste of the same designation in the plains. There they are known as an idle, "worthless and thieving race, rejoicing in waste, and enemies to cultivation and improvement; but above and below they are both "addicted to pastoral habits. In the hills the Gujars are exclusively a pastoral tribe,—they cultivate scarcely at all. The Gadis keep "flocks of sheep and goats, and the Gujar's wealth consists of buffaloes. These people live in the skirts of the forests, and maintain "their existence exclusively by the sale of the milk, ghee, and other produce of their herds. The men graze the cattle, and fre- "quently lie out for weeks in the woods tending their herds. The women repair to the markets every morning with baskets on their "heads, with little earthen pots filled with milk, butter-milk and ghee, each of these pots containing the proportion required for a "day's meal. During the hot weather the Gujars usually drive their herds to the upper range, where the buffaloes rejoice in the "rich grass which the rains bring forth, and at the same time attain condition from the temperate climate and the immunity from "venomous flies which torment their existence in the plains. The Gujars are a fine, manly race, with peculiar and handsome "features. They are mild and inoffensive in manner, and in these hills are not distinguished by the bad pre-eminence which attaches "to their race in the plains. They are never known to thieve. Their women are supposed to be not very scrupulous. Their "habits of frequenting public markets and carrying about their stock for sale unaccompanied by their husbands undoubtedly expose "them to great temptations; and I am afraid the imputations against their character are too well founded. They are tall well- "grown women, and may be seen every morning entering the bazaars of the hill towns, returning home about the afternoon with "their baskets emptied of their treasures. The Gujars are found all over the district. They abound particularly about Jowala Mukhi, "Tira, and Nadaun. There are some Hindu Gujars, especially towards Mandi; but they are a small sect compared to the Musalmans."

It has been suggested, and is I believe held by many, that Jats and Gújars, and perhaps Ahírs also, are all of one ethnic stock; and this because there is a close communion between them. It may be that they are the same in their far-distant origin. But I think that they must have either entered India at different times or settled in separate parts, and my reason for thinking so is precisely because they eat and smoke together. In the case of Jat and Rájpút the reason for differentiation is obvious, the latter being of higher rank than the former. But the social standing of Jats, Gújars, and Ahírs being practically identical, I do not see why they should ever have separated if they were once the same. It is however possible that the Jats were the camel graziers and perhaps husbandmen, the Gújars the cowherds of the hills, and the Ahírs the cowherds of the plains. If this be so, they afford a classification by occupation of the yeoman class, which fills up the gap between and is absolutely continuous with the similar classification of the castes above them as Bráhmans, Banyas, and Rájpúts, and of the castes below them as Tarkháns, Chamárs, and so forth. But we must know more of the early distribution of the tribes before we can have any opinion on the subject. I have noticed in the early historians a connection between the migrations and location of Gújars and Rájpúts which has struck me as being more than accidental; but the subject needs an immense deal of work upon it before it can be said to be even ready for drawing conclusions[1].

482. Gujar Tribes.—The Gújar tribes and clans appear to be very numerous, and apparently new local sub-divisions have sprung up in many places. Still the distribution of the main tribes for which I give figures on the opposite page in Abstract No. 84 is far more general than is the case with other castes of equal importance. The figures only include 47 per cent. of the Gújars of the Province; but they comprise 69 per cent. of those of Gújrát, and probably include most of the great original tribes. The Khatána and Chechi far surpass the others in number.

MINOR AGRICULTURAL AND PASTORAL TRIBES.

483. The minor agricultural and pastoral tribes.—The group of castes for which the figures are given in Abstract No. 85 on page 266 are not separated from the castes and tribes already discussed by any clearly defined line. Indeed it is quite a matter of opinion whether some of these should not have been ranked with the major and some of those with the minor tribes. But the group now to be discussed very generally hold an inferior position among the agricultural community, and seldom if ever occupy the position of the dominant tribe in any considerable tract of country. They may be divided into three classes, though here again the lines of demarcation are indistinct. The first consists of the market gardeners proper or growers of vegetables, and includes the Màli, Saini, Aráin, and Bághbán, all four of whom are probably closely connected, and some of them almost undistinguishable. The cultivation of vegetables is looked upon as degrading by the agricultural classes, why I know not, unless it be that night soil is generally used for their fertilisation; and a Rájpút would say: "What! Do you take me for an Aráin?" if anything was proposed which he considered derogatory. The second class comprises the Kanet and Ghirath, the low-class cultivators of the hills, and the Kamboh, Ahír, Mahtam, and other cultivators of inferior status. Some of these are closely allied to the vegetable-growers; others again to the Ghosi and Gaddi which constitute the third class, and are pastoral rather than agricultural. The class as a whole is to be found in largest number in the fertile districts of the eastern plains and sub-montane tract, and in the hills where the proud Rájpúts look upon labour at the plough as degrading. It is least numerous in the Deraját, where the comprehensive name of Jat embraces all cultivators of this class.

[1] Mr. Wilson notes that the Gújars and the Bargújar tribe of Rájpúts are often found together; and suggests that the latter may be to the Gújars what the Khánzádahs are to the Meos and what most Rájpúts are to the Jats.

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Abstract No. 85, *showing* Minor Agricultural *and* Pastoral Tribes.

MINOR AGRICULTURAL AND PASTORAL TRIBES.

	Figures.															Proportion per 1,000 of Total Population.															
	45	31	7	65	20	29	147	105	142	33	27	51	118	125	81	45	31	7	65		20	29	147	105	142	33	27	51	118		125	81		GRAND TOTAL.
	Máli.	Saini.	Arain.	Baghbán.	Kanet.	Ghiráth.	Reya.	Lodha.	Káchhi.	Kamboh.	Ahír.	Mahtam.	Sarára.	Ghosi.	Gaddi.	Máli.	Saini.	Arain.	Baghbán.	Total.	Kanet.	Ghiráth.	Reya.	Lodha.	Káchhi.	Kamboh.	Ahír.	Mahtam.	Sarára.	Total.	Ghosi.	Gaddi.	Total.	
Dehli	12,714	1,672	1,585	...	...	...	1,993	3,825	1,323	46	14,544	...	...	876	267	20	3	2	...	25	...	...	3	6	2	...	23	...	...	34	1	...	1	60
Gurgaon	9,673	...	1	...	...	...	...	226	1	...	64,884	...	...	16	...	15	...	...	...	15	...	...	...	...	...	...	101	...	...	101	...	...	...	116
Karnal	10,124	21	7,118	...	...	...	...	1,659	284	9,082	1,007	...	...	490	2,729	16	...	11	...	27	...	...	...	3	...	15	2	...	...	20	1	4	5	52
Hissar	9,777	...	1,907	...	...	...	...	7	61	11	7,861	...	...	390	...	19	...	4	...	23	...	...	...	...	...	...	16	...	...	16	1	...	1	40
Rohtak	7,949	...	36	...	...	...	...	18	1	..	15,824	...	...	309	...	14	...	...	...	14	...	...	...	...	...	...	29	...	...	29	1	...	1	44
Sirsa	885	...	4,742	...	...	...	...	1	16	...	922	1,988	...	67	...	3	...	19	...	22	...	...	...	...	...	...	4	8	..	12	...	...	...	34
Ambala	...	63,054	30,881	...	2,602	296	...	1,528	55	12,988	1,561	...	...	224	901	...	59	29	...	88	3	...	...	1	...	12	1	...	...	17	...	1	1	106
Ludhiána	...	304	27,229	...	20	4	...	48	7	951	1	...	...	201	...	...	...	44	...	44	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	46
Simla	...	50	24	...	9,090	101	...	17	8	11	536	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	2	212	2	...	...	...	...	12	...	...	226	...	...	...	228
Jalandhar	11	14,324	123,323	...	60	389	...	...	42	7,120	259	3,314	...	...	...	...	18	156	...	174	...	...	...	...	...	9	...	4	...	13	...	...	...	187
Hushyárpur	195	43,790	38,801	...	1,639	41,793	...	...	10	466	30	230	...	...	5	...	49	43	...	92	2	46	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	49	...	2	2	143
Kángra	407	1,911	1,067	...	61,141	108,716	...	...	11	...	26	1	...	...	2,036	1	3	1	...	5	84	149	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	234	...	3	3	242
Amritsar	...	565	44,708	...	...	210	...	...	66	13,654	356	1,873	...	...	...	...	1	50	...	51	...	...	...	...	...	15	...	2	...	17	...	...	...	68
Gurdáspur	...	13,842	55,983	...	...	6,142	...	...	...	275	53	...	...	...	303	...	17	68	...	85	...	7	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	8	...	...	...	93
Sialkot	...	433	65,241	...	...	14	...	...	...	10	448	1,052	...	1	...	...	...	65	...	65	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	66
Lahore	122	2	94,964	...	...	20	...	152	34	17,694	1,213	9,551	...	99	...	...	...	103	...	103	...	...	...	...	...	19	1	10	...	30	...	...	...	133
Gujránwála	...	...	21,740	...	...	...	...	8	...	604	85	17	...	...	...	...	...	35	...	35	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	36
Firozpur	52	...	51,043	...	...	4	...	174	1	5,208	1,100	5,954	...	83	...	...	...	78	...	78	...	...	...	...	...	8	2	9	...	19	...	...	...	97
Ráwalpindi	106	7	2	41,701	1	...	...	385	...	8	941	...	...	235	...	...	...	...	51	51	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	52
Jahlam	...	...	15,470	11,414	...	6	...	2	...	14	195	...	...	...	...	...	...	35	19	54	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	54
Gujrat	...	...	20,386	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	58	2,022	...	...	...	...	...	30	...	30	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	...	3	...	...	...	33
Shahpur	...	...	8,574	...	...	...	...	...	...	128	962	...	...	...	...	...	...	20	...	20	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	2	...	...	...	22
Multan	49	53	23,981	20	...	4	...	378	...	687	887	4,193	...	332	...	...	...	43	...	43	...	...	...	1	...	1	2	8	...	12	1	...	1	56
Jhang	...	...	6,077	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	45	29	...	...	...	...	...	15	...	15	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	15
Montgomery	...	...	22,889	...	...	...	...	...	...	14,673	186	13,147	...	...	...	...	...	54	...	54	...	...	...	...	...	34	...	31	...	65	...	...	...	119
Muzaffargarh	13	...	3,991	...	...	...	..	3	...	11	73	2,943	...	5	...	...	...	12	...	12	...	...	...	...	...	...	9	...	...	9	...	...	...	21
Derah Ismail Khan	...	...	1,068	...	..	8	...	11	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2
Derah Ghazi Khan	22	...	59	...	...	12	...	...	1	1	6	822	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	...	2	...	...	...	2
Bannu	...	3	3,941	...	...	9	...	1	...	7	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	12	...	12	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	12
Pesháwar	...	...	...	21,240	...	12	...	92	5	3	436	4	...	23	...	...	...	..	36	36	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	1	...	...	...	37
Hazara	...	...	...	5,532	...	...	...	...	...	...	37	...	4,426	...	...	...	...	...	14	14	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	11	11	...	...	...	25
Kohát	...	...	...	1,154	...	...	...	2	1	1	62	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	6	6	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	6
British Territory	52,102	140,031	676,831	81,063	74,553	157,740	1,993	8,537	1,928	83,656	114,633	47,140	4,426	3,351	6,242	3	7	36	4	50	4	8	...	...	...	4	6	3	...	25	...	...	...	75
Patiála	6,052	7,854	41,500	153	14,203	328	...	27	27	23,417	31,512	...	...	181	...	4	5	28	...	37	10	...	...	...	...	16	21	...	...	47	...	...	...	84
Nábha	269	22	3,182	...	...	...	...	1	3	3,649	14,711	21	...	...	...	1	...	12	...	13	...	...	...	...	...	14	56	...	...	70	...	...	...	83
Kapurthala	1	2,061	39,095	...	33	314	...	...	9	12,937	28	2,347	...	...	...	...	8	155	...	163	...	1	...	...	...	51	...	9	...	61	...	...	...	224
Jind	3,104	7	2,353	...	...	...	...	2	291	529	5,023	...	...	8	3	12	...	9	...	21	...	...	...	...	1	2	20	...	...	23	...	...	..	44
Faridkot	12	73	2,294	...	1	...	...	...	...	4	153	106	...	...	...	...	1	23	...	24	...	...	...	...	...	...	2	1	...	3	...	...	...	27
Maler Kotla	...	...	1,738	...	...	...	...	...	...	4,570	24	...	...	...	...	...	...	24	...	24	...	...	...	...	...	64	...	...	...	64	...	...	...	88
Kalsia	3,069	...	2,879	...	14	...	...	3	...	749	39	...	...	...	...	45	...	43	...	88	...	...	...	...	...	11	1	...	...	12	...	...	...	100
Total East. Plains	13,180	10,017	93,041	153	14,251	642	...	42	330	45,855	58,946	2,474	...	189	3	5	4	37	...	46	6	...	...	...	...	18	23	1	...	48	...	...	...	94
Baháwalpur	...	...	29,031	...	...	...	...	...	...	.	...	5,766	...	...	...	...	...	51	...	51	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	...	3	...	...	...	54
Mandi	...	435	384	...	68,681	719	...	...	...	4	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	3	...	6	467	5	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	472	...	...	...	478
Chamba	5	1	...	...	...	96	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	11,161	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	96	96	97
Náhan	354	...	232	...	37,817	180	...	48	...	7	33	...	...	...	...	3	...	2	...	5	338	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	340	...	...	...	345
Biláspur	...	58	29	...	20,593	116	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	16	...	1	...	...	1	238	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	239	...	...	...	240
Bashahr	...	...	...	...	38,994	...	...	...	...	...	3	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	606	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	606	...	...	...	606
Nálagarh	2	1,915	92	...	13,913	680	...	...	...	49	...	...	...	3	...	...	36	2	...	38	255	13	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	269	...	...	...	307
Suket	...	169	370	...	21,830	24	...	...	...	1	...	...	...	...	...	...	3	7	...	10	416	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	416	...	...	...	426
Total Hill States	434	2,584	1,138	...	256,971	1,870	...	48	...	78	61	...	...	3	11,177	1	3	1	...	5	335	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	337	...	...	...	342
British Territory	52,102	140,031	676,831	81,063	74,553	157,740	1,993	8,537	1,928	83,656	114,633	47,140	4,426	3,351	6,242	3	7	36	4	50	4	8	...	...	...	4	6	3	...	25	...	...	...	75
re States	13,614	12,601	123,210	153	271,222	2,512	...	90	330	45,933	59,007	8,240	...	192	11,180	4	3	32	...	39	70	1	...	...	...	12	15	2	...	100	...	3	3	142
	65,716	152,632	800,041	81,216	345,775	160,252	1,993	8,627	2,258	129,589	173,640	55,380	4,426	3,543	17,422	3	7	36	4	50	15	7	...	...	...	6	8	2	...	38	...	1	1	89

In Kángra the Ráthi *als* are said to be Barjati, Kulái, Gharáti (a Khatri *al* in Chamba), and Sakhotru. The Rájás used to confer the *janeo* on Ráthis in return for presents and services, and this is why some of them still wear it.

Among the Thakkurs of Kángra are the Baráú, Harelu, Janwár, Marthán and Siúri *als*. Other *als* whose members do not wear the *janeo* (and are therefore presumably Thakkur too) are the Baghretu, Ghári, Tutári and Ugharetu.

The Gaddís are an interesting people, and offer a striking contrast in several respects to the other inhabitants of Chamba. The costume of the Gaddis, both men and women, is characteristic and striking. The old head-dress of the men is of a peculiar shape, with a flap round the margin, and a peak-like projection in the centre, said to represent the Kailás of Mani Mahes. The flap is tied up for ordinary wear, but let down over the ears and neck in time of mourning, as well as in severe weather. The front is often adorned with dried flowers or beads. But this head-dress is falling into disuse, save on special occasions its place being taken by the *pagri*. On the body a *pattú* coat called *chola*, reaching below the knee, is worn. It has a deep collar, which hangs loose in two lappets in front, and in the sewing the wearer stows away various articles, such as a needle and thread, pieces of paper and twine. The *chola* is tightened round the waist by a black rope worn as a waist-band. This is made of sheep's wool and is called *dora*. Above the waist-band the coat is loose, and in this receptacle the Gaddi carries many of his belongings. On the march a shepherd may have four or five lambs stowed away in his bosom, along with his daily food and other articles. The legs are generally bare, but many wear *pattú* paijámas, loose to the knees for the sake of freedom in walking, but fitting tight round the calf and ankle where it rests in numerous folds. Shoes are in common use. From the girdle hang a knife, a flint box and steel and a small leather bag, in which the wearer carries money and other small articles. The hill people are all fond of flowers, and in the *topi* or *pagri* may often be seen a tuft of the wild flowers in season, red berries, or other ornament. The chief ornament is the *tabit*, a square silver plate of varying size covered with carving and hung from the neck. Gaddi women wear a dress like that of the men, made of *pattú* and called *cholu*. It hangs straight, like a gown, from the neck to the ankles, and round the waist is the woollen cord or *dora*. A cotton gown of a special pattern is now common and is called *ghundu*. It is worn in the same way as the *cholu*. The head is covered with a *chadar*, and the legs and feet are bare. The Gaddi women wear special ornaments, of which the chief is the *galsari*, and sometimes a *tabit*, similar like the men. They also wear heavy brass anklets, called *ghunkare* which are peculiar to the Gaddi women.* The Gaddis say that they assumed the garb of Shiva and Párvati when they settled in Brahmaur which they call Shiv-bhúmi or Shiva's land, but it is not their dress alone that makes them conspicuous. Their whole bearing is characteristic, conveying an impression of sturdy independence which is fully borne out by closer contact with them. They are robust of frame, and accustomed to exposure in all weathers owing

* Brass anklets called *riháru*, are worn by Gaddi children to ward off the evil eye, and to prevent them from crying. They are made by the menial caste, named *riháru*, which is itself supposed to have the power of injuring children by sorcery.

to the migratory life so many of them lead. In their manners they are frank and open, deferential to their superiors and yet manly and dignified. They delight in festive gatherings, and are fond of singing and dancing—the latter in a style peculiar to themselves. Their women are pleasing and comely, and have the reputation of being also modest and chaste. The Gaddis are a semi-pastoral and semi-agricultural tribe, and own large flocks of sheep and goats, which are their chief source of wealth. With them they go far afield, the summers being spent in the higher mountains of Pángi and Láhul; and the winters in the low hills bordering on the plains. This duty the male members of the family take in turn, the others remaining at home to tend the cattle and look after the farm work. Many of them own land on both sides of the Dhaula Dhár, and reap the winter crop in Kángṛa, returning in spring to cut the summer crop in Brahmaur. On the whole they are better shepherds than farmers, and perhaps for this reason they are the most prosperous agricultural class in the State. The yearly exodus to Kángṛa takes place in October and November, and the return journey in April and May. With an appearance of candour and simplicity, the Gaddís have the reputation of being good at making a bargain; hence the saying in the hills—

Gaddi mitr bhola,
Denda tap to mangda chola.

"The Gaddi is a simple friend,
He offers his cap, and asks a coat in exchange."

The Gaddi wedding customs merit special notice.

In betrothal the boy's parents or guardians send their *parohit* to negotiate for a girl about whom they have information, and he brings back her parents' reply. If it is favourable the boy's parents send two or more respectable men to the girl's home to complete the bargain. Then if it is clinched, two of the boy's family go with the *parohit* to perform the ceremony. If the betrothal is *dharma puna* this consists in the bride's father giving the *parohit* a bunch of *drub* grass with four copper coins or more, if they please, to be handed over to the boy's father in token that the alliance is accepted. The *parohit* hands over the *drub*, and the coins are returned to the *parohit* with a rupee added by the boy's father. The night is spent at the bride's house, and after a meal her father gives the boy's father 8 copper coins and these he places in a vessel as a perquisite to the servant who cleans it. In a betrothal by exchange (*tola*) the first observances are the same, but when all go to finally complete the alliance a grindstone and *sil* with 3 or 5 *roris* of *gur*, *supári*, *bihan* and *roliyán** are placed before the party and then the *parohit* places *supári*, *bihan* and *roliyán* in the skirt of his sheet and puts them on the *sil*. Before tapping them on the *sil* with the grindstone he receives 4 annas from the boy's father and mentions the names of the boy and girl whose alliance is to be formed, and then taps them. After this the *supári*, etc., are placed in a vessel, with the balls of *gur* broken up, and distributed to those present after the girl's father has taken a bit. The elder members of the girl's family do not take any as it would be contrary to custom. The boy's father puts Re. 1-4 in this vessel and this is made over to the bride's parents

* *Roliyan* red colour for marking the *tika* on the forehead: *bihan*, coriander.

who get jewellery to that amount made for her. After this the bride appears before the boy's father and he gives her a rupee. The rest of the ceremony is exactly as described above, but in this case the coins put in the vessel come out of the boy's father's pocket. The ceremony in the other house is performed in exactly the same way, though not on the same day for the sake of convenience. A propitious date is not fixed, but a lucky day is desirable, and Tuesday, Friday and Saturday are considered unlucky.

After having the date for the wedding fixed by a *parohit* two men are sent to the girl's people with a *ser* of *ghi* to notify them of the date, and if they approve of it messengers from both sides go to the *parohit* and get him to write the *lakhnoteri*. For this he is paid 8 Chamba coins or 4 annas in cash, rice and some red tape (*dori*). At the wedding itself the *sumhurat* rite is first performed by worshipping Ganpati, *kumbh* * and the nine planets and then the *supári* (a mixture of turmeric, flour and oil) purified by *mantras* is rubbed on the boy. Three black woollen threads are also tied round his right wrist to protect him from the evil eye. He is then taken out into the court-yard by his mother, with part of her red sheet thrown over his head, to bathe. At the bath the black thread is torn off and he is led back by his mother. Next he must upset an earthen lid, containing burning charcoal and mustard placed at the entrance to the worshipping place, and this must be thrown away so as to remove any evil influence which he may have contracted in the court-yard. The *parohit* then ties nine red cotton threads round the boy's right wrist and gives him *ghi* and *gur* to taste. These wristlets are called *kangana*. This is preceded by the *tel-sand* ceremony. Again Ganpati, Brahma, Vishnu, *kumbh*, *dia* † and the nine planets are worshipped, and then a he-goat is sacrificed to the planets by the boy, its blood being sprinkled on the *sándori* (*bagar* grass rope) and *munj mála* (a ring of *bagar*). The *sándori* is then spread round the room along the cornice and the bridegroom made to don a white *dhoti* or sheet round his loins, to put flour *mundras* (*jogi's* ear-rings) in his ears, sling a satchel over his shoulder, tie a black woollen rope round his chests and cover his buttocks with an animal's skin, suspend a *fanani* (bow for carding wool) to the black rope and take a *timbar* stick in his right hand with a Brahminical thread tied round his right thumb. This dress is assumed so that he may appear a regular *jogi* (ascetic). After this the presiding priest asks him; 'why hast thou become a *jogi*?' His answer is 'to receive the Brahminical cord.' Then he is further interrogated by the priest as to what kind of cord he requires, *i.e.*, one of copper, brass, silver, gold, or cotton, and he asks for the latter. The priest then sends him to bathe at Badri Narain, Trilok Náth and Mani-Mahesha, and these supposed baths are taken in turn by dipping his hands and feet in, and pouring some water on his face from, a vessel put ready for the purpose in the door-way. After these ablutions the pretended *jogi* begs, first of his relations and then at the house, and they give him a piece of bread and promise him cattle, goats, etc., according to their means. In conclusion the priest asks him whether he wishes to devote himself to *játera*

* *Kumbh.* A small pitcher filled with water, is placed over a handful of rice and peach leaves or a few blades of *drub* are put into it. It is worshipped exactly like the *deotas*.

† *Dia.* A small earthen lamp with a burning wick is placed over a handful of rice and worshipped like the others.

Death Rites

Gaddis cremate their deads. Lepers and those who die of *luhar* (kind of typhus) are first burried but their corpses are exhumed after three months and burnt. The ceremonies are the same as for those who are cremated. The funeral procession is not accompanied by music even if some old person dies, but the mourners keep on chanting *Ram Nam Sat Hai Jo bole so gat hai* which means God is truth and he who remembers Him—attains *Nirvan*. Intimation of the death is given to relatives and friends by messengers who may be of any caste or community. In Brahmaur the dead are cremated on a pyre of mulberry wood which is collected from trees growing in the *Chaurasi* area and where a number of trees are reserved for each community. The cremation ground lies along the course of Brahmni Nullah and each caste has its own burning place. Thus Brahmans have their cremation ground first and a little lower is the place demarcated for Khatris and Rajputs. Lower down is the cremation ground for the Sipis. The only Rehara household has recently migrated to Brahmaur from a nearby village, and there is no cremation ground for Reharas. The body is placed on the funeral pyre with the head towards the north. Jewellery and blankets are taken off and the body is burnt. A copper coin is placed by the pyre as the tax of the land on which the body is burnt. Fire is applied to the pyre under the head by the nearest relative preferably by the eldest son or someone who belongs to the same *gotra* as the dead. Such a person is made to put on white clothes and has his head shaved off alongwith his face. This is called *bhadar*. The *purohit* joins the relations but no ceremonies are observed. The light is applied after going round the pyre once clock-wise. On the 10th day, the *daspindi* is performed. Other relations wash their clothes and bathe and roll up the blanket used for seating the mourners. On the 12th day, at night, a goat is sacrified in the deceased's name, and this is given to the *purohit*. Next morning five *pinds* made of barely or rice floor or one *supindi* are again offered in memory of the deceased. On this day clothes, utensils, cash are given to *purohit*. On the 14th day the deceased's relations on the wife's side come to the house in the morning and feast the relations and others. A goat is killed for this feast and the mourning period come to an end. At the end of the third month oblations are again offered to deceased and the occasion is signified by a feast to the brotherhood. The offering made on this ceremony go to the *purohit*. Similar ceremonies are gone through at the end of the sixth month and the 1st year (Barkhi) and 4th year (Chaubarkh) after the death. After the 4th year of the death, the dead assumes the status of a *pitr* and is remembered only during annual *shradhs* in the month of Asauj when for full fifteen days Brahmins are feasted on the dates corresponding to the death dates of the departed relations generally upto 3rd pedigree.

If burried, the body is laid flat in the grave with the back on the ground and the hands folded on the chest. The head is kept to the North. The ashes of the dead are carried to Hardwar. Bones of fingers, knees and ankle joints, seven of them are collected after cremation the same day. These are brought to the house in a piece of *masru*, red cloth and kept for ten days in the clothes in which the deceased breathed his last and in the room in which he expired. After the *daspindi*, they are washed in honey, milk, *ghee*, cowdung and *bilpatri* seeds and then dried and deposited in a small wooden box wrapped in a piece of *masru* and burried in a recess made in the wall of the house, with a coating of barley and mustard floor over it. They would be taken to Hardwar and immersed in Ganga as soon as convenient.

The ladies of the bereaved family do not unlike the urban areas, perform any organised *siapa* which entails the beating of forehead and breast. Their grief of course, is expressed in weeping, and ladies of the neighbourhood also gather to offer their consolation. But melodrama is conspicuous by absense. Neither do the ladies accompany the funeral procession nor do they go to the cremation ground.

3

ECONOMY

Economic Re es

BRAHMAUR represents a village with mixed economy. The people are not dependent upon any single profession and unlike most other Indian villages, agriculture is not the mainstay of the people. Out of 146 households, 47 households are officials posted there. Agriculture, however, is followed by 92 households and 48 of these households rear sheep and goats which brings them more income than agriculture. With some households, rearing of sheep and goats in fact is the main occupation, and agriculture is the subsidiary profession. Other subsidiary professions are also followed and these are labour, business, mule-driving, blacksmithy, silversmithy, running of *gharats* and carpentry. There is no weaver by occupation itself although weaving is done by almost every household. The sale of surplus *gardus* and *patties* also brings them additional income. The money earned during migration also constitutes a welcome addition to the family income and as many as 61 households earn their livelihood from October to March working at odd jobs outside the village. These, in short, are the main sources of income of the people of the village. It may be conceded at the very outset that it is not possible for an investigator to elicit correct information from the villagers in the matter of their income and expenditure. They do not keep any proper accounts, nor are they able to give correct figures as they cannot count even upto hundred which they count as five twenty (*panj beese*), and 80 they count as four twenty (*char beese*), and so on. When these questions about income and expenditure are put to them, they at once become suspicious and close like an oyster. They harbour a lurking fear that perhaps these uncomfortable questions about their most personal affairs are asked with some ulterior motives—may be more taxes are in the offing or one may be called upon to pay certain donations and the like. An effort has been made to gather as much information as possibly could be done under the circumstances. On account of construction of approach road to Brahmaur and extraction of timber from forests, and construction of government buildings at Brahmaur and nearabout, new avenues of income have also been thrown open to them and 8 able-bodied persons are working there as unskilled labour at a daily wage of about Rs. 2/-

The income from agriculture is not much and according to the villagers, even the food-grains that they grow are not sufficient to go far. This is why they have to migrate for the winter months. Horticulture does not exist, excepting some little walnuts which bring in very little return. Other local fruits like *cheeds*, are not saleable and are consumed by the people. As the climate and height of Brahmaur is suited to apple cultivation, people are slowly planting these trees, and it is hoped that in the near future, horticulture will also be a source of some income to them. There are some excellent apples and peaches grown in one of the Naga Baba's *batika*. Gaddis, as a lot, are a conservative people, and do not easily take to new ideas. They have their established routine and would not like to deviate from it unless they are assured of more return from the new undertaking. Their habit of migration also takes about 2 months in transit both ways and consequently this dead weight has an adverse effect on their yearly earnings. Brahmaur is a sizeable village in this part of the country and one should have expected that the creative urge of the people would have manifested itself in some peculiar art developed here and

that it should have been of great help to augment income of the people but excepting one shop of a silversmith, and few blacksmiths which are found almost in every village to cater to their agricultural needs the villagers do not pursue any remunerative craft except the weaving which they follow to weave their woollen cloth and *gardus*. Someone might be able to produce at occasions spare *gardus* to sell, but this is not a regular profession followed by the people in general. Even in the matter of agriculture, the devotion of a son of soil is lacking and sowing of the *rabi* crop is done slightly casually. They are, however, at their best as shepherds and the sale of wool which a full grown sheep yields to the tune of about 2 srs. a year in three annual shearings, once in Phagun, the second in Ashadh and the third in Kartik, brings in sufficient amount to the village in terms of per capita income. There are 4484 sheep and goats in the village owned by 48 households and on a most conservative estimate, if the number of sheep be reckoned at half the number of total sheep and goats, the yearly wool production from them should be in the neighbourhood of about 4484 srs. and at a cost of Rs. 5/- per seer of raw wool, this should bring an income of about Rs. 22,000/- a year. The income from the sale of lambs, goats, each of which fetches from Rs. 30/- to Rs. 50/- on an average, is in addition to the earnings from the sale of wool. It would, thus, appear that the rearing of sheep and goats and sale of raw wool deserves to be regarded as the main profession in terms of money return. There is, however, a limit to this source of income as the Forest Department do not now grant any additional permit for more sheep and goats.

Out of total population of 720 persons, 339 are workers and the number of non-workers is 381. Out of 381 non-workers, 280 are from 0 to 14 age group. Similarly, in the age group 15—34, out of 65 non-workers, 16 are men and 49 women. The women are engaged in household work or in spinning wool whereas out of 16 male non-workers, 13 are students. The 9 male non-workers in the age group 35—59 are not regular workers, as neither they have sufficient land to keep them busy throughout the year nor can they find full time jobs. In fact it will be correct to call them partial-workers instead of non-workers. These males are partially dependent on other members of their households. In the age group of 60 and above only one male has been returned as non-worker and this shows that even old men lend a helping hand and as many as 20 of them are employed in agriculture. The number of women non-workers in this group is large as arduous duties in youth and middle age coupled with frequent child births more or less completely exhausts them when they cross their fifties.

Workers and Non-workers

Workers and non-workers in the Village

Age group	Total Population			Workers			Non-workers		
	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
All ages . . .	720	381	339	339	212	127	381	169	212
0—14 . . .	283	145	138	3	2	1	280	143	137
15—34 . . .	274	144	130	209	128	81	65	16	49
35—59 . . .	122	70	52	100	61	39	22	9	13
60 & over . . .	41	22	19	27	21	6	14	1	13

wild apricot locally called *cheedh* does not bring them any return in money value, but is useful for local consumption and the kernel, in the absence of any other oil seed, is utilised for extraction of *cheedh* oil. This is not only used as cooking medium but also utilised for other purposes. The number of walnut trees is not large and the produce does not help the villagers much except that it adds a little to their earnings. Sometimes, walnut oil also serves as cooking medium. The limited land holdings do not permit of a bright future for horticulture in this area unless the villagers themselves decide to convert their agricultural fields into orchards. If someone starts earning a sizeable income from fruit trees, it is sure to catch the eye of others, but till then and till Brahmaur is connected with outside world by a motorable road, horticulture, it is apprehended, is not going to be very popular with the people. Their wander lust is also a stumbling block in the development of horticulture as they feel that the fruit trees will keep them tied to their homes and they will have to forego the income which they at present earn during their migration period. The orthodox attitude of apathy towards anything new is slowly but steadily undergoing a change and people are gradually veering round to the view that their small holdings will give them much better return if put under fruit trees, when this view point takes a firm root on a much wider scale, we can expect this area to be converted into a fine apple producing area.

Animal Husbandry

Besides rearing sheep and goats, the villagers also keep cattle, mainly bulls and cows. There are only 123 bulls and 116 cows in the village. No one keeps a buffalo as the climate is not conducive to the proper rearing of buffalo. Once a villager brought a buffalo, but he was not happy with the experience as the milk yield suddenly dropped from 9 srs. to 4 srs. and the buffalo had to be taken to low hills before winter.



The following table gives the number of cows and bulls as well as pack animals kept by the villagers community-wise—

Caste	Total No. of house-holds	Cows		Bulls		Pack animals	
		No. of house-holds owning cows	Total No. of cows	No. of house-holds owning bulls	Total No. of bulls	No. of house-holds owning pack animals	Total Number
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Brahman	34	20	45	23	52	1	2
Rajput	49	26	52	28	49	9	10
Sipi	15	12	19	9	22	1	1
Rehara	1	..	..	..	..	..	..
Total .	99	58	116	60	123	11	13

The total number of cows is not enough to ensure an adequate milk supply to the population of the entire village and, accordingly they suffer from lack of this important diet. The breed of the cattle is very poor and the milk yield per cow is also very small which ranges from ½ sr. to 1 sr. approximately. The lack of adequate number of cows is attributed by the villagers to their migrating nature as well as the lack of adequate pastures for them. There are only 13 acres of pasture land and acting upon the old maxim "everybody's property is nobody's property", the villagers do not care to properly look after it. The cattle are mainly fed on green leaves of *ban* trees and maize stalks which are stored either in *saal, dragra* or on the branches of some walnut trees. The cattle are sometimes also let loose to feed on the grass growing on the fringes of the fields. This is incidentally also the major cause of many minor disputes between the farmers as sometimes cattle stray into the fields also.

There is a Veterinary Centre in the village. The centre is housed in a rented building, but now a new building for it is under construction. It is staffed by a qualified veterinary supervisor and a compounder. Medicines are also supplied free and in emergent cases the services of the staff can also be requisitioned at the house, on payment of the prescribed fee. This centre has been supplied with a red Sindhi stud bull for cross breeding and a number of cows of local hill breed are reported to have been crossed. The incharge of the centre is very hopeful of good results. During migration, the people carry their cattle with them if there is none-else to look after them in their absence and the long trek both ways tells upon their health very much.

No poultry is kept in Brahmaur proper because it is apprehended that the birds will defile the sacred Chaurasi area. People don't consider taking eggs and fowls as taboo, and in other villages situated around Brahmaur, many have taken to keeping poultry. Some even take these birds in baskets with them on their migration to the lower hills. In the absence of proper and adequate milk diet, the keeping of poultry seems to be essential for the people who have started realising this fact and it is hoped that in near future, adequate number of poultry birds will be reared by the people which will offer a welcome addition to the proteinous diet to their food which is at present woefully lacking.

The common cattle diseases are given below together with their local equivalents and the treatment applied locally—

English Name	Local Name	Indigenous treatment
Foot and Mouth disease	Khareru	Kerosene oil
Pluro pneumonia	Fotka	*Kahra*
Tympony	Aphara	Charcoal
Impection	Baank	Soap & Ash with water
Bronchitis	Khansi	Sundh and pepper
Mange	Charad	Palm Oil
Rinderpest	Manwan	Nil

The common sheep and goat diseases and the indigenous treatment given is—

English Name	Local Name	Indigenous treatment
Caprina pneumonia	Folka	Salt
Mange	Charad	Palm Oil

The gaddis pay more attention to the rearing of goats and sheep and since this constitutes a major source of income. The subject deserves elaborate treatment. The number of goats and sheep-reared by the villagers is 4484, and the following table shows the ownership community-wise—

Caste/Community	Total No. of households	No. of households possessing sheep or goats	No. of sheep or goats possessed
1	2	3	4
Brahman . . .	34	20	2,027
Rajput . . .	49	20	2,364
Sipi . . .	15	8	93
Rehara . . .	1	..	..
Total .	99	48	4,484

Malundi and Pohals and their Migration Calendar

Malundi and Pohals—From the number of sheep and goats possessed by these people

it can be easily surmised that they have to depute one or more men to shepherd the flock. *Malundi* or owner of the *mal is* a shepherd who tends his own flock. But if someone is hired to look after the flock on wages, he is called a *pohal* which appears to have been derived from *Pashupal* or *Gaupal*. *Pohals* are hired in summer season by a very few people in rare cases when they cannot spare some one from amongst the family to look after the flock. There is yet another custom prevalent in Brahmaur about tending the flock. If the number of sheep and goats is small and it is not possible for some one from amongst the family to be exclusively available for looking after the flock, then this flock is entrusted to another *malundi* in summer seasons, on payment of some fee to be mutually agreed upon. The *pohals*, when hired, are given (1) free meals, (2) free clothing and wool for the family, (3) two or four sheep per hundred sheep and goats and (4) Rs. 2/- in cash per month as wages. In this way a *malundi* can look after his own flock and in addition thereto he also tends the flock of one or two others. The entire family of a *malundi* does not follow the flock. One or two persons, as already stated, look after this, and others remain at home to look after the fields.

The *malundi* takes the flock to pastures and if the pastures are situated not at a distant place, he returns to the village every night. Such pastures are locally called *tarkals* and are situated in the Brahmni forests near Brahmaur. These *tarkals* are not sufficient for the upkeep of the entire sheep and goat wealth of the village and people have therefore to migrate to other pastures.

Migration calendar—The *malundis* as well as the *pohals* keep constantly migrating between the low hills and the inner mountains of Pangi and Lahaul alongwith their flocks. In the beginning of the winter (October and November), the flocks are driven to the low hills of Kangra, Nurpur, Pathankot and Jammu. For winter grazing no *malundi* or *pohal* is hired by any one and this work is tended by one of the members of the households. In the spring season (April), the flocks are driven back to the village where these are utilised to manure the fallow land. During the state period the Ruler of the state used to lease out the pastures near the village (Brahmani in case of Brahmaur) on contract. The contractor further used to allot these pastures to the shepherds subject to the condition that they would keep their sheep and goats in the fallow cultivable fields at night. In return the owner of the fields used to give grains to the contractor who further passed on half of the grains so collected to the shepherd concerned as his share. Thus the contractor had double advantage. Now, the pastures are allotted direct to the shepherds by the Forest Department. This does not impose upon the shepherd the obligation of keeping his flocks in the fields for manuring purposes. Therefore, the practice of keeping the sheep and goats in the fallow cultivated fields belonging to the villagers other than those who do not possess such livestock has vanished, as the link (contractor) between the shepherds and such owners of land has now vanished.

The flocks are kept in the village for a short period of 20 to 25 days in a month and they have *tarkal* as their pasture-land. For Brahmaur, Brahmani forest serves as *tarkal*. It is about 2 miles from Brahmaur. It would not be out of place to mention that the practice of bringing back the flock to the village at night is also on the decline. After grazing them on the *tarkal*, they are driven for the summer grazing. It is for this grazing season that *malundis* or *pohals* are engaged by those who cannot spare one of the members of their households for this purpose. The flocks are led over to the pastures in inner mountains of Pangi and Lahaul. These pastures are called *dhars*. There they remain for two months. It is interesting to note that each shepherd has his own fixed *dhar* which only he can use as pasture land for his flock consisting of a fixed number of sheep and goats. The Forest Department is discouraging the multiplication of the number of such animals and to implement this they do not issue grazing permits for more than a fixed number of goats and sheep. This attitude of the Department has created great dissatisfaction among the shepherds as they are charged a penalty of Re. 1/- per head of sheep or goat for which they do not possess the grazing permit. On the other hand the Forest Department are of the view that such checks are necessary to check overgrazing and resultant erosion. They also point out that the pasture land or the *dhars* with them are the same whereas the number of sheep and goats keeps on increasing and now a stage has arrived that it would be at the cost of the rich forests if grazing permits are issued for more sheep and goats.

Taxes—The grazing tax charged from the shepherds is Rs. 15/- per hundred heads of sheep or goats for the summer season. A shepherd has to pay the grazing tax twice a year. In the beginning of September, the return journey over the Pangi and Lahaul ranges commences and the flocks are driven

back to the *tarkals*. After staying there for 15 to 20 days, they migrate to the low lying pastures in Nurpur, Kangra, Pathankot and Jammu.

Shearing—Out of the total of 4484 sheep and goats possessed by the villagers, approximately half are sheep. The shepherds shear the wool thrice a year, in the months of Phalgun (March), Asadh (June-July) and Kartik (September-October). Before shearing, the sheep are given a bath and the shepherd observes a fast. Once this is done when they have a halt in the village *tarkals* and twice while in low-lying areas. From a case study, it is revealed that the average yield of wool from a sheep is 8 to 12 *chhataks*. Those who have larger number of sheep to shear generally employ Sipis of the village who do not possess such livestock. The Sipis employed for the purpose are paid in kind i.e. wool, the rate being wool yield of one sheep for shearing 25 sheep. During the last shearing season, a Sipi who is also a blacksmith was employed for the purpose by a shepherd. In all he (Sipi) sheared 125 sheep and thus got the yield of wool from 5 sheep.

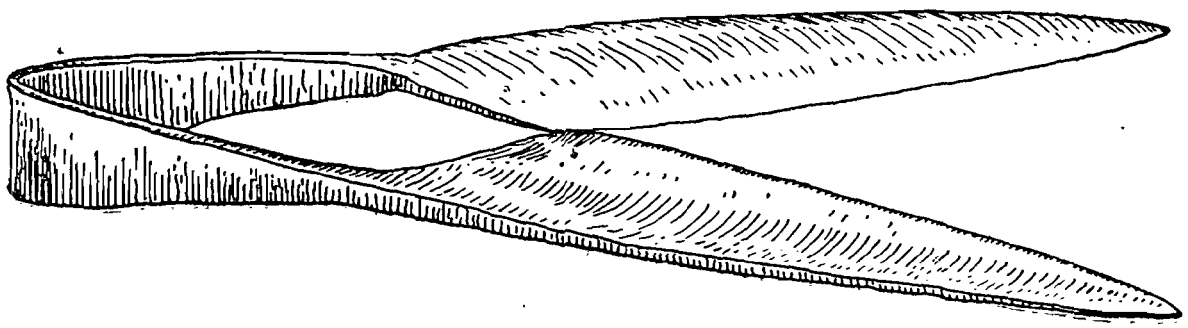
General—While on the move, a *malundi* travels very light and generally 2 or 3 *malundis* travel in a group. They have very little of personal belongings with them and do not carry any spare clothes except the one that they have on. They generally go without their traditional *suthan* that they wear in Brahmaur. A rough type of desi-shoe (*juta*) is enough as their foot-wear and of course the traditional *chola* with the inevitable *dora* wound round the waist is worn by all of them, along with the cap on the head. A peculiar aspect of the *chola* worn by these *malundis* is that the *chola* must conform to the colour of the wool surrendered by the flock. If the wool is white then the *malundi* must wear a white *chola* and if the wool is grey he must wear a grey *chola* and thus the shepherd identifies himself with his flock. The *malundi* while on move with his flock also carries a few utensils to cook. These utensils are mostly of aluminium excepting a *tawa* of iron, which is used for cooking *makki-ki-roti*. Every *malundi* carries a *hooka*, which he puffs even while on the move. The *hooka* is of *nariyal* type. A *malundi* leads a most primitive type of life which he leads unmindful of comforts. It is a hard life indeed.

While on move he sleeps in open either under a projecting rock or under the shade of a tree or under the clear sky, when the sky is cloudy he might take shelter in a cave. This is all the protection that he has against nature. For bedding, he has one or two *gardus* which are very thick warm and also to a great extent water-proof. The *dora* wound round the waist serves as a pillow and he passes his night huddled under the cover of a *gardu*.

He cooks his simple meals which consist of maize flour bread which he takes with salt or green chillies. It is very occasionally that he cooks *dal* or any vegetable. Sometimes a raw onion serves for the *salad*.

Since he has plenty of milk from his goats, he makes full use of it and also cooks *khir* (rice and milk boiled together to a thick consistency). He generally cooks his meals before packing up for a move to another halting station and carries it with him to be eaten as and when he feels inclined to do so.

He also transits business on his way and whenever he feels like it he sells, some goat or sheep. Every *malundi* must have a pair of sheep dogs locally called 'Gaddi dog'. This special type of breed is eminently suited as watch dogs. They are so fearsome that they



Shearing Scissors

1. The Village

Introduction

Kanum is one of the 77 villages of the newly formed 6th District, Kinnaur, in Himachal Pradesh. It is a big village in Poo Sub-Division. Out of total No. of 32 villages in the Sub-Division bordering Tibet, Kanum has a population of 701 souls comprising 350 males and 351 females.

Most of the district of Kinnaur with an area of 2,579 square miles is a high land of towering mountains of mighty ranges of the Himalayas. During the pre-independence period it was a part of the former Bushahr State and administratively constituted sub-Tehsil of Chini. After independence when the princely Hill States were merged into Himachal Pradesh, most of them formed Mahasu District. The Kinnaur District was formed on the 1st May, 1960 as a result of administrative reorganisation of the border area to ensure speedy and intensive development of this inaccessible area. In addition to the former tehsil comprising 63 villages, 14 villages from Rampur Tehsil of the Mahasu District were added to them to form a new district with Headquarters at Kalpa.

Kanum is about 33 miles from Kalpa. Surrounded by peaks capped with perpetual snow, it lies nestled peacefully in the lap of hills far away from Simla at an elevation of 9,600 ft. The village has been built up on terraced land and the River Sutlej flows about 2 miles below. It lies approximately in the longitude 78°-28′ E and latitude 31°-40′ N. The Sub Divisional Headquarters are at Poo, which is 16 miles farther away. The Hindustan Tibet Road, which was until recently a mule track, has been opened for jeeps about a year back. The new national high-way, which is under the construction passes about 2 miles down the village along the right bank of Sutlej.

About 6 miles from Kalpa one has to pass a bridge over Kashang Khud. Another bridge over Kirank Khud about 5 miles from Jangi, has to be crossed. At Kanum there is a PWD rest house.

Hemmed in by hills Kanum is pleasantly situated. Near upon the brow of a hill, which descends too precipitously, and surrounded by walnuts, wild apricots, bemi, muldum, palu, mangal, chilgoza and other green trees, the village presents a beautiful view when one approaches 'Sumchho Gori' as the cluster of the few villages including Kanum, is known locally. On the very rugged and uneven slopes the village 'abadi' is known as lower Kanum, central Kanum and upper Kanum.

Sven Hedin in his Travelogue TRANS HIMALAYA Vol. III while putting down his magnificent experience of discoveries and adventures made a reference about *Kanam*. A relevant paragraph is reproduced here:—

"From a commanding promontory where the Cairn Kanam—Laptse—stands, we enjoy for a moment a magnificent prospect. Deep down in a side valley lies the village of Kanam and farther off Pill and other villages. But the finest sight is the background formed by the nearest snow clad summits of a Huge Himalayan massive which is known by the famous name of Kailash. In the peculiar illumination and in an

atmosphere apparently saturated with warm vapour, its fern covered peaks make a deep and imposing effect. Steely blue clouds and round white fleeces form white beds round the higher parts of the mountains, and the blinking white summits rise above this sea of aerial surge".

In the 'Sumchho Gori' there are only 3 villages Kanum, Labrang and Spillo. The 4th village Karla, smaller than all the three, is a part of Spillo. All these villages are at a distance of 2 to 3 miles from one another. The people inhabiting Kanum are Rajputs, Kolis, Lohars and Carpenters locally called Ores and used to be Hindus but with the passage of time and severence of all connections with other Hindus now call themselves Buddhists. The Buddhist influence becomes more and more pronounced towards the frontier.

Reasons for Selection

(1) The economic, social and cultural study of the inhabitants of Kanum will represent that of a major portion of the sub division bordering Tibet.

(2) The language and the economic conditions of the people are different from those living in other parts of Himachal in a number of ways.

(3) Like other villages, agriculture is the main source of income in the village, but sheep and goat rearing is of great importance to the villagers and a study of these factors would supply valuable material.

(4) It is a fair sized village with a population of 701 persons. Agriculture though a principal occupation cannot produce enough to meet the requirements of the inhabitants. The villagers engage themselves in sheep and goat rearing as in trade involving exchange of produce of their country wool, woollen patties, chilgoza, goat and sheep with grains. Some work on the road side.

(5) The study would reveal customs of the area.

(6) Inhabited by Negis, Rajputs, Kolis, Lohars and Ores the village represents multi-ethnic composition groups and the study of inter relationship and interdependence of these castes would be of interest especially in view of the remoteness of the place.

(7) It was until recently quite away from the modern means of communication. The District and Tehsil Headquarters are 33 and 16 miles on the Western and Eastern directions from the village and the important business centre Rampur is 104 miles. The region is cut off from the stream of life which is flowing in the rest of the country. Thus their religious, social and cultural life has so far remained un-interrupted and unsophisticated for centuries. Its study will bring to light certain new facts of life of a tribal community.

Agriculture is the main stay of the villagers and other occupations such as weaving carpentry and blacksmithy are affected by the measure of its prosperity as weavers, carpenters and Lohārs, get their wages in kind. During winter people migrate to lower hills alongwith their flocks laden with chilgozas, wool, woollen patties, nuts, pasham, jira and other local herbs which are sold by them either in Lavi fair at Rampur or in the villages in Sirmur, Seoni, Arki, Suket, Bilaspur and Mehlog in their camping places. Apart from these activities they work as labourers onth e roads and buildings. During May, June they return from the lower hills taking with them salt, cereals, ghee and other requirements. The well-to-do people of the village used to go to Gartok in Tibet and buy wool, pasham, jira, sheep and goat. This trade has now practically come to an end.

Legend

There is a legend about this village. The story which was handed down from his forefathers to Chhering Jit Negi an elderly member of the village goes like this. "Long long ago Kanum was thinly populated and the village was confined to what is now central Kanum. There used to be a main gate to the village and every body here had to put off his shoes outside the main gate. A ghost used to visit the village and he would count the shoes. In case there was any additional pair of shoes, he would kill the visitor. Thus no body would dare to visit the village and its population did not increase much. When the villagers felt fed up with the Ghost they prayed before the village deity Dabla for deliverance. The Dabla proposed to marry his sister to the Ghost. It is believed that since the marriage of Dabla's sister with the ghost he never killed any body and its abadi has increased since. This led to the setting up of upper Kanum and all the houses there, more than one third of the whole village were constructed thereafter."

History and Name of the Village

Apart from the legend some village elders gave the version that some body migrated from lower hills and settled there. The man belonged to Lactas Lineage of which there are about 12 families, the largest of any other ancestry. This

version is further supported by the history of the village given in *shajra nasab* recorded at the time of settlement in Sambat 1982 BK corresponding to 1926 A.D. An Urdu version of the statement of the villagers in Devnagri Script is as follows—

व्यान मालकान दफा अवल-हसूली मलकीयत तकसीम अवलीन जमीन-पहले इस जगह लकटस खानदान खांगटा टीकर गड़ परगना नावर से आकर आवाद हुवा उसने अपने हमरा एक कोली देवटी चामंग लाया मोसमीयान आला हम मालिक मुकतलिफ जगह से आकर आवाद हुए क्योंकि यह जगह हमवार कशावा ऊफतादा थी हसव इजाजत आलि मालिक आवाद हो कर अराजी वंजर को सर दो करने गये और आला मालिक से इजाजत भी हासिल की, जिस कदर आवादि बड़ती गई उसी कदर अराजी वंजर को भी सरदो करते गये। पहले नौतोर की वावत कोई वंदिश नहीं थी। आला मालिक की एकदफा इजाजत लेकर अराजी ममलूका खुत काशत हसव मर्जी किया करते थे। तकसीम हिसस जदी पर हुइ वाद अजा चुंके रकवा गैर आवद बहुत था हसब इस्ततायत खुद व हसब इजाजत मालिक आला, हरएक ने रकवा गैर आवदा को नौतोर करके राजी मकबुजा को वढ़ा लिया। इसलिये हिस्से जदी का अमल जाता रहा-अब हरएक शवस मालिक कब्जा है। देहजा में कोई अराजीयात् सामलात मासवाए चरान्द आवादी रास्ता व वावड़ी आवनोशी वगैरा के नहीं है और रकबा चरान्द के तकसीम करने का कोई दस्तूर नहीं है। अगर कोई रकबा-वंजर चरान्द से ज्यादा हो तो हसब दरखास्त मालिक आला की इजाजत से नौतोड़ कर सकते हैं। रकबा शामलातदेह में वाज़ वाज़ टुकड़े ऐसे हैं कि जो किसी खास मालिक के मकबुजा हो उन टुकड़ों की वावत वही मालिक करार दिया गया है कि जिसके कब्जा में कोई ऐसा टुकड़ा वाका हो चक हजा में दाखिल खार्ज का भी अमल है।

विनाए आवादि के आवदि देह वमच वजा तस्मींया :—

चूंके मुरूस आलिखानदान लकटस विलाहसूल हकीयत इस जगह आवाद होते हुए वञ्जर अराजी को काशत करते वक्त उसको एक खूवसूरत पत्थर मिला-उस पत्थर पर लफज (का) लिखा हुवा था उसने उसको परमात्मा समझ कर घर लाया। अरसा के वाद जब कोई लामा तिव्बत से उसके घर में आया तो उसने वह पत्थर उस लामा से दिखाया। लफज् का- तिव्वति का लफज् था। लामा ने कहा कि तिव्वति जमान में लफज(का) को परमात्मा या राजासाहिब वहादूर का हुकम कहते हैं। इस वजह से इस चक्र का नाम कानम् मशहूर हुआ जो अभी तक मशहूर चला आता है।

जिकर अदाए मालगुजारी व तरीका वाच :— पहले इस गांव की मालगुजारी किसी पैमाने से वाच न थी। हसब मर्जी मालिक आला व वक्तन फौकतन तफरीक हुवा करती थी। वहरहाल कमीवेशी का अखत्यार मालिक आला का था। उस वक्त माल गुजारी नकदी कम दाखिल करते थे लेकिन गल्ला, तेल, घी वगैरा अजनास की तफरीक ज्यादा हुवा करती थी। वल्कि हसव मालिक आला को किसी साल में व वाईस किसी काम रियास्त के जरूरत खर्च ज्यादा हुवा करती थी यानि आमदनी से मुकर्रा खर्च ज्यादा बढ़ जाता था तो ऐसी ऐसी वेशी अखराजात की अदायगी के हम मालकान जिम्मेवार रहते थे जो कि सम्वत १९३३ में हसव हैसियत जिमीदारान मामला तकसीम किया गया उस वक्त माल गुजारी नकदी व गल्ला वगेरा जो अठाड़ा (ठाड़ा वेगार) किरायल के नाम से मशहुर है वमय खिदमत मालिक आला कायम हुवा जोकि हतौज दाखिल खजाना करते हैं। मगर अशलाए कमी वेशी मालगुजारी का दस्तूर नाहाल वरावर जारी है यानि जब आमदनी मुकतर्रा खर्च से ज्यादा हो जाता है तो हम मालकान मतवातर वजरिया वाछ वसूल करते हैं और दिगर अखराजात संगीन मसलन शादी व गमी और जमार वन्दी सोसाटी का साहिव गद्दीनशीनी व खर्च भीमाकाली छःहवूव रियास्त इलावा मालगुजारी के अदा किऐ जाते हैं।

English Translation

Statement regarding ownership and division of land..... First of all niembers of Lactas family came from Khangta Tikkargarh Pargna Nawar (in Tehsil Rohru, District Mahasu) and settled here. They brought with them a Koli, Deoti Chamang. "We other owners finding this place level and flat came and settled here, coming from different places, and with the permission of the primary owner (the Ruling Chief of the erstwhile Bushahr State) we brought under cultivation the barren and uneven land. With the increase in population more barren land was brought under the plough. Previously there were no restrictions regarding grant of nautors. After taking the permission of the Primary owner once, the settlers used to plough more land according to their needs. The land so acquired was partitioned among the descendants, but after that because there was enough of uncultivated land, everybody according to his capacity brought more nautor under his possession with the permission of the Primary owner. Therefore, no trace of the original partitioning can be found and everybody is the recorded owner of the land actually in his possession. There is no common land except

3. Economy

Economic Resources

The economy of the village based on human labour and unaided by any mechanical devices rolls on at a snail's pace. Villagers are always humming with activity which mainly whirls around agriculture, their principal occupation. Other occupations such as weaving, carpentry and blacksmithy are affected by the measure of agricultural prosperity as weavers, carpenters and Lohars get their wages in kind, though they own small holdings too. Agricultural produce of the entire village is not sufficient to feed them and to meet their requirements. They engage themselves in variegated occupations such as manual labour, sheep and goat rearing, donkey and mule driving as also in trade involving the exchange of produce of their country viz, wool, woollen patties, chilgoza, goat and sheep with corns of all kinds either in the Lavi Fair at Rampur or in their respective camping places in Karsog, Bilaspur, Arki, Seoni, Mehlog and Sirmur. On their journey back they load their goats and sheep with small bags made of goats' hair



Shearing

slung over the back and bring back salt, wheat, maize, rice, pulses, ghee and other necessities of life which are not available in the area. Prior to the India-China dispute Shipki-La Pass was open to all traders without passport, customs and without let or hindrance and some of the well-to-do villagers enjoyed this facility but no more do caravans of mules, flocks of sheep and goats and ladden human beings now wind through the cavernous openings of Shipki-La. Pasham, jeera, medicinal herbs, goats and sheep were the main items which they imported from Tibet in exchange of cereals and in cash payment as well. Main occupation of *Negis* is agriculture, goat and sheep rearing. Chamangs take to weaving as their main occupation. Carpenters are traditional manufacturers of agricultural implements, wooden utensils and masons. They work as 'baskisa' and get small remuneration for this work too. Domangs follow blacksmithy and silversmithy. The construction of roads and other Govt. bulidings has thrown open other avenues of livelihood for these people and an unskilled worker gets a daily wage of Rs. 3 at present.

Goats and sheep are reared by all the Negi families. Only 5 to 6 households amongst the scheduled castes have small number of goats and sheep which they keep with the flocks of the Negis. Sheep are sheared twice a year whereas goats are sheared only once. This Industry is patronised by the people rather on an intensive scale, because it provides them not only with wool and goat hair but as well meat. Healthy goats are employed as carriers of commodities. This results in a lot of saving to them. For storing cereals and other odds and ends bags of goat skin are used. These skins are also used as mattresses to sleep on.

Occupational Pattern

Out of 19 Chamang households, weaving and woollen shoe making is practised by 17 families. Twelve households do both weaving and farming and 5 of them live by weaving alone because they do not posses any land. Two Chamang families neither possess land nor do they have pitlooms. They either work as agricultural labourers or earn their living on the road construction work. In addition to their main profession, Chamangs work as whole-time or part-time servants in the Rajput houses. Their women are employed as 'Rigries' by the Rajputs and some men as 'Fawals'. It is not always necessary that *'rigries'* and *'fawals'* should be appointed from amongst the scheduled castes only; even Rajputs work as such, 'Rigries' and fawals are engaged for a period of one year from the 'Lossar' fair. A settlement regarding their wages is reached beforehand for entire year. A rigri according to the prevalent rate is given 80 'brekhangs', a wooden measure of about 2 seers of cereals, 6 seers of raw wool, a pair of leather shoes and woollen shoes, Rs. 2 in cash and daily meals. In addition to this she is allowed paid leave for 2 months during winter. Wages in the case of a 'fawal' for one year are, Rs. 100 cash, clothes including shoes, daily meals. However, some of the 'fawals' get Rs. 200 in cash. Tailoring and shoe repairing is also undertaken as subsidiary occupation by 2 to 3 housekols.

Badhis follow carpentry as their main occupation, besides agriculture and flour milling which are their subsidiary occupations. There are only 3 households of 'badhis' and out of them 2 possess very small holdings of land and one family does not have even that much. They are either employed as manufacturers of wooden parts of the agricultural implements or as masons-cum-carpenters for house construction work. Their women attend to gharats and charge at the rate of $2\frac{1}{2}$ seers for grinding every maund of cereals. At the time of fairs, festivals, and religious occasions they play on musical instruments and this also supplements their economy to a little extent.

Domangs are occupied with blacksmithy and silversmithy. All the 3 households are engaged in this and one of them owns a little land. Besides agricultural implements, they make musical instruments and all items of jewellery and silver cups too. Tibetan type silver cups are the best pieces of craftsmanship of the Domangs of this village and their major earning is from silversmithy rather than blacksmithy.

In brief these are the economic sources of the people. All sections of the village community have been granted concession under forest settlement to collect chilgoza cones from the forest and extract seeds therefrom. The seeds thus collected are either sold at Lavi Fair at Rampur or consumed by them and some of them carry these as presents to their friends in the lower hills when they go there in winter. In addition to these permanent sources of income the villagers have found a new avenue of employment as labourers on the huge construction programme of roads, and buildings. Irrespective of caste or sex people have availed of this opportunity during the last about 5 years and consequently their economy has considerably improved. The well-to-do Zamindars were often observed showing concern about the changes and they found it difficult to engage labourers to attend to their sheep and goats. Men and women now prefer to work on the roads rather than work as 'fawals', agricultural labourers and *'rigries'* for obvious reason that they get better wages. With

the opening of a jeepable road to Poo the movement of the people has considerably increased and 3 local Rajputs have started shops in the village, thus breaking away from their traditional occupations.

It was observed that they were far better in their new occupations. The table given here shows households engaged in cultivation industry or business: —

Total No. of Households	Households engaged in Cultivation only	Households engaged in Industry only	Households engaged in Business only	Households engaged in Cultivation, Industry and Business	Households engaged in Cultivation and Industry	Households engaged in Cultivation and Business	Other occupations
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
113	63	8	..	..	14	3	25

63 households are engaged in cultivation whereas 8 are occupied in industry, weaving, carpentry and blacksmithy and none of them owns land. Fourteen households employed in cultivation and industry are mainly those who possess small holdings and besides their traditional occupations they do agriculture work as well. Similarly 3 families run business in addition to farming. Twenty five families engaged in other occupations include Govt. servants posted in the village and some labourers. From this it is apparent that out of a total number of 113 households 63 are purely those of agriculturists and 17 carry on with some other occupations in addition to agriculture, and the rest of 33 households are non-agriculturists.

Caste-wise division of occupations is as follows: —

Caste	Occupation	Households
Rajput	Agriculture	62
Rajput	Agriculture & Business	3
Chamang	Agriculture	1
Chamang	Agriculture & Weaving	11 5
Domang	Agriculture & Blacksmithy & Silver-smithy.	1
Domang	Blacksmithy	2
Carpenters	Agriculture & Carpentry	2
Carpenters	Carpentry	1
Others		25
	Total	113

Income

The income of each household has been calculated on the basis of total annual produce and other sources which will give a general idea about their economic standard. However, one thing should always be kept in mind that villagers who can be often very vague about the simplest things of life that concerns them—are very roughish in calculating their income. Opportunities are many but villagers may not have fully realised or utilized opportunities to earn more.

In the foregoing paragraph it has been shown that 63 households are engaged in cultivation which is their principal occupation, but while assessing their income it came to our notice that even amongst the agriculturists one or the other member in the family occasionally worked as a part-time labourer and naturally this becomes an important subsidiary occupation which supplemented the income to an appreciable extent. 19 households who derive their income from agriculture possess sizeable holdings while 44 other households no doubt practise agriculture as their main occupation casually engage themselves in manual labour whenever they find an opportunity. There are only 3 households falling in the income range of Rs. 25 p.m. In these households old women are living independently and doing cultivation only worth the name and their income from the agricultural produce is hardly sufficient for 2 or 3 months. They eke out their living either working as part time agricultural labourers for their neighbourers or often on the road construction work.

Now coming to the income range of Rs. 26—50 we see that this group consists of 8 households falling in occupation No. 2 and 3 engaged both in labour and agriculture and labour while 20 families come under the income range of Rs. 51—75 and an equal number of households in the range of Rs. 76—100.

and Ores fall in the category of scheduled castes, but the latter two castes do not inter-dine and intersmoke with the former group who are socially at the lowest rung of the village Society.

Chamangs are both leather workers and weavers. They remove the carcasses of dead animals. It was disclosed during the enquiry that about 15 years back they used to eat the flesh of dead animals including cows, but none of the Chamangs eat the flesh of dead animals now and most of them have abandoned the profession of skinning dead animals too. Out of a total of 19 households belonging to Chamang 4 work as casual leather workers.

Domangs and Ores mix up freely. There is no social taboo with regard to inter-dining and inter-marriages among these people. Their professions no doubt differ but for all social relations they come under one group. They claim superiority over the *Chamangs* and both the castes do not mix up at all. Even the Chamangs do not accept the things cooked by the *Domangs* and *Ores*. *Domangs* and *Ores* are the *baskisa* of the temple orchestra. Main water sources are Kuhls and every body takes water from these Kuhls. There is no restrictions for the scheduled castes to bring water from a particular kuhl, however, they have to wait their turn at some distance if someone from the higher caste is taking water from the kuhl.

Negies do not allow the harijans to enter their houses and whenever they visit they sit outside in the courtyards. Food and water is served to them in the courtyards. The villagers are aware of the untouchability Act, but in practice there is no appreciable change in their outlook. Inferiority complex among the Chamangs, Domangs and Ores is more due to their economic dependence on the higher caste people and they do not want to break the traditional social laws. However after Independence they have been becoming increasingly conscious of their rights and old prejudices are sure to die with the spread of education and betterment in their economic condition. The changing times have not left them untouched altogether. Scheduled castes were not previously permitted to play the orchestra nor could they use a horse for the bridegroom to ride. But now restrictions are gradually vanishing.

Social Status of Women

Socially a woman enjoys all the privileges and positions which are normally sanctioned to her in other societies. She is the lady of her hearth and in a majority of cases she has to be consulted about the important decisions concerning the



Kinauri Belles

family. A husband generally does not by pass her. In settling matrimonial relations of their sons and daughters, mother plays a very important role and her opinion often prevails. At the time of confirmation of betrothels, the sisters and aunts have a special right to demand izzat money. It is a social binding to please them. Women folk do not confine themselves to household duties but they contribute equally in other spheres too. Agricultural operations except ploughing are carried on by Women. They are seen carrying water from the kuhls, flour from the *gottangs,* watering the fields, carrying manure to the fields and laden with heavy loads of fodder which they bring from the nearby forests. Practically no sphere of duty is left where the women do not take part. On religious and other fairs women play a dominant role in singing and dancing and without their presence, the fairs would lose all colour, fun and charm. In spite of her polyanderous position she enjoys a great deal of freedom and is free to seek separation from her husband(s) if things are not to her liking. Unlike her sisters

in the plains and lower hills, she is free to chose a partner of her own choice and not necessarily be tied for all her life to one chosen by her parents. She does not observe purdah and no social gathering or fair or festival is closed to her. Of course she has to work hard, but then life being what it is in these areas she possibly cannot afford to sit by the fire side in her parlour as a spectator while her people are grapling out side with the hard realities of life in the grim struggle for existence. But for her active co-operation and capacity to shoulder equal if not more burden, these areas would possibly have been barren and desolate.

Jomos—The virgin girls who turn nuns, however, do not keep hair and shave off their heads. They go about bare-headed and may not use the 'thepang'. Some may have either a boyish hair.

Statistics of age and sex distribution

(Total all ages)	Persons	Males	Females
1	2	3	4
All ages			
0—4	701	350	351
5—9	64	35	29
10—14	66	34	32
15—19	81	48	33
20—24	50	27	23
	16	44	32
25—29	60	34	26
30—34	48	20	28
35—44	97	46	51
45—59	103	44	59
60 & over	56	18	38

Sex ratio is 1 : 1, the number of males and females being 350 and 351.

Migration

Throughout the year some one from almost each household is away with the flock of goats and sheep either in Lower Hills or in the alpine pastures on the peaks of mountains 8 to 10 miles from the village. During winter from October they migrate to Lower Hills as far in-to Bilaspur. Arki, Mehlog some parts of Karsog, Seoni and Sirmur. They spend the chilly months in these places till the end of April. Goats and sheep are the chief riches of the people here as they furnish them with wool. Romang and bags are made from their skins. To these shepherds their homes are nothing better than rest houses. They stay there hardly for a week while going to the alpine pastures in Pruti, Brati, Rao, Runang, Weh Hangrang, Valley, Dubbling and Shayal-Khar, likewise they do not stay for more than a week in their homes when migrating to Lower Hills. In the alpine pastures on the high altitudes shepherds go without children, but coming down to Lower Hills is often with women and children, leaving elderly members behind who may look after the landed property. During migration season one might come across these people all along the way beyond Rampur some on the move with bag and baggages laden on goats. Bags made of goat or ram skin are slung across the backs and are full of edibles, utensils, wool, *pasham*, dried *chulis* and *chilgozas* in small quantity which are given as presents to their friends in the respective camping places and some resting on the road sides cooking their meals. The gruff shouting which is frequently heard is given to goats and sheep to keep on moving and the faithful dogs who guard their flocks are always with them. These dogs are of special breed and inspite of their leisurely gait are strong enough to challenge any night predator which may be on the look out for a kill. To protect these dogs from the leopards which is a serious menace to the goats and sheep, it is given a spiked iron collar round the neck. Some well-to-do persons have donkeys to carry miscellaneous articles like woollen patties, chilgoza and pasham which they sell in Lavi fair at Rampur, thus seemingly an unending caravan goes on slowly and steadily perhaps breaking their journey at many places to let their hungry flocks graze.

Some able bodied men and women leave their homes in search of labour and usually they find ample scope of work in the lower hills as these months are the most suited for terracing the fields. There they are drawers of water and hewers of wood. In some places, they work as labourers on house construction work and as carriers of manure to the fields, but of late with the opening of fresh employment avenues on roads and buildings, construction works, migration in search of labour has considerably decreased. This sort of migration has been continuing since ancient times and the people have established contacts and friendly relations in most of the places in the lower hills.

Family Structure

Caste and community-wise structure of family is given in the table.

Caste	Total No. of house-holds	Type of families living in the households			
		Simple	Inter-mediate	Joint	Others
1	2	3	4	5	6
Rajput (Negi)	78	21	19	29	9
Koli . .	19	2	5	12	..
Lohar . .	3	1	..	2	..
Ores . .	3	..	..	3	..
Gupta . .	2	..	..	..	2
Khatri . .	1	..	..	..	1
Brahman .	7	..	..	..	7
Total .	113	24	24	46	19

From this table it will be seen that the village consists of simple, intermediate and joint families and the composition of family groups has been given on the following basis.

Simple—Consists of husband, wife and unmarried children.

Intermediate—Married couple and unmarried brother, sister, one of the parents.

Joint—Married couple with married sons/daughters or with married brothers/sisters.

Others—Single members. This group of family consists of Government employees posted in the village and some widowed women who are living alone.

In each caste group there is a tendency towards joint families perhaps polyandry being the main reason.

clan, half to the adopted son. The only case of adoption which my informants could recall was in a distant village where the owner of the rights to use the land was on his death bed, and there was only one male member of the clan living.

In Gaddi-land the cultivable land only occurs in the less precipitous parts of the valleys, usually between 1,000′ and 3,000′ above the main river valley. Where the cultivable land is small with a large number of people dependent on it the size of the village is also limited. In such a situation there may be only one or two houses occupied by the working group which usually consists of the members of one clan. In one or two places the land is more extensive and there the group of houses might be occupied by members of several clans and several castes.[1]

After all the cultivable land had been used, there remained areas around the village which the members had the right to use either as sites for their houses or on which to graze their domestic animals. This land was granted by the rajah but no revenue was paid. I will call this land "common land of the village" although it was really the rajah's land lent to the village free. Cremation grounds are also of this type. They are useless for any other purpose.

Outside this area were lands controlled by the rajah's agents (such as the Forest Department) but to which villagers had access. Such land as this was used for the pine forests, to which the Gaddis could turn when they required a new watermill or a piece of new timber for a house. The villagers had the right to buy trees selected by the forest guard for about five rupees each for private use within the village. Similar trees were sold to forest contractors who were non-citizens for about 80 rupees. In addition the villagers had the right to hunt in the forest without a license (although they required a gun license)[2] and to collect loose brushwood, pine needles, grass and such edible products as mushrooms and toadstools.[3]

Land which was used for any purpose other than the above had to pay a fee to the rajah. For new houses a sum of one rupee per annum had to be paid and for each water mill built along the side of a stream a separate fee of one rupee had to be paid. If this fee were not paid the owner lost the right to the land on which the edifice was built.

It can thus be seen that the connection of the rajah with the land was very close and that each cultivator had a direct relationship with the rajah, irrespective of his clan or caste. This relationship should be looked on as a reciprocal relationship. The subjects had the right to use the land, to be protected both in the military and religious sphere and to have their various local and national customs protected. The rajah also acted as a sort of Storehouse of the national wealth and the national prestige, which he spent on the upkeep of roads and the purchase of elephants. In return, the subjects had to pay revenue for their land, to undertake their appropriate service, whether religious (as Brahmins), military (as Gaddis), or labour (as the lower castes), and to obey the orders of the rajah's servants.

The system of land control by the rajah resulted in a basic equalitarianism because, since no one could purchase land very much in excess of what he required for his own use (since land rarely came on to the market and could not be used as security for loans), all rank derived only from government appointments and not control of excessive wealth.[4]

[1] I intend to use the word village for a group of houses surrounded by cultivable land, even when this village may consist of only one house. The word hamlet is unsuitable as each group of houses has an independent existence and is not associated politically with other dispersed houses.

[2] Non-citizens of Brahmaur pay a heavy fee for a hunting license.

[3] Many toadstools are edible. One such toadstool is termed *chamakanun* and tastes exactly like meat.

[4] One Gaddi in Brahmaur, who had inherited land in excess of his requirements had planted trees on his land. After they had matured, he wished to cut them down to use the money to educate his children. The rajah refused him permission on the advice of the Forest Department and he found he could not use his land for the purpose which he had originally planned yet if he ceased to pay the revenue, he would lose both the trees and the land. On Chamba becoming part of the Republic of India, the system of land holding was changed so that the occupier acquired absolute rights over this land to dispose of as he wished. He cut down the trees without being legally required to plant new trees so that the land, useless for any other purpose, is now subject to degradation. The situation of the land after the Indian Settlement will be dealt with subsequently.

NOTE—In the Middle Ages, rajahs used to present land to Brahmins to acquire religious merit. One copper plate inscription after having described the boundaries of the land states that the rajah gives it "as far as its limits, grass, grazing and pasture ground together with fruit trees and with the water courses and channels, with approaches, ingress and egress, with fallow land and cultivated land with (the fines for) the ten offences". It then states that the grantee "should freely enjoy and make others to enjoy this grant on the authority of our charter.. Subjects resident in the enjoyed land in obedience to our command will have to deliver to him the regular share and use, tax in kind and cash and every tribute due to the king".

This grant clearly gives the Brahmin only the right to use the *revenues* of the land which were formerly due to the rajah. It is doubtful whether the rajah, although the proprietor of the land, could prevent people already tilling the land from continuing to do so. The rajah is clearly not the landlord of Chamba State in the sense that he could alienate any of his territory. It seems doubtful whether the rajah could even alienate his revenues to anyone other than a Brahmin. In the Brahmaur valley the only land which had been alienated in this way is the one acre of former rice land attached to the temple, the revenue of which was used for the support of the resident priests. This piece of land at the bottom of Grer village no longer grows rice (in 1963) although it was doing so in 1951.

Similar principles apply to the use of grazing land as to cultivable land. It has thus been described by the gazeteer of the Kangra district as applying to Chamba.

"The pasturable low country is termed a *ban*. Each *ban* in Kangra is claimed by a Gaddi as its *warisi* (inheritance) except in Nurpur where all *bans* are free. The origin of this *warisi* is alleged to be in a grant (*patti*) from the rajah. Lyall claims this arose from a shepherd presenting a *nazam* (petition) to a rajah, obtaining a right to graze a new *ban* and then uniting with other shepherds to graze it. The holder of the *patti* was often the *mahlundi*, master of the flock, and the other shepherds as his *asamian* or clients. On paying fees to the rajah's agent (*banwajiri*), all paid equally, but the *mahlundi* acquired the *mailani* (money from sheep's droppings), unless it was paid in food when all ate. When the rajah demanded sheep and goats the nominal price paid went to the *mahlundi*, although each shepherd supplied the sheep in turn.

Holders of *warisi* often exact a toll from other shepherds but should a run not be taken up by a *mahlundi*, after a while the right would disappear.

In the winter, on descending from the high ranges, the grazing tax was collected by a Gaddi (who was an agent of the rajah) who could allot the pasturelands (*dhans*).

In coming and going from Chamba to Kangra, three months are spent in the *kandi dhans* (mountainous pastureland), each of which has its local name and recognised boundary. There may be three or four *goths* (resting places) in each *dhan*. There are two sorts of *dhan*, the one in bare rocky ground above the line of forest called *nigahr;* the others lower down termed *kundli* or *dhar*. Formerly a tax, *langekoru* (crossing tax) was paid of one or two goats and the fleece of a sheep. They were collected by a village official termed a *drinkar*, who was always a Gaddi (although an agent of the rajah). He was also entitled to take certain perquisites from the shepherds himself.

Villages at the bottom of *dhans* formerly demanded payment for their use in the form of manuring but this right applied only in the autumn and not in the spring." (p. 268).

These rules applied only to Kangra. In Chamba all grazing rights belonged to the rajah of Chamba. In the Bara Bangahal once part of Chamba State), the grazing tax was paid to the government by shepherds from Mandi but not from Gaddis (for Gaddis are domiciled in Chamba State).

From this chaos of grazing rights certain common principles emerge. (1) On the Kangra side of the Dhaula Dhar, there are three types of pasturage, mountainous pasturage near the tops, pasturage amid the forests lower down and pasturage on the plains. In the case of the first a tax was paid to the rajah but in the case of the second and third, certain neighbouring villages were also considered to have rights over the pasturage. These obligations were paid by arranging for the sheep and goats to manure the fields of the agriculturists in certain seasons. At other seasons if the agriculturists wished for the animals' manure they had to pay for the privilege either in cash or in food. In addition the right to graze certain of the low pastures lay with the rajah who granted the right to a special herdsmen client who was issued with a grant showing his grazing rights over the territory.

(2) On the Chamba side of the Dhaula Dhar and in the Bara Bangahal, the tops of certain mountains are well known as grazing grounds where the grass springs up every spring and autumn. These grazing grounds are divided into areas and the right to collect the fees in such areas was auctioned by the rajah of Chamba to the highest bidder, who was usually a Gaddi. These areas were so arranged that shepherds might wander from one to the other at the appropriate season if they found one too overcrowded. The rate in 1950 was 2 annas 6 pies (2½d.) per goat per grazing district and one anna 6 pies (1½d.) per sheep. As citizens of Chamba, they had the right to graze their flocks in the Bara Bangahal without the payment of additional tax (although shepherds from outside Chamba State had to pay it), and in Lahul to graze their sheep and goats on one side of the river only. On the other side, the inhabitants of Lahul may graze their animals. If Gaddis were to cross they would need to pay a grazing tax to both the Chamba and Lahuli ruler.

(3) In addition to a grazing tax paid to the local rajah either directly or through a *mahlundi* and to manuring rights paid to local villages, a crossing tax was paid. This tax was given to the rajah not for revenue but in accordance with his religious status as a measure of thanksgiving for the successful crossing of the pass. In the case of the pass between Chamba and Kangra very rarely was any special difficulty encountered but over the high pass between Kugti village at the top of the Budl Nadl and Lahul, Gaddis even today never fail to sacrifice some of their animals which were formerly presented to the rajah. This is a bare mountain top at a height of over 16,000′ without any wood or trees of any sort. It is exceptional for anyone with animals to take less than three days actually on the tops of the mountain and should

a storm arise there is no protection. They do not sacrifice on the return journey.

(4) No shepherd whether from Kangra, Chamba or elsewhere could acquire the permanent right to graze flocks either on the upper or lower slopes of the Dhaula Dhar. He might however in the case of the Kangra valley acquire a grant by petitioning the rajah for the right to use the land for the purpose of grazing sheep for a longer period than three days. This grant lapsed through nonuse. For periods of less than three days any shepherd could travel through the land. In every *dhan* special resting places were recognised for transients (*goths*).

Thus the right to pasturage over the whole of the State belonged to the rajah who could dispose of the rights temporarily.

These rights to grazing tax have now been taken over by the Government of India State Forest Department. At first there was some dissatisfaction and anger because the grazing grounds were re-organised by a non-Gaddi who did not know of the movement of the flocks so that if a Gaddi shepherd grazed out an area, he found he might have to pay a new tax to move to another pastureland in the same area. The tax is now collected by an employee of the Forest Department and a receipt issued. This receipt is however not issued unless the shepherd has a permit issued by the Forest Department at Brahmaur stating how many sheep and goats over one year of age that he is supposed to have in his flock. From a government point of view this is designed to prevent overgrazing. The rates in 1962 were in Lahul 4 annas per goat and 2 annas per sheep, in Brahmaur 2 annas per goat and sheep and in Kangra 8 n.p. per sheep and 4 annas per goat.

In short the situation under the rajah was that the whole of Chamba State was nationalised, that is belonged to the nation in the person of the rajah. The rajah however could not use the land as he wished but had to allocate it on certain customary principles for the good of the citizens of the State. Land could thus not be used as security for debt because such security only existed as long the owner or owner's group existed and as soon as he could no longer use the land himself, it reverted to the State in the person of the rajah.

Perhaps one of the most fundamental changes instituted by the Indian Union when it incorporated Chamba in Himachal Pradesh was to introduce the idea of private property in land. This question will be dealt with subsequently but in 1953 a Settlement was instituted in Brahmaur *tahsil* in which the inhabitants of each village were asked about their traditional customs and obligations to the State and to each other. This "agreement" between the State and each village is incorporated at the beginning of each *patwari* register. In the appendix is enclosed such a statement as it applied to the inhabitants of Goshen and much of this report must be regarded as a commentary on this agreement, as its nature and form assumes a social organisation similar to that of the Punjab plains, an assumption which is incorrect because of the peculiar nature of the relationship between the rajah proprietor, the villagers and the soil.

Religion—The inhabitants of these three districts are overwhelmingly Hindu by religion, are conscious of their obligations as Hindus to the other members of the society and are aware of the fact that Hinduism includes people outside their own Chamba boundaries to whom they are related by bonds of religion. These ideas do not conflict with their belief that the Hindu gods (especially Shiva) have a personal and special interest in themselves which gives them a sort of superiority over those Hindus from outside Brahmaur.

To the Gaddis, the area around Brahmaur has a religious significance expressed by the few ancient monuments which have withstood the passing of time. Behind the *maidan,* the square in the middle of Brahmaur, there still remains traces of the rajah's palace in which his wives used to promenade in the tenth century. In front of the square there still stands a well preserved and impressive mountain temple to which certain hereditary Brahmins make a traditional monthly *puja* (worship) on behalf of the whole Gaddi community and to which is attached a number of priests (*sadhus*) supported by the former revenues of temple lands. The importance of the shrine is shown by the annual pilgrimage of Indians from the plains and even from the south, who travel on to the festival held at Lake Manimahesh at the top of the valley. To the Gaddis these pilgrims are a source of income and a long standing proof of the importance of their valley to the larger Indian continent. But to the residents, the importance of the valleys to the gods needs no emphasis. The larger mountains are named after gods. Mt. Kallas is the seat of Shiva and his consort Parvati and his trident, which flashes in the lightning is the national symbol of the valley. At the top of every pass is a shrine at which the herdsmen sacrifice a beast or the traveller presents a small coin. Along the paths are pillars of rock which are either a memorial to some Gaddi killed in a battle with a bear or else a warning to the traveller to look up to some sacred shrine or monument which can be seen from that position. The religious beliefs of the Gaddis can almost be said to have a topography for each monument stands to testify to the manifestation of the gods at a particular spot. Behind Brahmaur at a height of

bulls are small, black and hardy and are mainly from Kangra. A bull was estimated by the owners to be worth about 50 rupees cash in 1952. Cows are worth less than half this sum. Each bull and cow is believed to have its own familiar spirit (*Jakh*), and when an animal is bought or sold, the name of its familiar spirit is also transferred. A calf acquires its mother's spirit. On the successful birth of a calf or at the sickness of the bull or cow, gifts of clarified butter (*ghi*) are offered to the spirit.[1] In addition to the name of the spirit, each cow has also its own personal name. A cow's purchase money implies the approval of its spirit to the sale. Some families also own one or two sheep which remain in the house all the year. Sheep have no guardian spirits.

After seeing that their animals will be well looked after during the winter, the Gaddis shut up their houses to prevent a wild animal breaking in, and as the first snowfall strikes their homes, make haste to descend the track to Chamba or cross over the Dhaula Dhar to Palampur, Dharamsala or the Kangra valley. They leave in family parties and at different speeds. Where they are bound for, and how fast they travel, depends on their aim and how fit they are.

Of the 22 elementary families at Goshen in 1952, six remained behind. Of the sixteen who went away, 2 had land at Dharamsala, where they could work for winter crops, the three musician families begged, one family found employment on the new Jullundur railway laying sleepers, one who owned a packhorse went to work at Kangra and stayed with relatives. Another family cut wood at Pathankot, four other families either were looking after sheep or accompanied people who were looking after sheep. Thus during the winter the village community dissolves. The proportion of families leaving Goshen in 1961 appeared to be about the same although in certain villages obtaining government work, the proportion staying was higher.

Although the term Gaddi is etymologically connected with the word for "high pastures" and in common usage refers to shepherds, by no means all Gaddis have any association with the care and pasturing of sheep. But among those Gaddis who own flocks, there is a definite cycle of activity which repeats itself every year.

During the summer, the sheep and goats are pastured on the mountains on the south and west of the Chandra Bhaga river (Sutlej) in Lahul or in the pastures on the Bara Bangahal. As autumn approaches the shepherds travel slowly down the valley below Kugti to Brahmaur where they remain two to three weeks. During this period, they allow their flocks to rest on those lands whose owners pay a fee for the sheep manure, and join in the various festivities of this season of the year. As autumn continues, they travel up the Ravi over nearly all the passes between Holi and Baijnath. They remain on the tops until snow drives them down to the Kangra plains, where they arrive as late as possible. There they pasture their flocks on the fields before the autumn (*kharif*) crops are planted, and receive payment from the landowners for so doing. They remain in the valley all the winter, until, as the spring approaches, they return to Brahmaur either through Dalhousie and Chamba along the main road, or over the first snow-free pass. In the middle spring, they again stay for two or three weeks at Brahmaur and on the hills on each side, before passing up the valley to Kugti and Lahul. The shepherds are not nomads in the sense that they do not know where they are going. They have a definite cycle of movement and in different places build up relationships with the local inhabitants, especially those who, not keeping animals themselves, require the sheep and goat droppings.

Caring for the sheep and goats is an isolated and lonely occupation, and, during the spring and autumn, often dangerous with bears about. On these trips the wife usually accompanies her husband for whom she prepares and cooks the meals and looks after the children. The husband collects the firewood and looks after the sheep. There are usually recognised shelters under an overhanging rock, which have become well-known in the course of time, and, along well-known routes, there may be as many as twenty to thirty families camped under the one rock each with a separate cooking fire. Children too small to walk are carried on their father's back. A family with enough sheep is self-sufficient, not requiring rights in land for subsistence. The sheep and goats are shorn in June and October. The largest clip is in October.[2] In February, the clip is sold to Kangra traders and the money used to buy food to support the family during the winter. In June and October the wool is exchanged with other Gaddis in Brahmaur for food, and to provide the wool staple to be made into cloth by members of the family remaining at home. Yet, to a Gaddi, this self-sufficiency hardly makes up for the disadvantage of the wandering roving life away from the centres of

[1] The gift to a *jakh* is termed *ahri* and is one *ser* (about 2 lbs.) in weight after the first birth, ½ *ser* for the second birth and the third birth and ¼ *ser* subsequently. This applies whatever the sex of the calf.

In Kugti are also found *yung*, a cross breed between a yak and a bull or cow. A few water buffaloes have been introduced in the lower valley when the jeep road was built. See *The Sherpas of Nepal, Buddhist Highlanders* by Christoph von Furer—Haimendorf. John Murray, London, 1964 p. 12.

[2] The average clip per annum per sheep is said to be between 69 and 83 *sers*. (1 *ser*—2 lbs. approx.)

permanent habitation. For every shepherd has a fixed permanent home, and, far from being a nomad, his hope is always to return to his own village, where he can participate in the village activities during the summer and autumn at least. During the winter it is at least as comfortable to live with the sheep in the warm Kangra valley as in the snow-covered empty Brahmaur villages. At this time shepherding becomes more popular. But the majority of Gaddis are not shepherds. In Goshen only one *gotra* could be said to have members specialising in shepherd's work.

Gaddi flocks consist of both sheep and goats, Although sheep produce more wool, they are less hardy and give less meat and milk. Goats are also able to live on poorer pasture than sheep, but at the same time tend to destroy the pasture after they have grazed for a certain length of time, as their sharp hooves cut the turf, exposing the top soil, which is blown away by the wind.

There are about 20 per cent more sheep than goats and this proportion appears to have remained the same for at least the last ten years. Even though the destruction by goats of the top soil is greater and the tax is greater every shepherd requires both animals. The product of the sheep is in the nature of a cash crop which can either be sold or made into clothing but the goat is in the nature of a subsistence crop which can be eaten and exchanged in the villages. Some Gaddis own sheep and goats without being shepherds. The owners pay the shepherds 5 *ser* of raw wool per sheep plus the gift of one sheep for a small flock (*toeni*) per season. But rates vary and hired shepherds are becoming increasingly unwilling to take responsibility for flocks other than their own family's. But where flocks are looked after by other than the owner there is a kinship connection, usually mother's brother[1] sister's son relationship. Owners lack confidence in non-kin to keep accounts honestly.

About three or four years ago a severe disease struck certain of the flocks with a big decrease in numbers. In 1962 the flocks were coming back to the same strength as in 1958. However, the situation of the shepherds is today not the same as in the time of the rajah. At the time of the rajah, any person who wished to graze on the *dhars* could do so provided he paid the approved grazing fee.[1]

At the present time, one can only pay tax to the extent that one has a permit issued by the forest officer and the total number of animals allowed to graze in any one *dhar* is determined by the forest officer. This is in order to prevent overgazing. Animals under one year of age are not included in the permit and no tax need be paid on them. The owner of every animal found over age and not registered on the permit is fined one rupee on the spot or else brought before the *tahsildar*. According to the forest officer at Brahmaur to whom I owe a great debt of thanks for his courtesy in answering my enquiries, the general principle of the forest department is to allow the name of the owners to be freely transferred provided the total number of sheep or goats does not increase. From personal knowledge I know that these permits are freely bought and sold amongst shepherds so that shepherds have now become closed corporations. Yet since the size of flocks rises and falls in accordance with the number of kids and lambs born *two* seasons earlier and in accordance with diseases which may strike at any time, the shepherds cannot afford to have the full number of animals granted on their permit in an off year (in case they need them the following year). Thus they are forced into the position of either running more than the number on their permits risking a fine or bribe; or else keeping the number of their flock less than their permit and selling part of their licence temporarily to some other shepherd. This changes the whole pattern of shepherding as it prevents outsiders coming into the occupation and strengthens the hands of those able to get permits.

During the whole of this period the population was increasing at a rate estimated by the Census of India as 19% between 1951 and 1961. while the number of sheep and goats was reduced by about a quarter due to the Forest Department permit system.

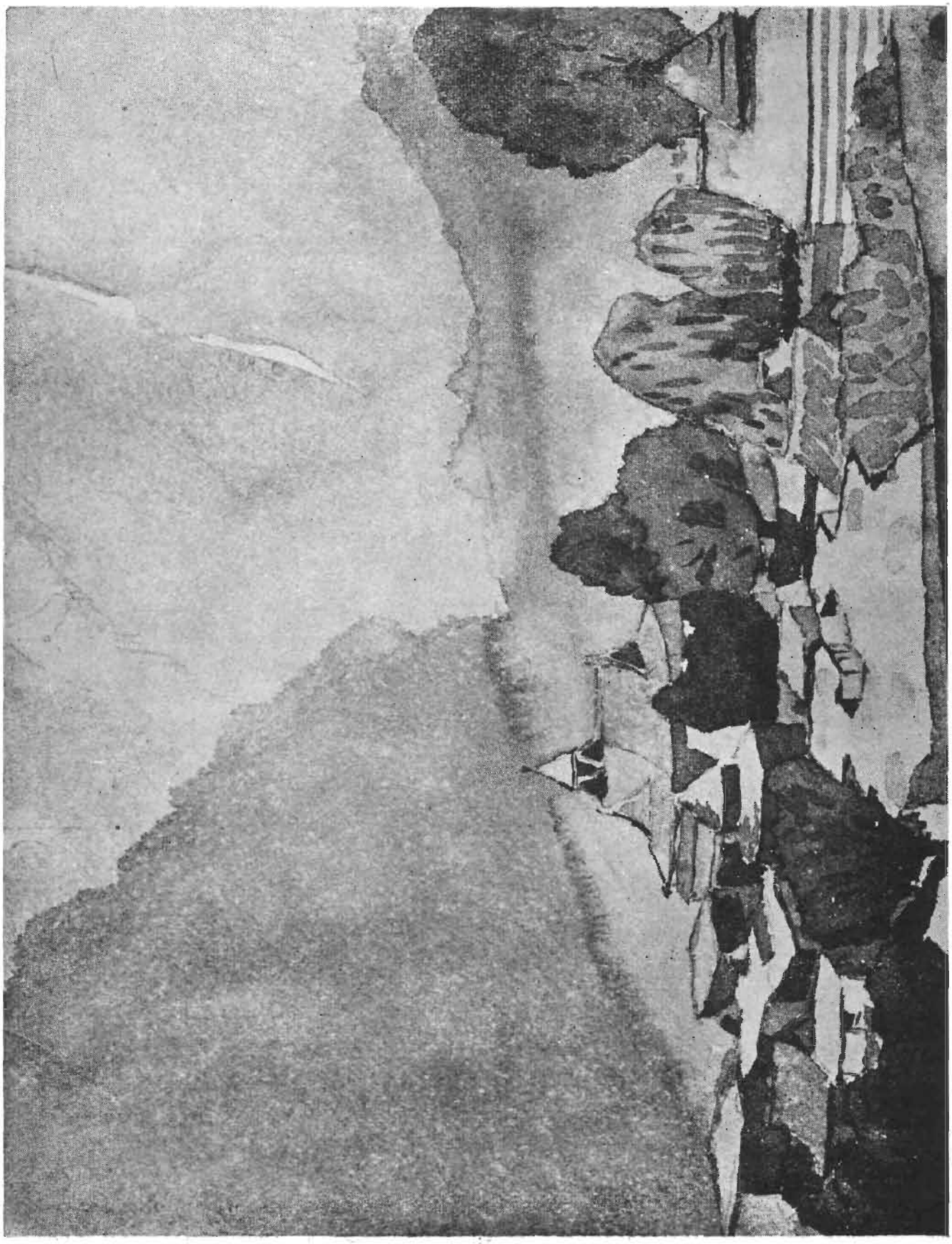
It is clear that Gaddis are not principally a sheep caring nomadic people but have done so for hundreds of years as an *additional* means of gaining subsistence. Most Gaddis still have no desire to undertake this task and the crude grass sandals with which they protect their feet against the snow is in striking contrast to the neighbouring Lahulis who have invented their own effective boots against the elements. The Gaddis are an agricultural peoples who take up other occupations from economic necessity rather than desire.

[1] This outline of the former rights in pasturage for sheep and goats varies considerably in different parts of the state. For example in Kugti although the rajah owned the right to collect fees from the shepherds for pasture, he apparently had not the right to allow shepherds other than local shepherds to graze there. Dhars were held direct from the rajah but "the inhabitants of Kugti which is surrounded by large tracts of waste, boast that they have always held from the Rajah the lease of all the Kugti *dhars*, with power to admit what shepherds they please, and they do not admit that the Rajah could now lawfully alter this arrangement. They claim in fact a kind of corporate property in the *dhar* limited however to sheep grazing; the right of netting or snaring musk deer in the same tract is leased by the Rajah direct to Bangahal men or other outsiders" (p. 142, Punjab District Gazetteers, Vol. *X, A Kangra District*, Part A 1904 Civil and Military Gazette, Lahore, 1906).

Grazing statement of sheep and goats in the Brahmaur tahsil of Himachal Pradesh who have paid the recognised grazing fees. By courtesy of Hem Raj, Brahmaur Forest Officer.

Year	Sheep	Goats	Remarks by the author
1952-3	42,176	31,695	
1953-4	40,515	28,301	
1954-5	41,220	30,831	
1955-6	41,117	32,458	
1956-7	40,600	30,896	
1957-8	38,346	28,921	
1958-9	35,733	25,098	
1959-60	30,828	24,864	This is the year after the sheep were struck by disease.
1960-1	30,715	24,629	
1961-2	30,515	24,406	

Please notice the approximately constant proportion of sheep and goats during the whole of this period.



An Artist's Impression of the Village

The village is environed by the fields and fruit trees punctuated by vineyards. The scenery partakes more of magnificence than of beauty. Here everything is on the grand scale, huge pieces of fallen rocks of immense bulk, hurled from the peaks above and vast impending cliffs fringed with dark forests and topped with eternal snow appear on every side.

The total area of the village is 529 acres or 214·07 hectares. In all, there are 128 households having a population of 786 persons –382 males and 404 females. The density per sq. mile comes to 951 persons.

The bus terminus, at present, is village Jeori at a distance of about 50 miles from Kothi. A motorable road which would pass just below the village is also under construction. The construction of road in the inner Himalayan ranges involved cutting of solid granite rocks inch by inch and the whole work is a marvel of engineering skill. The nearest important market is Rampur, although with Kalpa becoming the district headquarters some of the important commodities have become available in the small local bazar. The post and telegraph office is also located at Kalpa. Before the formation of Himachal Pradesh on the 15th April 1948, Kinnaur formed a part of the erstwhile State of Rampur Bushahr.

HISTORY

There is a temple of Bhairon in the village. It is an ancient monument but is neglected now-a-days. Besides the statue of Bhairon, there are eighteen more small statues of other gods and goddesses. It was not possible to ascertain from the villagers as to who built the temple and when and why. Two of the eighteen small statues are those of goddess Saraswati – the goddess of learning and art in Hindu mythology. Clear cut conclusions are difficult to be drawn but it may be that the village or the area around it was under the Brahminical influence at some distant past.

There is a small tank in front of the temple of Bhairon next to a weeping willow. It is a pucca tank built by the five Pandavas of Mahabharata fame—so the legend goes when they came to stay in this village during their ramblings. We cannot give credence to this belief as it is a common practice among all simple hill folks to associate something from their village with the Pandavas and in every sizeable village in this part of the country one comes across one thing or the other which is so often linked with Pandavas.

Rahul Sankrityayan, in his book "Kinner Desh" is of the opinion that these murtis belong to the 10th century, at any rate not earlier than Gupta age. But perhaps from the 7th to the 10th century Bhots were exerting a great influence on Kinner Pradesh, and during that period Kothi might have been the centre or tributary of some central power where Hindus were powerful enough to defy the Bhots and their culture. At any rate the presence of these murtis in the village should lead one to infer that the Buddhist influence was in a decaying state when the Bhairon temple was built here.

Sankrityayan is further of the opinion that the period can either be the beginning of the 7th century i.e., the period of Vann or Harsha or the 10th century when the Shrongchun empire (617 –902 A.D.) was on the decline and his descendant Skiyad-de-cmagon had not established a separate kingdom in the western Tibet. After the destruction of Bhot empire a ruler having faith in Brahminism came here. During that period the nearest neighbouring state to Kinnaur was the Gurjar Pratihar dynasty of Kannauj of which Bhoj-II, Mahipal, Vinayak Pal (914 45 A.D.), Mahendra Pal-II (945—48 A.D.), Dev Pal (948 53 A.D.), Vinayak Pal-II (953-54 A.D.), Mahipal-II (954 55 A.D.), Vats Raj-II (955 60 A.D.), Vijay Pal (960—1018 A.D.) kings ruled in the 10th century.

The opinion expressed above by Rahul Sankrityayan should go to show that the Murtis in the Bhairon temple at Kothi

either belong to the period of Harsha (7th century) or of Mahipal-I of the Gurjar-Pratihar dynasty.

The Bhairon temple also has a Shivlinga and this affords a reasonable ground to elieve that the temple was established y some follower of Shaivism.

In these hills we come across villagers who erect monuments in the name of a deity in fulfilment of some vow. It may well have happened that some chieftain professing Brahminical faith erected this Bhairon temple and also installed these murtis in fulfilment of some vow or in commemoration of some local victory. Chandika is the presiding deity of the village. In the Hindu mythology she is Shiva's consort. Bhairon was created by Shiva. Some one might have erected Bhairon temple to complete the divinity of mother, father and son.

It can not, however, be gainsaid that Brahminical influence has all along been there and persists even to date.

PHYSICAL ASPECTS

The yearly average of snow and rainfall for the last ten years recorded at Kalpa, is 119″ and 16·98″ respectively.

Rock—Gneiss and schist.

Slope—Easy to steep.

Soil-covering—Light artemisia or bare.

Aspect—Easterly.

The crop of trees is almost a mixture of Deodars and pines of the commercial variety commonly known as Chilgoza (Pinus Gerardiana). To the north and east the deodar is of low quality—interspersed by a few groups of straight trees. In the centre and to the south the crop improves slightly but is still poor; there are some good trees along water channels below Kalpa village, though they are suffering rom illicit fellings.

Climate

Spring—March 16 to May 15.

Summer—May 16 to September 15.

Autumn—September 16 to November 30.

Winter—December 1 to March 15.

Kinnaur has been divided into two climatic zones—the wet zone and the dry zone. The records of the meteorological department show that the monsoon rainfall decreases progressively from the outer ranges of the Himalayas towards the interior. As far up the Sutlej valley as Wangtu the amount of rainfall does not differ much from that experienced in the outer ranges of the Western Himalayas but beyond that there is a progressive decrease which has a noticeable effect on the nature of the vegetation. This is due to the local effect of the two lofty mountain ranges forming the southern and northern border of Kinnaur; they act as a barrier to the progress of the monsoon clouds blowing the Sutlej and Pabar valleys and cause the precipitation of much of their moisture on their southern slopes. This is very marked in the case of the northern range which produces locally very heavy rains in Pandrabis pargana. Further east the great Himalayan range causes the precipitation of the remaining moisture and in the upper parts of Kalpa and Kailas ranges the climate is practically arid.

Water Sources

The water sources mainly depend on the melting of snow. In Kalpa forest range the snow melts very early, and the soil being dry and dusty absorbs the scanty rainfall at once. Springs are rare, thus it is only in the larger side nullahs where the streams have their origin in the glaciers and high snow fields that a continuous supply of water is ensured. The villagers depend on kuhls (water channels) which carry water from nullahs to their fields. It has been observed that even during the nights the villagers attend to the kuhls

4. SOCIAL AND CULTURAL LIFE

Muslim Gujjars in Maingal have a separate entity of their own. Their dwellings are scattered over the cold regions away from the tumultuous life of towns. Their peace is the least affected when they migrate to the jots. As quoted by Ibbetson in 'A Glossary of tribes and castes of the Punjab and North West Frontier Province' the Gujjars are described as a simple all enduring race, thrifty and industrious with no ambition but to be left alone in peace with their cattle.' They do not share any custom with the Gaddi Brahmins. They are staunch muslims and observe all the tenants of Islam. Fasts are observed in the month of Ramzan of Hizri era. The custom of reading *namaz* five ttme a day is observed by elderly Gujjars. They believe in Pir Dastgir. The Gujjars greatly believe in evil eyes and days and to ward off their effect they wear round their necks a *tabeej* encased in a silver case. *Tabeej* is put round the necks of even children. Women do not observe *purdha.*

Festivals

The Gujjars do not have any festival peculiar to their own tribe. They follow muslim festivals and the most important are Idul Zuha and Idul Fittar. Muslim Gujjars do not engage themselves in singing and dancing nor do they have any musical instruments. Unlike other tribes they have not developed any folk dance or songs. They are always busy in their routine duties and have identified themselves more with their cattle.

Idul Zuha (An eye witness account)—When the Investigators were there, Idul Zuha fell on 23rd April, 1964. Gujjar houses were being cleaned and washed with local clay a day earlier. We asked Nura-an elderly Gujjar as to why all the Gujjars were observing cleanliness. He replied that it was because of 'Id'. Gujjar women were seen washing heavy bundles of clothes. Men and children shaved their heads. Fateh Mohmad extended an invitation to us for meals.

They got up early in the morning and took their bath and applied *kajal* in their eyes. We reached Fateh Mohmad's house at about 10 A.M. People were going to Idgah—a flat little ground about two furlong down the village, amids the forests. By about 11.30 50 men and 4 women assembled. They were sitting in groups and discussing subjects of their common interest. After a little chitchat they spread their sheets on the ground and sat facing the west in 4 rows. Children and younger people were in the back row. The women were sitting at the farthest end. They erected a screen on one side and we could not see what they did in *purdah.*

Then the *kazi* stood and read aloud *khatba.* The Gujjars kept sitting in silence some times touching the ground with their foreheads. This process continued for fifteen minutes.

Last of all the Gujjars stood up and one by one they went to *kazi* Roshan Din to put some coins in his right pockets. Women did not give anything to the *kazi.* There after they embraced each other in groups. Some of them put many questions to the *kazi,* and the elderly Gujjars sat to discuss their common topics. At about 12 everybody left the Idgah ground and went to their houses.

Preparations of *kheer* and maize *rote* were relished in each household. Fateh Mohmad offered *kurbani* by slaughtering a goat. They take their morning meal before the dawn and evening meal after the moon has set in.

Idul Fittar—Preceeding a month from Idul-Fittar Gujjars observe *rozas.* They eat only once in the evening during rozas. But they take something before the day break and this is called *sehri* and throughout the day they do not take even water. A couple of days earlier they wash their houses with local clay, as in the case of Idulzuha, clothes are washed and cleanliness observed. They offer collective prayers and the *kazi* reads the *khatha. Kheer* is cooked in every household. Their relatives and friends also visit their houses. Quran is kept in each household. This is read twice a day. Fasts are broken with the words spoken *Rizeke-ka-vakat-hogaya.*

Migration

The pastoral economy of the Gujjars demands extensive utilization of pastures and their migration to the higher hills begins in May. They go with their buffaloes to the Chandi, Chal Sakri and Nadin. It takes two days to reach the jot. They have their separate *khothas* on the jots. They carry with them-beds, cooking utensils, tins to keep butter and ghee and *madhani* and *dekcha*. The luggage is loaded on a bullock. Men and women also carry heavy loads on their heads. During their stay at jot they do not usually use kerosene lamps but burn torch wood extracted from kail trees. This is called *jogni*. It was revealed by some elderly Gujjars that this was the best suited season for them. During this season they store appreciable quantity of ghee which relieves them of long outstanding debts. The President of Shilaghrat Panchayat wittingly remarked that when a Gujjar has stored two or three tins of ghee he must quarrel with someone and then it is the busiest season for the Panchayat to settle their disputes. So long as their money is not spent fully they usually quarrel among themselves or with their neighbourers. This is also one of the causes that they have not been able to improve their living conditions. The Gujjars are back from the jot in Maingal by September.

Gaddi Brahmins of Maingal are staunch Hindus. They have nothing in common with Gujjars. They follow all Hindu rituals and believe in various deities. They have an unflinching faith in fate and gods. Their family deities are chond, Bir, and Sitla. Rama and Krishna are worshipped. Goddess Sitla, Kali and Shakti are held in great reverence. The family deities are kept on a corner of their rooms. These are worshipped daily. Incence is burnt and an earthen lamp is lit occasionally.

The temples of Sitla, Kali and Shakti are in Bananha, Aloda and Dila villages which are within a radius of three miles from Maingal. Gaddi Brahmins often pay a visit to these places. They worship the *pipal* tree also as symbol of fertility. Fasts are observed on Shivratri, Janamashtmi, Ekadshi and Puranmashi—full moon day. Satya Narayan Katha is often held and Brahmins are invited from Sahu or Chambi.

The Gaddis of Maingal are different from the Gaddis of Brahmaur. They do not lead a pastoral life but have settled on agriculture as their principal occupation. Only one household among them has large number of goats and sheep. He is mostly away from his home, but his wife and children remain at home. They not have their separate priests from amongst them. On religious ceremonies and other occasions they engage Brahmin priests. Whenever they can afford they visit religious places like Mani Mahesh and Brahmaur. Annual cycle of fairs celebrated by them is given here:—

Basoa—On the 1st of Baisakha general cleanliness is observed. Houses are cleaned and washed with local clay. Clothes are washed and every one in the family takes bath. Good preparations of rice, pulses, *pindri* and *babru* are taken in every household.

Patroru—On 1st of Bhadon a special dish known Patroru is prepared and relished in each family. General cleanliness is also observed.

Diwali—Diwali the festival of lights is celebrated by Gaddi Brahmins of Maingal by observing cleanliness. Houses are washed with clay. The deities and devtas kept in their houses are worshipped and earthen lamps are lit during night. Preparation of *bedal*, pulses, rice and *babru* are prepared. Those who can afford, slaughter a goat or sheep.

Khichri Sajja—On the 1st Magh, *khichri* is prepared and taken with ghee.

Besides these, Janamashtmi, Shivratri and other Hindu festivals are observed. The devotees go to Chamba and other places of interest on these days. Fasts are observed and deities worshipped.

Other Fairs—Among other fairs Sahu Jatar held in April and Minjar fair of Chamba held in August are the main attractions to the villagers. Both Gujjars and Gaddi Brahmins participate in these fairs. A few Gujjar families have their relatives in Sahu Paddar. When they go to attend the fair they avail of this opportunity to pay a visit to their relatives.

Sahu Jattar—Sahu Jattar is held on the 15th and 16th Baisakh for 2 days at Chander Shekhar Maha Dev's temple in Sahu Paddar village which is 11 miles from Chamba and six miles through a short cut from Maingal.

There is a beautiful temple of Chander Shekhar Maha Dev whose *Pindi* is made of stone. Opposite to the temple a giant statue of Nandi bull stands. Whosoever participates in the fair, first of all must

offer prayer in the temple and then bow to the Nandi bull. Women sing and dance in the ground during the night. Offerings of flowers and money are also made by men and women at the Kali's temple and Chaturbhuj Narain's Idol which are just adjacent to the Maha Dev's temple. The priest of the temple offers *charnamrit* to the devotees.

The dance performed by women during night is called Ghurai dhandharas. Dance is performed during the day time by men. They form a circle and continue dancing to the tunes of music consisting of *dhols, nagaras, narsingh, karnal, shehnai.* On the concluding day of the Jattar towards the evening Chela of Mahadev goes into trance and the devotees invoke the blessings of the deity. Men and women are seen going round the shops. The Jattar is also the best suited occasion to establish *maitri* between a young man and a woman.

The term *maitri* seems to have been derived from the word *mitter* which means a friend and which is so very commonly used among Gaddis so much so that in this area a Gaddi is always accosted as *mittra.* The initiative to establish friendly relations may be taken either by the girl or the boy, but generally it is girls who are more eager to take the first step. She would go to the boy of her choice and invite him to establish maitri between the two. If the boy agrees, they both go to the temple, bow before the Mahadeva and promise to help each other in time of need. The boy generally gives some little cash to the girl and thereafter they go out and roam about the *mela* ground enjoying the fair together. The parents of the girl do not object her going about with a stranger boy with whom she has established maitri. It was gathered from more than one sources that this maitri is not generally abused so far as the boy and the girl who went together to bow before the Mahadeva are concerned. But it was confidentially learnt that the girl generally acts as a go between and is instrumental in introducing other girl friends to the boy who nine times out of ten abuses this concession. This being the state of affairs it may not be unrealistic to infer that in many cases even the maitri might be abused. This inference is further supported by the fact that young folks appear to be more romantic during fairs and kissing at public places is not considered a taboo.

Maitri (An incident with the Investigator):—On the concluding day of the mela we were witnessing the *chela* in trance. Thereafter some young men and women were seen performing *maitri.* The District Welfare Officer Chamba who appeared to be in distress also stood before the chela and obtained his blessings. The Block Development Officer Chamba, and two Investigators from the Census Department were still discussing the system of *maitri* when a young girl from the down stairs walked up and asked one investigator to establish *maitri.* Having regard for her sentiments the investigator did not give a flat refusal but made her understand that he would be leaving very soon for a distant place and would hardly visit that place again. But she appeared to be adamant. The Block Development Officer also came to his rescue and with some difficulty they were able to put her off with fifty paise as a gift to her.

Muslim Gujjars also participate in the fair but they do not look as happy and gay as others. Gujjar women are also seldom seen merry making in the fair nor do they establish *maitri.* Handolas are big attraction to young men, women and children. Six to seven marry-go-rounds were seen in action and a gathering of more than 1,500 persons enjoyed the fair. The number of shops put up by local shopkeepers and those who come from Chamba town were as follows:—

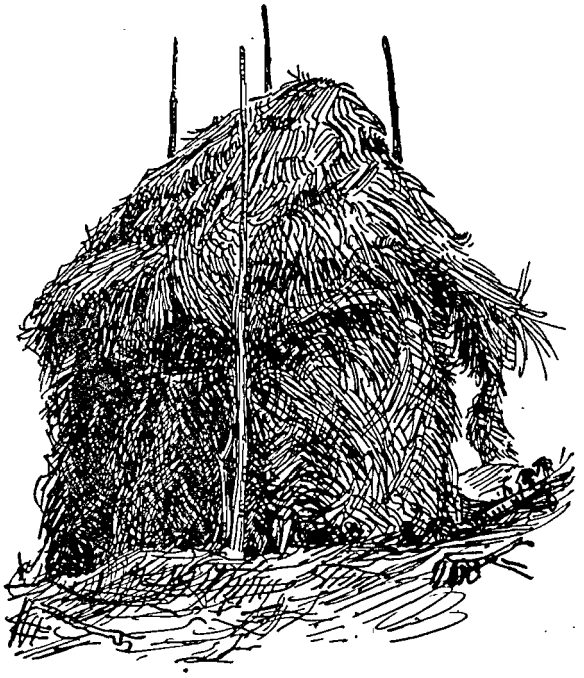
Muniary-General merchandize	15
Eating stalls	4
Confectioners	8
Chhaj seller	1
Potter	1
Basket and kilta seller	1
Photographer	1

Social Institution—The family

The family of a Gujjar in Maingal constitutes of male member-head of the family wife and children. Polygny is common among them. In case their wives cannot pull on together the husband builds separate houses for his wives and cattle are also divided. He exercises duel conrtol. The children live with their mothers. The produce is sold by the husband and he is responsible to manage the family affairs. The size of family is shown in the following table:—

Problems of Agriculture—Techniques followed are not up to the mark. The main reason is that the land is rocky, snows linger on indefinitely and local seeds are used. It is gathered that improved varieties of seeds have not been available to villagers in time. Here a great hindrance is the severety of nature. Snow falls at high slopes in November, and in the village by December. The *rabi* crops remain under snow till March and the crops are harvested in May-June. Most of the area cannot be brought under two crops.

The rainy season also sets in early. Sometimes it begins when the crops are still in the fields. About one third of the grains are destroyed. Whatever crop is out in time has to be stored in conical heap known as *khar* locally.



Khar

Manure—The only manure known to peasants is cow-dung. Artificial manures have not been introduced in the village as yet nor are the peasants willing to use them. The main reason advanced is that they can arrange reasonable quantity of cow dung.

The manure is not preserved carefully. Open heaps of manure can be found near the houses. Manure pits have not found favour with the villagers as yet.

Animal Husbandry

Animal Husbandry plays an important role in the village economy. Fourteen persons returned animal husbandry as one of their subsidiary occupation. Their sheep provide raw wool. Their cattle supply *ghee, chha* and milk for their own consumption and manure for fields. In 1961 Cattle Census the number of animals in the village was 1,826. Out of them 1,117 were sheep, 220 goats and 489 cows, bullocks or buffaloes.

The distribution of the animals is:—

1.	Bullocks above 3 years ...	109
2.	Calves over 3 years	54
3.	Cows	166
4.	Buffaloes	91
5.	Buffaloe calves under 3 years	12
6.	Cow Calves under 3 years ...	57

According to a rough estimate the milk yield was found as:—

Cow within 6 months—1½ seer daily
Cow after 6 months—1 seer daily
Buffalo within 6 months—2½ seers daily
Buffalo after 6 months—1½ seers daily

The Forest Department issues grazing permits on payment of normal fee. A distinction is made between right holder graziers and others in payment of fee and penalty. Penalty is levied when one fails to obtain a valid permit.

TABLE XIV

Charges realised for grazing

	From non-right holders		From right holders	
	Fee	Penalty	Fee	Penalty
	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.
Buffalo .	6·00	9·00	4·50	6·00
Sheep .	0·10	0·50	0·10	0·50
Goat .	0·25	1·00	0·25	1·00
Cow/Bull .	1·00	Not known	1·00	Not known

One buffalo bull and calves under one year are allowed free grazing.

The permits are issued by the Divisional Forest Officer (Chaurah) at Chamba. These permits can be checked anywhere but positively on Ravi Bridge at Chamba. All permits are valid for the period 1st June to 15th October.

Tisa, Gowari and Satyas are the markets for selling *ghee*. It was being sold at the rate of Rs. 12.00 per *batti* (Chamba *tole*) in 1962. But is mostly consumed within the family and sale is resorted only when a family may possess a milch buffalo. The *ghee* is not consumed by a villager for the first 15 days unless a seer or so has been offered to the goddess.

Grazing—It is done in the village almost in a collective way. Each member from three households take away all the cattle of the village to grazing grounds turn by turn. In

such a case a farmer may not like to send his buffalo in common stock for fear of slides and consequent injuries. The farmers may also send their sheep and goats with professional graziers to high hills. The charges of the graziers range from twenty to twenty-five naya Paise for the period from May/June to October for a sheep or goat. The grazier has no responsibility if the animal is killed by a *marauder* or if they die due to other causes provided the graziers could return the skin of the dead animal.

Distant pastures are known *odhwaries* in Chaurah. They are situated at higher altitudes about three or four miles away from the village. Some of the villagers have their lands there which are cultivated regularly. Sheds and temporary huts are constructed where cattle are kept at night. The cattle are shifted to these pastures in Jeth and remain there till early Kartik. At least one member of the family is always away from home during summer looking after the cattle at *odhwaries*.

Goat/sheep manure is considered more valuable than other manure. When the nomad graziers has to pass by the village with their flocks they rest with the flocks in the cultivable fields. In such cases the owner of the field has to serve the nomads with cooked or dry ration including firewood.

Goat hair are used to prepare strings. These strings are very strong and one seer can be obtained for Rs. 8.00. But usually they are not sold. The skins of these animals are known as *khaltus* used like bags for storing grains.

A sheep has two shearings in a year and an average sheep provides one seer of wool at a shearing. Usually every villager shears his sheep. A local Batwal who is an expert in sheep shearing gets one sheep's wool for shearing 40 sheep. The shearing is done with a typical scissors known as *kat*.

Disposal of dead Livestock—Dead goats or sheep are consumed as meat. Dead cows and buffaloes used to be burried after removing the skins by the *chanals*. After adopting their caste as Arya these people left the profession and the *sawarns* had to bury the dead animals themselves now. There is no taboo and all join in dragging the dead animal.

A Chamar from Dadion a nearby village may also be asked to the village for clearing the dead buffaloes and cows. In such case the skin of the animal is the property of a Chamar. The owner has a right to demand two pairs of *Chamba chappal* of any size free.

Also the Chamar would take free meals from the household concerned provided an animal is removed before noon.

Taboo is attached to the sale of cows. If one has to sell he usually charges around Rs. 20, which he thinks the average maintenance charges. The farmers prefer not to buy bullocks but to rear them.

Forest Economy

The forests play an important part in the economy of the village. The villagers are employed by forest contractors for extracting the timber. About 70 people are employed and they earn nearabout Rs. 4/- a day. In addition the villagers collect herbs from the jungle and sell them to the local shopkeepers. The prevailing rates of the herbs during September 1962, were:—

	Rs.	
1. Kauri Patis	30	per batti
2. Mithi Patis	2	
3. Karu	3	
4. Bankakru	2	
5. Banafsa	12	

Dhup is forbidden to be extracted from the hill tops without a valid permit from the Divisional Forest Officer, Chaurah. The fee is Rs. 5/- from non-right holders and Re. 1/- from a right holder. Though all the villagers are right holders they do not obtain permits. They gave out that permits were not allowed freely by the Forest Department. The villagers do collect herbs from the forest and sell them out. This cannot be regarded as a regular source of income and can at best be regarded as some slight monetary help to a farmer. No villager was a permit holder nor did any one admit that he was extracting *dhup* illegally.

When extracting of timber is started in the surrounding forests these people find employment as unskilled labourers with the forest contractors.

Forest Bartandari Rights—The forests around the village can be divided into four broad categories. An idea about these forests can be gained from this chart.

FORESTS

Unreserved		Reserved	
Demarcated Protected Forests (D.P.F.)	Undemarcated Protected Forests (U.P.F.)	Undemarcated Working Circle (U.W.C.)	Regular Working Circle (R.W.C.)

In all reserve forests (U.W.C. & R.W.C.) no villager becomes a right holder unless forefathers were declared such. In short only those persons can inherit rights in such forests whose forefathers were given *bartandari* rights in these forests. All the residents of Devi Kothi possess rights in such forests. Pre-requisites of right holder for obtaining trees are:—

1. That he must possess self cultivated land.
2. That he must possess a residential house which should not have been rented out.
3. He should not have sold *mezrooa* (timber trees growing on his own land) during the five years prior to the submission of application.
4. Whatever rights are obtained by him (as cheap timber trees) shall not be transferred to any other right or non-right holder in any way like sale, barter or free of charge.

The villagers of Devi Kothi have this right in Lower Tan Forest (Regular Working Circle) and jungle Devi Kothi. All non-timber trees other than *deodar, kail, tosh, rai* and *chil* are given to these right holders at the rate of 12 nP. per tree.

In unreserved forests the villagers right holders have such rights which were given to them by the early rulers of Chamba. All these rights have been defined in forests records. The common rights which are enjoyed by the villagers are:—

1. *Grazing rights free*—Grazing of all domesticated animals provided a villager is a right holder.
2. *Fire wood and Lights (Jagni)*—Removal of all dry branches, and dry logs. Removal of timber declared useless by the forest contractors, for the house construction at concessional rates.
3. Extraction of stones and clay for the house construction.
4. *Timber for house construction*—The statements below give the concessional rates for timber for house construction. (In U.W.C. forests).

TABLE XV

Rates of Timber

Class of tree	Rates for right holders			Rates for non-right holders		
	Deodar	Kail	Chir	Deodar	Kail	Chir
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
	Rs. nP.	Rs. nP.	Rs. nP.	Rs. nP.	Rs. nP.	Rs. nP.
. . . . .	Free	Free	Free	7·00	4·20	2·80
IV	0·25	0·25	0·12	35·00	21·00	14·00
III	1·00	0·50	0·25	70·00	42·00	35·00
IIA	2·00	1·00	0·50	175·00	105·00	163·00
IIB	3·00	1·50	0·75	315·00	189·00	91·00
IA	5·00	2·00	1·00	507·50	304·50	140·00
IB	..	..	..	665·00	399·00	210·00
IC	7·00	2·00	1·00	840·00	504·00	210·00
ID	..	..	..	*1050·00*	*630·00*	*210·00*

(*Source*:—Range Officer, Tisa).

The classification of timber trees is by measuring the girth of a tree.

Circumference between	2′ 1″ to 3′ 1″	=IV class
	3′ 2″ to 4′ 2″	=III ,,
	4′ 3″ to 5′ 2″	=IIA ,,
	5′ 3″ to 6′ 2″	=IIB ,,
	6′ 3″ to 7′ 3″	=IA ,,
	7′ 4″ to 8′ 4″	=IB ,,
	8′ 5″ to 9′ 4″	=IC ,,
	9′ 4″ and above	=ID ,,

The illicit cutting of timber trees is strictly guarded. Chaurah is rich in forest wealth. To protect the forests in village a guard hut has been provided. Cuttings are reported immediately and the forest department charges the prices as well as compensation from the right holders are shown on the next page. The statement shows the variation in the rates mentioned at last pages and price that has to be paid for illicit cutting. (The prices mentioned here are for *deodar* only).

The plants are spread on the ground and cattle made to tread over, winnowing is done side by side by the women. The soil of the village is un-irrigated and stony. The yield is therefore quite low i.e. 6 to 8 maunds per acre.

Local terms connected with Agricultural Operations—

Marodhi . . .	Manuring
Khawara . .	Threshing ground
Lunna . . .	Harvesting
Gahana . . .	Threshing
Punna . . .	Winnowing
Bahana . . .	Sowing
Mai pherna . .	Levelling
Parali behana .	*Deep Ploughing of the soil before* sowing wheat
Taru dena . .	Removing of pebbles and grass after 1st ploughing for paddy.
Chhumb dena . .	First harrowing and levelling the soil after sowing the paddy.
Munger pherna .	Harrowing of the soil for the second time for paddy.
Syanda . . .	Removing the weeds in paddy fields in September.
Sita . . .	Cob.
Harrom dena . .	Harrowing of paddy fields for the third time.
Harod dena . .	Light ploughing
Kohar . . .	1st harrowing for Koda
Dohar . . .	2nd harrowing for Koda
Trehar . . .	3rd harrowing for Koda
Chohar . . .	4th harrowing for Koda.

Agricultural implements

The tools and equipment used by the villargers are age-old. In most of the cases, they are locally made. Some are purchased from Mandi. The villagers get their implements prepared from Brestu, a blacksmith in village **Kathiana**, about half a mile from the village. The blacksmith gets 8 seers of grains at the harvesting of Kharif crop and 4 seers of grains at Rabi crop for sharpening and repairs of the implements from time to time. For making new implements the charges are different for different implements. The list of the implements is given below:—

Implement	Use	Approximate Cost
Aree—Saw	Cutting wood	3·00
Axe	Cutting wood	5·00
Belcha—spade	Digging	6·00
Daulti	Harrowing	5·00
Dratu—sickle	Harvesting	1·50
Darat—bigger sickle	Cutting wood	4·00
Gainti	Digging	8·00
Hal—Plough	Ploughing	10·00
Jungra—Yoke	Yoking the bulls	6·00
Jhabbal	Digging	25·00
Kodal	Hoeing	3·00
Khilni	Hoeing	1·00
Kilta	Carrying manure	2 00
Khurpi	Hoeing	1·50
Mai	Levelling	3·00
Jhawra	Digging	4·00
Patha	Measuring grains	1·00
Shoop	Winnowing	2·00
Tokri	Carrying grains	1·00

Weeds—The various weeds which grow in the village are Jawi, Rori, Pit Papra, Dudhi, Gungra and Milkari. These are removed by hand.

Pest and Diseases

Crop	Pest	Disease
Paddy	White ant, Rats	1. Semi loose smut and loose smut 2. Rusts
Maize	Maize borer, Blester, beatle	..
Paddy	Rice Hispa, Rice lug, Rice beatle	Paddy blast.
Wheat	White ant, rats	Wheat rusts loo e smut

Organisation of Man-Power

All the members of the family contribute at the time of various agricultural activities. While the men perform the hard duties like ploughing and digging, women perform most of the work pertaining to sowing, hoeing, weeding and harvesting and winnowing. They also help in carrying the harvest, manure and husk. Apart from this they attend to cattles, clean the shed and sweep the threshing ground.

During the peak season, if a household cannot cope with the work, they have to engage labourers. These are Chamars and are engaged for carrying manure while sowing and harvesting of wheat. For paddy, labourers are engaged for harvesting. These labourers are paid 2 pathas of paddy per day plus meals for the day. A patha weighs about 1.75 kgs.

Animal Husbandry

Live Stock—The table gives the position of live-stock possessed by the villagers :—

Caste	Cows		He-calves		She-calves		Goats		Sheep		Buffalo		Bulls		Poultry birds	
	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.	No. of House-holds	Total No.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
Rajput . .	19	53	13	28	8	12	8	125	13	66	12	25	17	51	..	..
Chamar . .	12	24	4	6	2	3	1	14	2	3	5	6	13	28	3	8
Hesi . .	1	2	1	2	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..

Out of total of 36 households, 32 households possess cows. The total number of cows in the village is 79. Thus each household has more than two cows. Thirteen households of Rajputs, 4 households of Chamars and one household of Hesi have 36 he-calves. Ten households possess 15 she-calves. 31 buffaloes are possessed by 12 households of Rajputs and 5 of Chamars. Thirty households have 79 bulls. Poultry birds are possessed by Chamars only. Three households have 8 birds. There are 139 goats and 69 sheep possessed by 24 households. The milch cattle with the villagers are thus plenty in number. The yield from these cattle is low ranging from 8 to 12 chhataks per day. Poultry birds are not popular in the village. This can be a good industry if the villagers are induced to keep these birds. They have a ready market at Mandi for poultry produce.

The villagers buy their buffaloes, cows and bulls from Bhangrotu and Suket at the time of Nalwari fair. They also sell their unwanted cattle to the traders who come from Rupar, Hoshiarpur and Haryana. Mostly these traders purchase calves and weak bulls of hill breed at cheap price. They feed these cattle well and sell at handsome price next year. A pair of good desi bullocks may cost 300 to 500. The villlagers go in for cheap bullocks, costing Rs. 200 to 300 a pair.

Buffaloes—There are 31 buffaloes in the village. These are owned by 12 households of Rajputs and 5 of Chamars. All these buffaloes are of pahari breed. The buffaloes generally start yielding milk at the age of 3 to 4 years and continue for 8 to 9 years. Daily milk yield per buffalo is 3 to 5 seers. A pahari buffalo cost Rs. 200 to Rs. 300. The cattle are given green leaves, grass, dried hay and sometime oil cakes and chokar. The villagers give salt to the cattle to lick.

Sheep and Goats—There are 139 goats and 69 sheep in the village. These are purchased from Gaddis who wander near about in winter, for 10 to 12 rupees. Generally, these are purchased as kids and lambs at Rs. 10 or 12 per head and are also sold at a handsome price of Rs. 40 to 50 per goat. Apart from fetching money, the goats are good source of supply of manure. The sheep are reared for obtaining wool which the villagers spin and make cloth and pattoos.

The cattle are kept in sheds during the night. These sheds are a hut sort of construction with thatched roofs. Some of the sheds have bamboo walls. Every household possessing cattle, has a shed adjacent to the main house. The villagers keep the sheds clean, but the construction of the sheds are such that they are dingy dump and dark. The breed of the cattle in the village is the sound as in other hill villages.

Household Industries

The prominent household industry in the village is tanning and shoe-making. It is practised by 9 households of Chamars. Five of them have tanning and shoe-making as primary occupation. Apart from this, the ladies of the village spin wool, make mats khajara chatais and binas (seats) of maize stalk. A couple of boys are receiving training in sericulture at Mandi. These boys are of the view that there will be no scope for their work in the village and they shall prefer to be employed some-where after the completion of their training. A villager had a loom some ten years ago, but, then he

died and the work was not attended to by any body. The loom was still lying in his house.

Tanning and Shoe-making—The dead buffaloes are the pre-requisite of the Chamars engaged in tanning and shoe-making. In return, the Chamar has to give two pairs of desi shoes to the owner of the buffaloe. After removing the skin from the dead animal, it is dried thoroughly in the sun for 5 to 7 days. Then it is kept immersed in water containing lime, for 3 to 5 days. This is followed by cleaning the skin thoroughly. For this purpose, the skin is kept in running water for 8 to 10 days. It is then again kept immersed in water containing powdered leaves of ambla trees. Then the skin is filled with water containing bark of ban and sama tree and kept suspended for two to three days. The tanning process is complete after drying the skin thoroughly.

Besides making ordinary desi juta, the shoe-makers of Bir also prepare jutas having beautiful tilla embroidery. The raw material used for making shoes consists of leather, golden thread and ordinary thread. The tools used are:—

1.	Mungri	for beating the leather
2.	Rambi	for cutting the leather
3.	Kundi	for stitching
4.	Laplayar	for punching
5.	Furma	shoe frame
6.	Shil	a slab of stone
7.	Fali	cutting is done on it.
8.	Jamoor	for stretching the leather
9.	Sansi	for stretching the leather
10.	Punch	for slotting.

The process of making shoes is universal and simple. For soling, thick leather is used and it is prepared separately first. Then the upper part is cut according to the required design. Embroidery is done by the women and when the upper is ready, it is stitched with bottom already prepared. Generally payment is made in grains. For one pair of mardana (male) juta, the cobbler gets 6 kg. of grains and for a pair of Zenana (female) juta 5 Kg. of grains. For repairs, the cobbler gets about 19 kg. of grains at the time of harvesting.

Carpentry—There is only one carpenter in the village. Apart from the wooden parts of agricultural implements the carpenter is engaged in the construction of houses. In Bir, carpenter is paid in cash and the wages vary from Rs. 5 to Rs. 6 per day. The tools used are usual which consist of a saw, tesa, files, randa, barma, nihan, hammers. zammoor, sanni, pendulum and a spirit level and a measuring tape or foot-measure.

Basket-making—There is one basket maker in village Deodha, a mile from the village. The villagers employ him when they feel the need of baskets etc. In addition to the meals for the full day his charges are:—

Basket—2 seers of grains for a basket of capacity of 20 seers.

Changer—8 seers of grains.

Jirda—2 seers per yard.

Obnu—4 seers.

Peru—2 seers of grains for a peru of 20 seers capacity.

Winnowing Fan—4 seers.

The raw material i.e. bamboo is supplied by the villagers. The technique of making all these articles is the same as else-where.

Khajra mats—A plant known as khajra is found in abundance in the forests near the village. Women folk set out early in the morning and come back near-about noon-time with a heap of khajra leaves on their head. These leaves are then dried and woven with hand to make a beautiful mat. No instrument is used for making these mats. Some times, these leaves are dyed by boiling them in water to which red or blue or green dye purchased from Mandi is added. These dyed leaves are used to weave various patterns.

Co-operative Societies and Panchayats

Bahudya Sehkari Sabha Samiti, Bir—The Multipurpose Co-operative Society, Bir has been functioning under the name and style of Bahudaya Sehkari Sabha Samiti, Bir since 20th November, 1955 with its office at Lag. This society covers all the villages included in the Panchayat Circle, Tarnoh. The objectives of the society are:—

(1) To advance loans to the members to purchase land, bulls, agricultural implements and seeds.

fruit trees. Persimmon, pomergranates, jujufus, lime, guava, plum, grape-fruit oranges, *loquat, jaman, lichi* and bananas are grown in the adjoining villages of Chaba, Matiogri, Begain and Basantpur. Some of the villagers, who possess *nautor* land above the Simla-Tatapani motor road have now started growing some of these fruits. Villagers feel mango trees are difficult to grow and that it takes years before any results are achieved; *papita* is short lived while guava requires a lot of looking after against parrots during the days and against flying bats during the night. These bats are a perpetual chirping and infuriating little birds who have lived in the neighbourhood across the river—on *shisham* and old mango trees—and who are a great nuisance since decades.

Pests and crop diseases

There are many diseases from which the crops of the villagers suffer. The major diseases diagnosed and cured by the farmers are:—

Malahi—A sort of insect which cuts the roots of the wheat crop. At the time of first plough the farmers collect the insect from the field and throw it away in Sutlej. There is no other effective control for this insect.

Mankharu—Small insect which cuts the top leaves of paddy plants. They know no local cure.

Jhálá—A sort of disease to maize and *mash* crop which results in drying up the leaves of maize plant, which however, remains green. As a result of this disease ¼th of the crop fails.

Kungi—This disease is confined to wheat crop. Wheat plants turn red and yield comparatively 25 per cent less wheat than the usual yield. The disease is due to cloudy season.

There is another disease affecting chillies and paddy, as a result of which chillies and paddy plants dry up and yield no fruit. No name is given to this disease.

Agricultural Implements

A list of agricultural implements with their costs and life are given in table XXIII. All these implements are made by the local blacksmith. The villagers supply the material and also help the blacksmith in lighting the furnace while the blacksmith makes the implements. He is paid for his services by way of *anaj* (foodgrains). Besides, he also undertakes to repair the implements of his clients who make customary payments of *anaj* to him at every harvest. The blacksmith charges at the following rates for making implements:—

TABLE XXIII

Implement	Use	Cost Rs. nP.	Duration
Plough (Hal)	Ploughing	4·00	One to two years.
Halash	..	10·00	5 years
Arhi	..	0·50	5 years
Blade (phale)	..	4·00	3 to 4 years
Yoke (Jungla)	..	8·00	5 years
Plain (moi)	..	12·00	8 years
Phalli (Plain used in paddy cultivation)	..	12·00	8 years
Gaan	Weeding maize fields	5·00	15 years
Khilni	Weeding	2·00	2 years
Kudaluro Khilnu	Digging	3·00	2 years
Kudali	..	4·00	4 years
Kudal	..	5·00	10 years
Drati (Sickle)	Harvesting	1·50	2 years
Drat	Cutting branches for firewood	3·00	3 years

Plough	1. Hal	2 *pathas* (4 seers) of the grains of the season.
	2. Halash	2 *pathas* of the grains of the season.
Jungla		2 *pathas* of the grains of the season.
Gaan		5 to 9 seers depending on the number of teeth.

Marketing of Produce

Table XXIV gives a rough idea of the surplus produce which is left with the village, as a whole, for sale, after it has been consumed at home. This information is for the year 1961-62.

The villagers sell their surplus foodgrains to the shopkeepers at Shakrori and at Seoni. But they sell peas in the vegetable market at Simla. The prices at which the villagers sold their produce in 1961-62 were roughly—

1. Rice	Rs. 18 to Rs. 25 per md.
2. Wheat	Rs. 15 per md.
3. Maize	Rs. 10 per md.
4. Barley	Rs. 11 per md.
5. Green peas	Rs. 18 per md.
6. Peas seed	Rs. 30 per md.
7. Onion	Rs. 10 per md.
8. Potatoes	Rs. 10 per md.

TABLE XXIV

Product	Quantity produced	Quantity consumed	Quantity available for sale
	Mds.	Mds.	Mds.
1. Paddy . . .	346	281	65
2. Wheat . . .	937	762	175
3. Maize . . .	933	749	184
4. Pulses . . .	25	25	..
5. Barley . . .	95	92	3
6. Peas . . .	107	15	92
7. Oilseeds . .	10	10	..
8. Onions . . .	8	7	1
9. Chillies . . .	1	1	..
10. Kulth . . .	2	2	..
11. Potatoes . .	23	15	8

There is a distinct change over what used to be the marketing arrangements in the past. Formerly the peasant was obliged to sell his produce to his *mahajan*—a shopkeeper at Seoni. The shopkeeper would always keep his debtors in a position where they could be exploited to the best advantage. Now, with better yields and a better market, they sell their produce like peas and rice, maize and vegetables direct at Simla. While in certain cases, some wandering shopkeepers from Simla or other places go to Shakrori and purchase the produce at local rates which are no doubt less than the market rates, yet better than the rates, the peasants would get from the shopkeepers, at Seoni. The agents from Simla generally purchase the foodgrains at Rs. 3 to Rs. 5 per maund less than the price at Simla. This is because the peasants, are sometimes pessimistic and think it better to sell at their homes even for a lower price than to go to Simla, taking all their produce there. They say it would be uneconomic for them to go and spend for their boarding and lodging at Simla and then they might not get a fair price for their goods after all.

Animal Husbandry

Live Stock—We gather that villagers sometimes buy their buffaloes and cows from traders of Bilaspur and from fairs at Rupar. These traders may bring calves and sell them to the villagers whenever they come across them. A pair of good *desi* bullocks may cost them from Rs. 300 to Rs. 500 or Rs. 700 to Rs. 800. A buffalo may cost them from Rs. 300 to Rs. 500. We have not come across any very good pair of *desi* buffaloes, but they are *pahari* Nilli-buffaloes. The cows are slightly bigger than what we have seen them in other villages, but their milk yield is poor. Livestock with the villagers in Shakrori is given in table XXV.

Buffaloes—There are only 2 *desi* buffaloes (*Gujaroo*) as against 59 *pahari*. Villagers generally purchase them from nearabout villages in Suket, Arki, Nalagarh and Bilaspur. *Desi* or *Gujaroo* buffaloes have also been bought from near Simla, where they had come from the plains. The buffaloes generally start yielding milk at the age of $3\frac{1}{2}$-4 years and continue for about 8 to 9 years. Daily milk yield per buffaloe being about 8 to 9 seers (Desi) and 3 to 4 seers (Pahari). A *desi* buffaloe costs from 500 to 700 rupees while *pahari* buffaloe costs from 200 to 300 rupees. The cattle are given *buel* leaves, grass, and oil-cakes and even *chokar*, but the villagers do not form the systematic schedule about their diet. They are also sometimes given salt. At least one member from every household daily wakes early in the morning and goes to Moongna (5 miles) to fetch grass for the cattle.

Goats—While going around some of these homes, we came across a number of goats and sheep, many of which have been bought from the Kinnauras that go by, for ten to twelve rupees. They are bought as kids and lambs and are sometimes sold at a price between Rs. 50 and Rs. 80 when grown up. These Kinnauras come from Asrang, Raurang, Kilba, Duna, Pangi, Spillo and Sorang. The goats supply wool for *kharchas* (goat hair mats) and besides meat, they also provide a good manure. Their rearing is cheaper than other livestock and there are *ghasnis* and scrub forests which provide ample food for them. Even landless labourers may also possess a few goats. The goats and sheep sold by the Kinnauras are however, not of improved variety.

Kidding is about twice in fourteen months, and high fertility always brings about an income to the owner. The bigger goats and sheep are sold here, by the villagers, and not the kids. It is likely that more people may take to keeping goats and sheep though they have a habit of nibbling the leaves of forests and all varieties of plants, and are considered a pest at times. We cannot eliminate goats from rural economy. (The hair of Himalayan goats find their way with the Kinnauras). Thousands and thousands have been trecking along and passing these villages since by-gone ages.

TABLE XXV

Caste	Bulls		Buffaloes		Cows		Calves	Sheep	Goat	Hens	Cocks
	Desi	Pahari	Desi	Pahari	Desi	Pahari					
Brahman	9	25	1	18	3	28	26	9	26	9	5
Rajput	23	35	1	34	1	43	50	11	27	13	11
Lohar	2	10	..	4	1	16	9	1	..	3	..
Chamar	..	2	..	2	..	3	1	..	..	1	1
Sood	..	..	..	..	..	1	1	..	..	..	..
Kumhar	2	6	..	1	..	6	4	2	..	2	..
Total	36	78	2	59	5	97	91	23	53	28	17

A Kinnaura family has been coming to Shakrori and Seoni for the last 24 years. They have their tremendous good-will in the village and for those, in whose *dhogris* they stay, and in whose fields they lodge for winter, they invariably bring *shawls, chuli, chilgoza* and, we are not so sure, even *anguri*. The soft warm fibre wool is not the best as one would expect. It is slightly rough, but the villagers seem to be satisfied with the goat, the sheep, the wool and the finished products. It is quite common to see young boys, young men, or old women or young women beating all their cattle back from the spring or from around in the grazing fields and in the scrub forests. They are few with some families and, therefore, they do not have a *gaddi* dog to look after them. The goats are fed on leaves of *kikar, ber,* bushes of *karonda, basuti* and *pipal* leaves.

There is no cattle-pound. So the fuming cultivators settle around calmly when any of these cattle stray across. Either the cattle are thrashed or the shepherd. Goat's milk is seldom sold. (The goat manure is more useful than the cow manure, but it is mixed with other manure and finally cast into the fields).

Veterinary Hospital

The Veterinary Hospital of Seoni, started in May, 1957, covers the whole of Seoni Sub-Tehsil and one Patwar circle of Karsog Tehsil. A veterinary Assistant Surgeon is incharge of the hospital. The hospital attends to about 15 cattle daily. Most common cases detected by the hospital are simple wounds, lousiness, fever, bronchitis, indigestion, dyspepsia, diarrhoea and broken horns. From 1957 to 1962 there have been only 7 out-breaks of foot and mouth disease but they were rapidly checked from spreading.

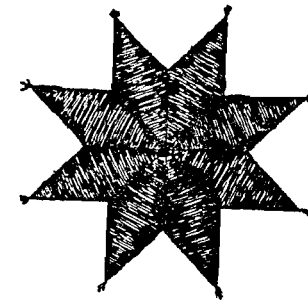
For improving the breed of the cattle, the hospital keeps one cow bull of *jersey-sindhi* type and one *murrah* buffaloe bull.

The poultry unit attached to the hospital keeps improved white leg horn. Besides giving demonstration to the villagers, the unit also supplies eggs for hatching and for eating.

Poultry

The villagers possess about 40 to 50 birds. It was only 3 or 4 years back that they started taking some interest in poultry. Only two households possess improved birds. A Brahman from the neighbouring village of Matiogri has, however, started a poultry farm on a larger scale. He has some two hundred birds, all of improved variety. People do not generally sell the birds for eating, but eggs are sold by all who have them spare. The eggs at Matiogri are sold at the rate of 3 annas per egg, and good chicken costs about Rs. 6 to Rs. 10 a bird.





10 *Village Crafts*

THE seasonal and "organic" character of agricultural production calls for other occupations and pursuits to fill the resulting periods of partial or total inactivity. The most natural of these supplementary occupations were originally and, to a large extent, sill remain the transformation and finishing of agricultural raw materials by the agriculturist himself. All the basic human wants are provided in the household economy. Not only food, but principal clothing and housing material are also prepared. We take to some of the villagers who do this.

Spinning

The few sheep owned by some households provide wool. This may also be purchased from *Kinnauras*. After it has been teased with fingers and particles of twigs and leaves or any dirt, are removed, the wool is pulled out from a matted state and kept in neat little baskets or *chhikkus*.

The spinning is done with *taklu* or spindle, which consists of a thin round piece of hardwood, about ten inches long and a whirl or *chhatr* also made of hardwood, attached to it some two inches from the bottom. For spinning the wool is twisted to the desired thickness with the right hand fingers and is tied round the *dandi* (shaft) of the *taklu*. Having drawn out about two feet of wool and holding it with right fingers and thumb the *taklu* is given a sharp twist. When the wool is well twisted, the *taklu* is stopped and the spun yarn is wound on its shaft. The process is repeated till the *taklu* is all full of the spun yarn.

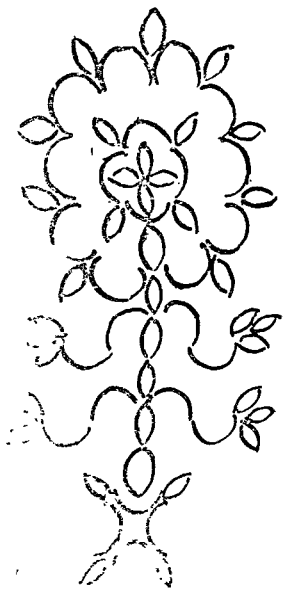
Weaving

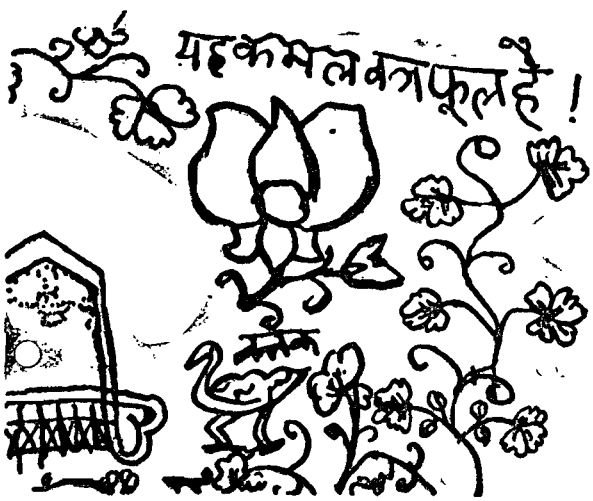
Villagers have to depend mostly upon a centinarian in the neighbouring village of Zedwin for weaving. The weaving is done on the pitlooms which the weaver has made. The shuttle or *nalu*, containing thread for the weft, in this type of loom, is thrown across the warp by hand. The loom is installed in a separate shed, which houses one more loom and is twelve feet square.

The main material used for weaving is spun wool and is provided by the customers. The dyed marino yarn for the designs is generally provided by the weaver himself who purchases them from *Kinnauras* or from Seoni or Simla. The designs on the *pattus* and cotton *chaddars* if at all there are any, are geometrical. The most common are the checks for which the weaver does not use any graph papers; he prepares the warp by counting the threads and inserting dyed marino at regular intervals and for the weft he uses a small match stick as a scale for using coloured yarn at appropriate places

Articles produced—

Pattu (a sort of blanket)—9 *haths* long and 3 *haths* wide.





4. *Gharyali*—A platform near the kitchen used for keeping the utensils.
5. *Chara*—An outlet for the outflow of water in one corner of the room.
6. *Dragala or Behi*—Projected verandah in the floor.
7. *Khudi*—Niche in the wall.
8. *Tohlu*—Round holes in the partitioned wall.
9. *Thumbi*—Wooden pillars.
10. *Chobu*—An opening to the second floor from *obra* in one corner.
11. *Bonti*—A slate is removed to serve as an outlet for smoke.
12. *Hadupu*—Platform erected by the side of kitchen hearth for keeping the utensils.
13. *Thhatasaris*—The thick planks on which slates are fixed.
14. *Nahas*—The thick plank or *thhatasaris* which rest on the wooden purlins.
15. *Kanaran*—One end each of the rafters rests on the wooden plates fixed in the wall, the other end on the central beam.
16. *Farque*—When wooden planks are fixed in between joists instead of filling the space with masonry such walls are called *farques* and are generally in the second storey.

Migration

Some villagers own goats and sheep. Each shepherd is allotted a particular pasture of *dhar* for his own flock consisting of a number of goats and sheep. Intensive grazing for generations led to erosion. To check this trouble passes are issued. The areas round about have been declared Reserved Forests and the infringement of the rules is followed either by cash penalty or forfeiture of the animal.

The persons who take to this seasonal migration are the ones who have a sizeable flock to tend. They readily get work during the intervening period. A few of them migrate during the winter. They do so out of convention and due to the cold and to get a grazing ground for the flocks.

A few have purchased some land. The number of migratories thus hardly comes to 15 per cent of the total population.

Migration starts in September-October and is collectively known as *gana*. The route adopted is generally the shortest one and a number of mountain ranges have to be crossed over to reach the plains of Shahpur and Kangra. There are a number of passes in the outer Himalaya or *Dhaula Dhar* between the Ravi valley and Bhattiyat. These are Chuari or Basodan with a height of 8,000 feet, Kali Nali between Mahla and Raipur with a height of 8,900 feet, Mahli between Mahla and Tundi at a height of 8,600 feet and Loa between Mahla and Bhatti Tikri with 10,500 feet. Except for the Chuari pass which is crossed over by a mule track, the others are practical only for men and goats and sheep. While on the move, these shepherds and owners of flocks travel very lightly. Few personal belongings are kept. Except for the dress which is on at the start of journey, little or spare clothes are

carried. Legs remain bare and a *cholā* and *dora* alongwith the cap is all the shepherd is dressed in on these marches. Then of course, he may have a *jarelu*—made out of goats hair for his feet.

The women accompany them and are dressed as usual. For bedding they may have one or two *pattus* which would be of thick wool and are kept tied around the waist. A few utensils, a *hooka* and a *khalru* full of maize flour, some salt, chillies and occasionally some pulses are carried. These men have become so much used to the hard nomadic life, their job entails that to sleep in the open under a cloudy sky is a common habit for them. Whenever it rains, they just look up for some projected rock or a cave shelter and can pass the night leisurely huddled together. Generally the sides of a river or *nullahs* are selected to pass the night. Possibly that is due to the closeness of water.

During the period that is spent in the plains, they take to a number of jobs apart from grazing the flocks. Once a while their women folk work as maid-servants and to see them pounding the paddy is common enough. Men work mostly as labourers on the farms. In this way they accumulate some cash. In the course of journey, some business is also conducted.

A Gaddi is an astute business man and would part with his goat and sheep only when a satisfactory bargain is struck.

I am reminded of the words of a Gaddi shepherd near about Gehra—He with his 6 hundred goats or so, and me in the Deputy Commissioner's Jeep—Being thoroughly annoyed with himself—his sheep, and a nasty stare at me, he had a simple but very philosophic remark to make, "In all these years wherever I have taken my sheep, no matter what route I chose Government has improved and made a better road or is intending that—And behold—this old beaten track—below these rocks was our beaten track for centuries a jeep has started plying—God only knows what happens next. I and my sheep seem to be precursor of all road development programme."

The seasonal migration has effect on the economic and social life of the village. Cash is brought back into the anaemic economy of the village and the slightly enhanced spending power of the people enables them to have a few necessities of life. This in turn, gives encouragement to the petty grocers to enlarge the scope of their little business. Migration leads to a number of other consequences as well. Non-availability of food grains is the ill effect of the migratory habits rather than the cause of it. The people migrate during October, November and return from April to June; *kharif* crop is harvested in a hurry as the passes have to be crossed over before winter sets in. Again, due to the late arrival, *rabi* crop is sown without much regard being paid to the levelling and manuring of fields. Besides, much of period is taken unnecessarily in the journey. On the social side, change of ideas takes place and consequently superstitions yield place to a slight change in the approach towards life. These villagers are developing interest in their children's education which is confirmed by the small kids running to school every morning. The traditional dress is being discarded by the new generation.

Dress

The dress worn by Gaddis is distinct from that worn in the plains and is "Characteristic and striking" in its varied aspects. Generally they use the woollen garments because of the cold climate but in summer cotton clothes can also be used. Traditional dresses continue to be worn and a mythological importance is attached to them. They hold the belief that Lord Shiva also used the same type of dress. There is no distinction of dress as between the castes. On occasion of mournings, only the coloured clothes are avoided. Otherwise this remains unchanged.

Dora—It forms an indispensable part of the dress used both by men and women. Apparently it is an attractive woollen tassel 15 to 25 yards long. Made of sheep's wool, it is black in colour. This is tied round the waist.

Men's Dress

Head Dress—The head dress for men is of a peculiar shape with a flap round the margin and a peak like projection in the centre. The peak is believed to represent the Kailash of Mani Mahesh—an abode of Lord Shiva and as such rightly depicts the religious sentiments of the Gaddis. The flap is tied up for ordinary wear but let down over the ears and neck in times of mourning and also in the severe weather. This style of head dress is falling into disuse and even an ceremonial occasions it is being replaced by the *pagdi* or a woollen *topa* which may be slightly embroidered.

Chola—On the body a *pattu* forming a sort of a coat, known as *chola* is worn. This reaches below the knees having deep collars which hang loose in two lappets in front, various articles such as needle, thread and

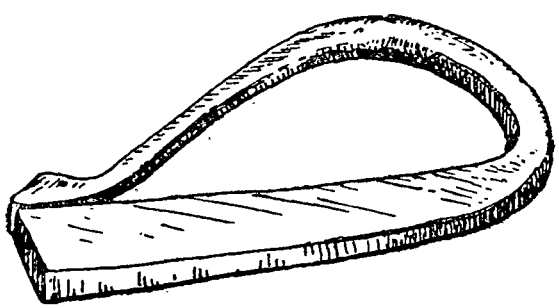
pieces of paper are tucked away in it. The *chola* is tightened round the waist by *dora* of many yards.

The *chola* may consume as much as 20 yards of cloth as the front and parts lengthwise from the centre are kept deliberately loose. *Chola* with some glass tinsels or coloured embroidery are used on festive occasions.

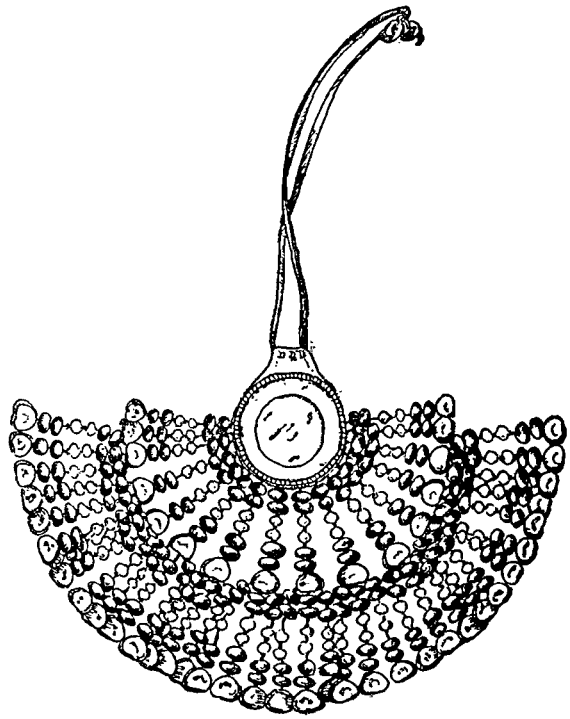
From the girdle there hangs a knife, a *runka* for striking a light, and a *mandua* in which his money and other small articles of every-day requirements are carried. Dangling from the *dora* there may be a cheap round looking glass adorned with *rattis*. This is called *gharat* and the *jhalar* that hangs down below the mirror is *Chhatta*.



Mandua

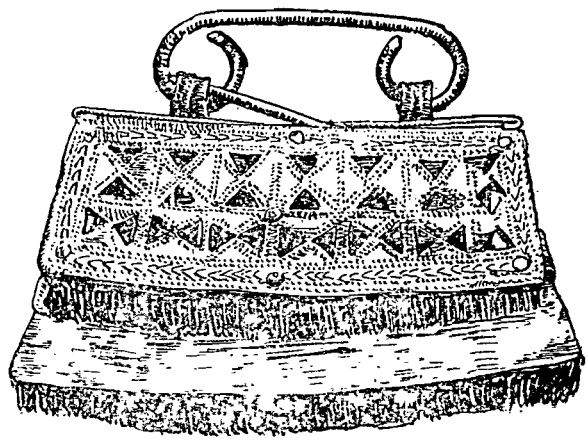


Runka



Chatta

Khukh—The upper portion above the waist is called *khukh*. Being loose it provides space to keep many articles of daily requirement. A shepherd on the move may have four or five newly born lambs stowed away in this space, meals tied up in an untanned leather pouch, a similar pouch full of tobacco, a flint, a knife, a flute and another pouch having tinder for lighting up the fire are all tucked up in the *dora*. Now the flint and the tinder are being replaced by the match box.



Runka

CONTENTS

		Page
FOREWORD		iii
PREFACE		vii

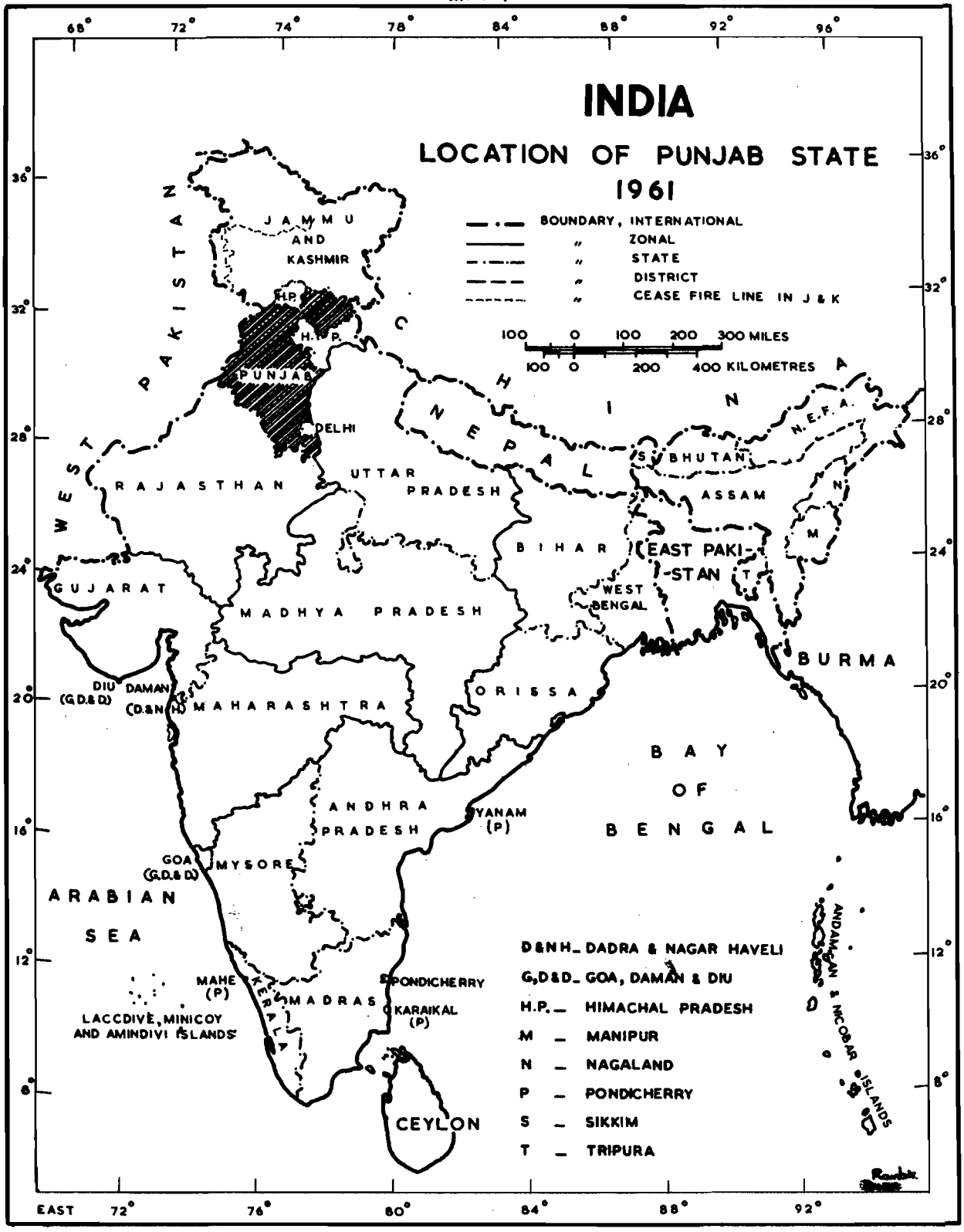
LAND

Map No.		
1.	INDIA : Location of Punjab State : 1961	3
2.	PUNJAB : Administrative Divisions : 1961	4
3.	Changes in Administrative Divisions : 1951-61	5
4.	Physiography	6
5.	Drainage System	7
6.	Normal temperature conditions	8
7.	Wind roses	9
8.	Mean annual rainfall	10
9A.	Mean monthly rainfall : January	11
9B.	Mean monthly rainfall : February	12
9C.	Mean monthly rainfall : March	13
9D.	Mean monthly rainfall : April	14
9E.	Mean monthly rainfall : May	15
9F.	Mean monthly rainfall : June	16
9G.	Mean monthly rainfall : July	17
9H.	Mean monthly rainfall : August	18
9I.	Mean monthly rainfall : September	19
9J.	Mean monthly rainfall : October	20
9K.	Mean monthly rainfall : November	21
9L.	Mean monthly rainfall : December	22
10.	Rainfall reliability	23
11.	Rainfall regions by extent of precipitation and reliability (related to irrigatiocal needs)	24
12.	Distribution of minerals	25
13.	Vegetation types	26
14.	Soils	27
15.	Archaeology	28

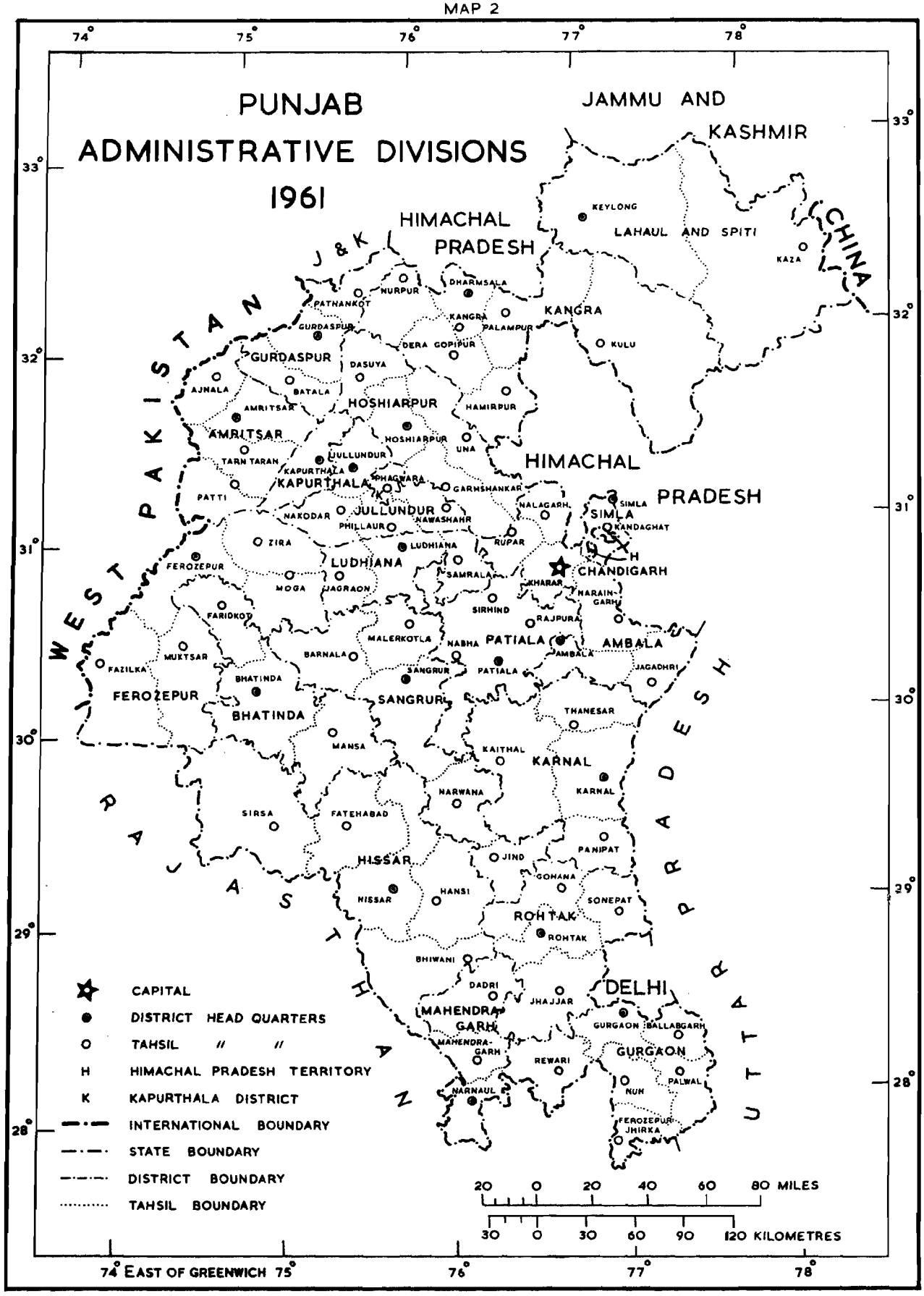
MAN

16.	Distribution of rural population : 1961	31
17.	Distribution of urban population : 1961	32
18.	Density of population : 1961	33

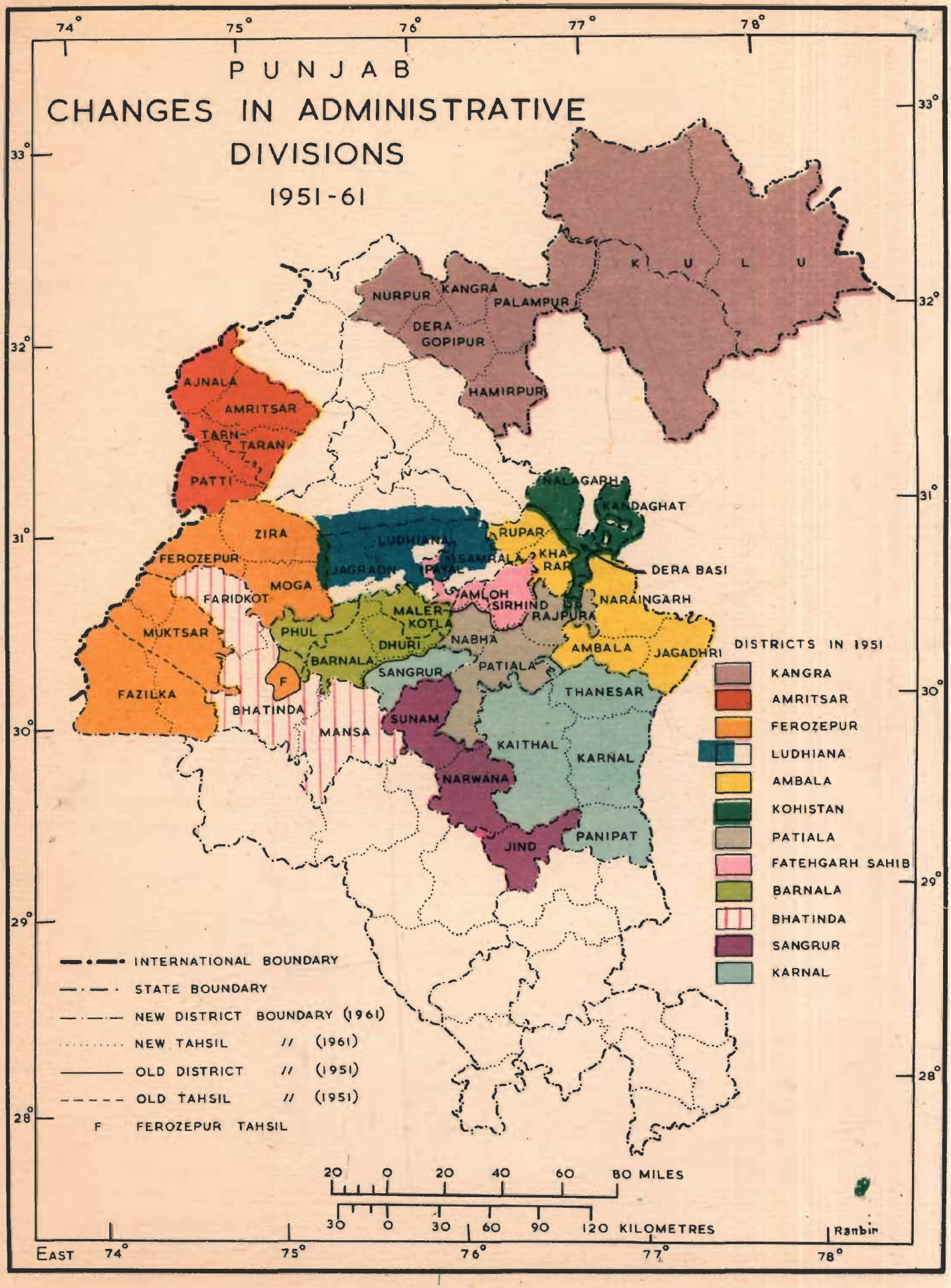
MAP I


INDIA
LOCATION OF PUNJAB STATE
1961
BOUNDARY, INTERNATIONAL
" ZONAL
" STATE
" DISTRICT
" CEASE FIRE LINE IN J & K
100 0 100 200 300 MILES
100 0 200 400 KILOMETRES
JAMMU AND KASHMIR
H.P.
H. P.
PUNJAB
DELHI
RAJASTHAN
UTTAR PRADESH
BIHAR
WEST BENGAL
EAST PAKI-STAN
ASSAM
N.E.F.A.
BHUTAN
NEPAL
CHINA
PAKISTAN
WEST
GUJARAT
MADHYA PRADESH
ORISSA
BURMA
DIU (G.D.&D.)
DAMAN (D.&N.H.)
MAHARASHTRA
ANDHRA PRADESH
YANAM (P)
BAY OF BENGAL
GOA (G.D.&D.)
MYSORE
ARABIAN SEA
MAHE (P)
KERALA
MADRAS
PONDICHERRY
KARAIKAL (P)
LACCDIVE, MINICOY AND AMINDIVI ISLANDS
CEYLON
ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS
D&NH_ DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI
G,D&D_ GOA, DAMAN & DIU
H.P._ HIMACHAL PRADESH
M _ MANIPUR
N _ NAGALAND
P _ PONDICHERRY
S _ SIKKIM
T _ TRIPURA
EAST
68°
72°
74°
76°
78°
80°
84°
88°
92°
96°
36°
32°
28°
24°
20°
16°
12°
8°

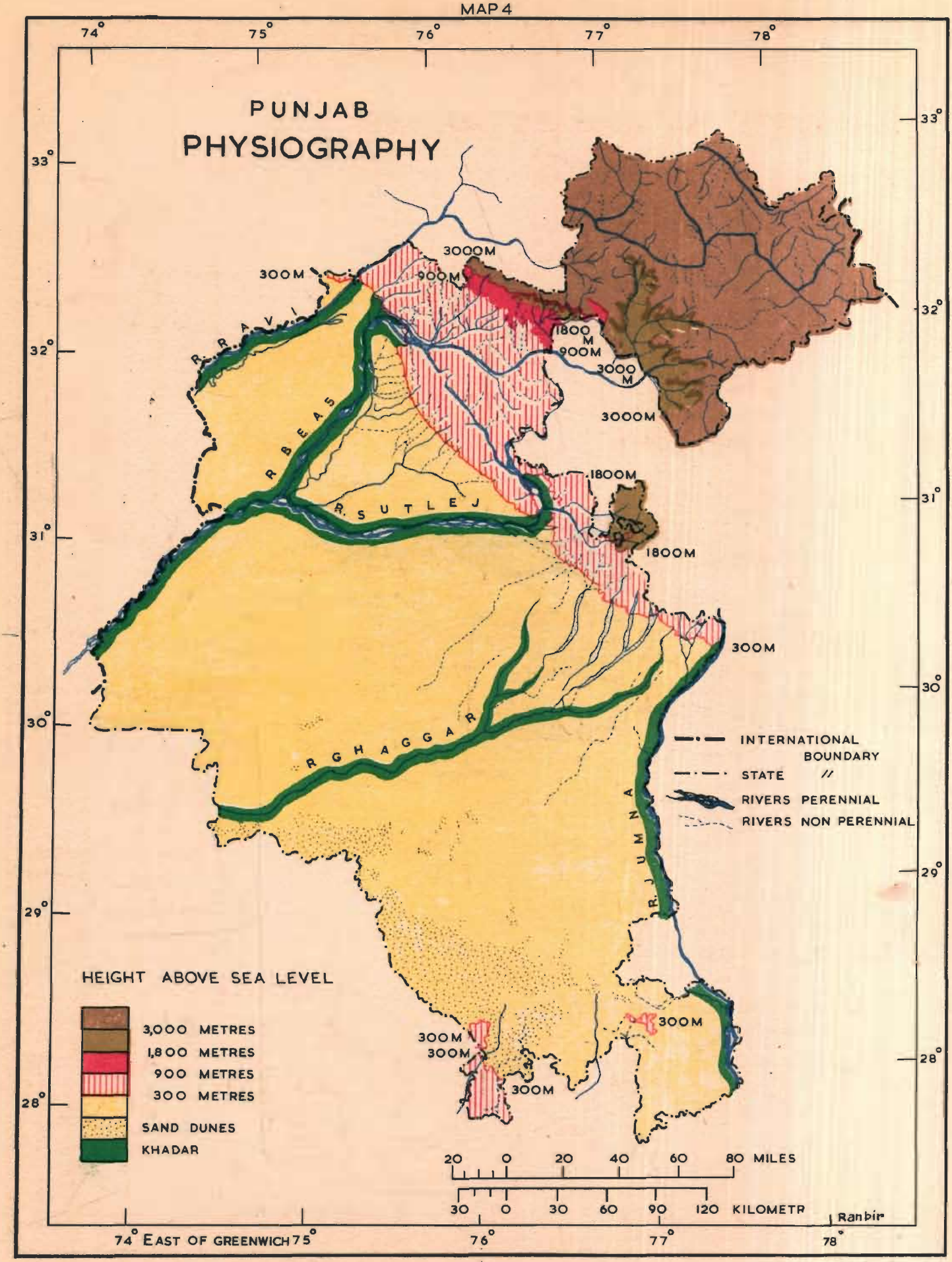
MAP 2


PUNJAB
ADMINISTRATIVE DIVISIONS
1961
JAMMU AND KASHMIR
HIMACHAL PRADESH
CHINA
J & K
WEST PAKISTAN
RAJASTHAN
UTTAR PRADESH
KEYLONG
LAHAUL AND SPITI
KAZA
DHARMSALA
NURPUR
PATHANKOT
KANGRA
PALAMPUR
KULU
GURDASPUR
DERA GOPIPUR
DASUYA
AJNALA
BATALA
HOSHIARPUR
HAMIRPUR
AMRITSAR
UNA
TARN TARAN
LULLUNDUR
KAPURTHALA
PHAGWARA
GARHSHANKAR
PATTI
NAKODAR
JULLUNDUR
NAWASHAHR
NALAGARH
SIMLA
KANDAGHAT
PHILLAUR
ZIRA
LUDHIANA
RUPAR
FEROZEPUR
MOGA
JAGRAON
SAMRALA
KHARAR
CHANDIGARH
FARIDKOT
SIRHIND
HARAIN-GARH
RAJPURA
MALERKOTLA
NABHA
PATIALA
AMBALA
MUKTSAR
BARNALA
FAZILKA
SANGRUR
JAGADHRI
BHATINDA
THANESAR
MANSA
KAITHAL
KARNAL
NARWANA
SIRSA
FATEHABAD
PANIPAT
HISSAR
JIND
GOHANA
HANSI
NISSAR
SONEPAT
ROHTAK
BHIWANI
DADRI
JHAJJAR
DELHI
MAHENDRA-GARH
GURGAON
BALLABGARH
REWARI
PALWAL
NARNAUL
NUH
FEROZEPUR JHIRKA
CAPITAL
DISTRICT HEAD QUARTERS
TAHSIL // //
H HIMACHAL PRADESH TERRITORY
K KAPURTHALA DISTRICT
INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY
STATE BOUNDARY
DISTRICT BOUNDARY
TAHSIL BOUNDARY
20 0 20 40 60 80 MILES
30 0 30 60 90 120 KILOMETRES
74° EAST OF GREENWICH
74° 75° 76° 77° 78°
33° 32° 31° 30° 29° 28°

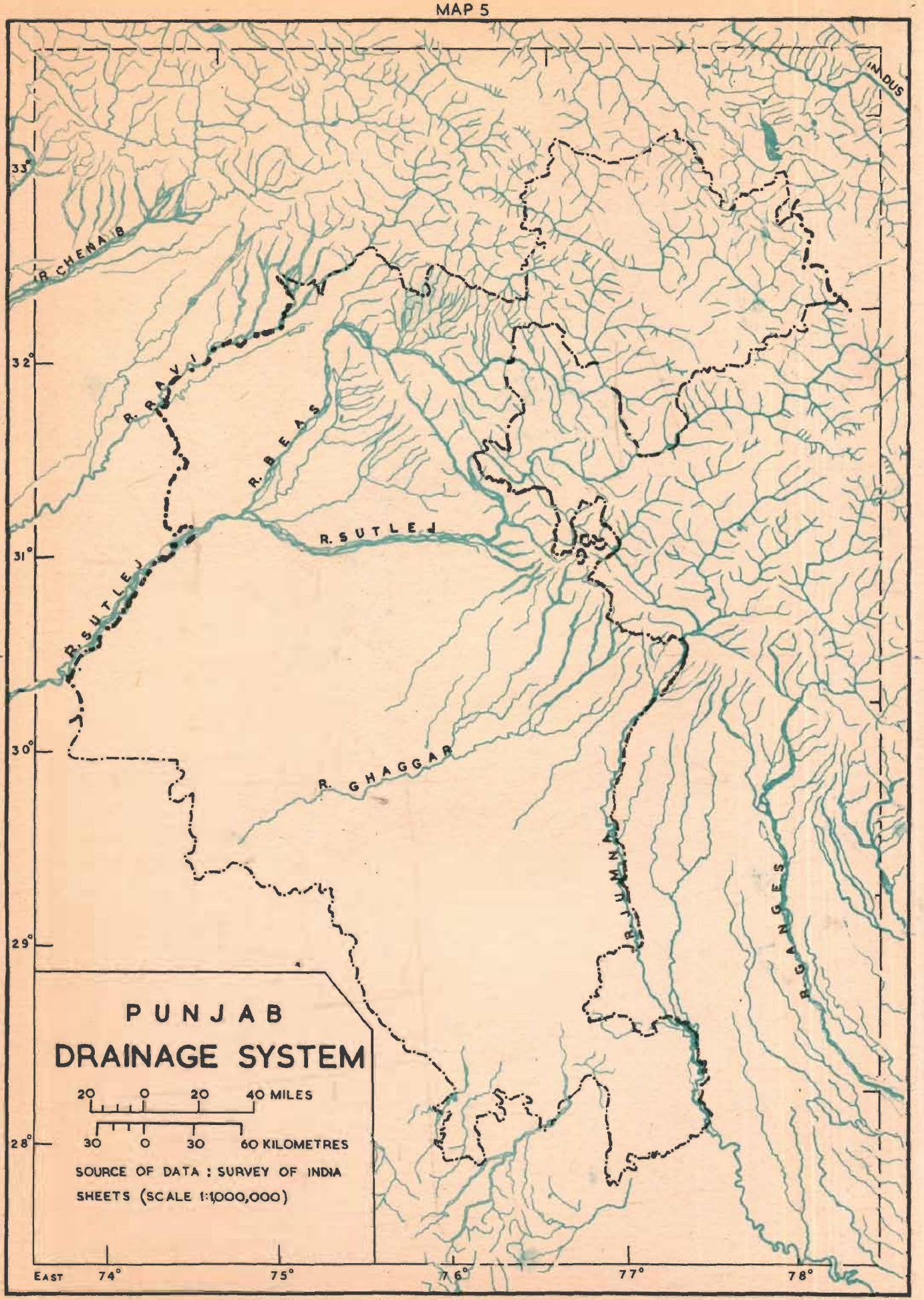
MAP 3.


PUNJAB
CHANGES IN ADMINISTRATIVE DIVISIONS
1951-61
74°
75°
76°
77°
78°
33°
32°
31°
30°
29°
28°
KULU
NURPUR
KANGRA
PALAMPUR
DERA GOPIPUR
HAMIRPUR
AJNALA
AMRITSAR
TARN-TARAN
PATTI
NALAGARH
KANDAGHAT
ZIRA
LUDHIANA
RUPAR
FEROZEPUR
JAGRAON
SAMRALA
PAYAL
KHARAR
DERA BASI
MOGA
FARIDKOT
JAMLOH
SIRHIND
RAJPURA
NARAINGARH
MALER-KOTLA
MUKTSAR
PHUL
NABHA
DHURI
AMBALA
JAGADHRI
BARNALA
SANGRUR
PATIALA
F
FAZILKA
THANESAR
BHATINDA
SUNAM
MANSA
KAITHAL
KARNAL
NARWANA
PANIPAT
JIND
DISTRICTS IN 1951
KANGRA
AMRITSAR
FEROZEPUR
LUDHIANA
AMBALA
KOHISTAN
PATIALA
FATEHGARH SAHIB
BARNALA
BHATINDA
SANGRUR
KARNAL
INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY
STATE BOUNDARY
NEW DISTRICT BOUNDARY (1961)
NEW TAHSIL // (1961)
OLD DISTRICT // (1951)
OLD TAHSIL // (1951)
F FEROZEPUR TAHSIL
20 0 20 40 60 80 MILES
30 0 30 60 90 120 KILOMETRES
Ranbir
EAST

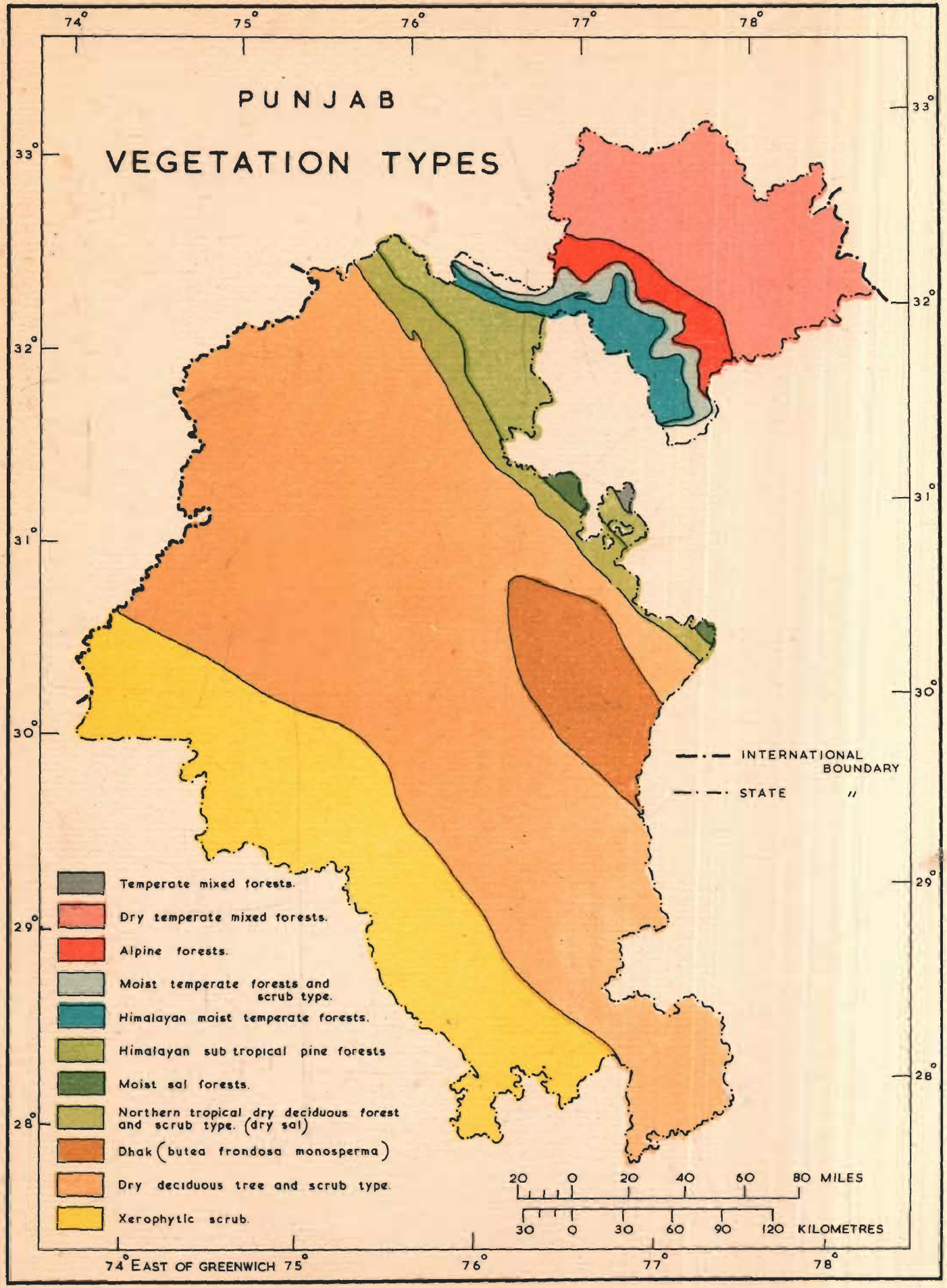
MAP 4


PUNJAB
PHYSIOGRAPHY
74°
75°
76°
77°
78°
33°
32°
31°
30°
29°
28°
3000M
900M
300M
1800 M
900M
3000 M
3000M
1800M
1800M
300M
300M
300M
300M
R. RAVI
R. BEAS
R. SUTLEJ
R. GHAGGAR
R. JUMNA
INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY
STATE //
RIVERS PERENNIAL
RIVERS NON PERENNIAL
HEIGHT ABOVE SEA LEVEL
3,000 METRES
1,800 METRES
900 METRES
300 METRES
SAND DUNES
KHADAR
20 0 20 40 60 80 MILES
30 0 30 60 90 120 KILOMETR
Ranbir
74° EAST OF GREENWICH 75° 76° 77° 78°

MAP 5


INDUS
R. CHENAB
R. RAVI
R. BEAS
R. SUTLEJ
R. SUTLEJ
R. GHAGGAR
R. JUMNA
R. GANGES
33°
32°
31°
30°
29°
28°
EAST
74°
75°
76°
77°
78°
PUNJAB
DRAINAGE SYSTEM
20 0 20 40 MILES
30 0 30 60 KILOMETRES
SOURCE OF DATA : SURVEY OF INDIA
SHEETS (SCALE 1:1,000,000)

MAP 13


PUNJAB
VEGETATION TYPES
74°
75°
76°
77°
78°
33°
32°
31°
30°
29°
28°
INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY
STATE "
Temperate mixed forests.
Dry temperate mixed forests.
Alpine forests.
Moist temperate forests and scrub type.
Himalayan moist temperate forests.
Himalayan sub tropical pine forests
Moist sal forests.
Northern tropical dry deciduous forest and scrub type. (dry sal)
Dhak (butea frondosa monosperma)
Dry deciduous tree and scrub type.
Xerophytic scrub.
20 0 20 40 60 80 MILES
30 0 30 60 90 120 KILOMETRES
74° EAST OF GREENWICH 75° 76° 77° 78°